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G O D'S TERRIBLE VOICE IN THE CITY.

Wherein you have

- I. The sound of the Voice, in the History of the Two late Dreadful Judgments of *PLAGUE* and *FIRE* in *LONDON*.
- II. The Interpretation of the Voice in a Discovery of the Cause and Design of these Judgments.

The Fifth Edition, corrected.

By *T. Vincent*, sometime Minister of *Maudlins, Milk-street, London*.

Micah 6. 9. The Voice of the Lord crieth unto the City, and the Man of Wisdom shall see thy Name: Hear ye the Rod, and who hath appointed it.

Printed for *George Calvert*, 1667.

REPRINTED FOR
JAMES NISBET, LONDON, 1832.



To all such of the City who have seen the desolations of London by the late judgments of Plague and Fire.

IT might have seemed more seasonable unto some, if a work of this nature had come forth unto view more immediately after the sound of God's terrible voice, and execution, at least, of the last dreadful judgment of the fire; because if a man strikes while the iron is hot, it is likely to make the more deep impression; which, when it grows cool, grows hard and unmanageable; and if the hammer of the word had been used, when London was newly come forth of the furnace, some might think they would have yielded the more easily unto its strokes, and the better have received the fashion which this hammer would work them unto; and that, since the fresh and lively remembrance of the judgment is more worn off; it is to be feared that they are more cooled and hardened, and therefore in likelihood it will be more difficult to effect a due impression of the judgments, by the word, upon them: yet, besides that it was not in my thoughts to attempt this work, until the greatest part of the winter was spent; I may further add, that though a discourse concerning the plague would have been most seasonable under the judgment itself, when

people, who were generally taken off from their trading, had room and time for retirement and consideration, more than ever they had in their lives before; and therefore were more likely to lay to heart what might be spoken or written unto them on that subject; Yet the reason is not the same in the judgment of the fire, which (however startling and astonishing), was so far from giving them retiring time for consideration, as the former judgment of the plague had done; that it did engage them unto more laborious works than ever they had, not only while London was burning, in removing what they could save of their goods from the fire; but also since, in looking out new habitations, and fitting their houses and shops for trades; which hath given them occasion for so much distraction, that I fear they could hardly settle their minds to read and consider so seriously as they should, what the Lord hath been doing with them, and speaking unto them by this Terrible Voice, which hath sounded so loud in their ears; but by this time I hope that the most have attained to some kind of Settlement; at least, so much, as to give them leave to sit down and ponder upon the meaning of God, in these strange and dreadful judgments of plague and fire in the city; and therefore this book may be more seasonable unto the most, than if it had been

written and presented to them immediately after the fire had burnt them out of their habitations. Friends, it is high time for all of you to retire yourselves, and bethink yourselves, and wisely to consider God's dealings with you; to open your ear, and labour to understand these speaking judgments, lest, if God be provoked by your deafness and incorrigibleness to speak a third time, it be in your utter ruin and desolation. If these papers be any ways helpful to revive in your memories the judgments themselves, by the Historical Narration which here you have of them, to work your hearts to some sense of sin in discovery of the cause; and to persuade you to a ready compliance with God's design, in the declaring of what God now expects from you, after such dreadful executions; as yours will be the benefit, so I desire that God may have the whole glory; and that you would make this return for my help of you, to help me with your prayers, that I may be the more helpful to you in mine, who am

Your dearly affectionate Friend,
and Servant in the Lord,

T. VINCENT.

GOD'S TERRIBLE VOICE

IN

THE CITY.

PSALM lxxv. part of the fifth verse.

“By terrible things in righteousness wilt thou answer us.”

INTRODUCTION.

“**SHALL** a trumpet be blown in the city, and **th**e people not be afraid? Shall there be evil in the city, and the Lord hath not done it? The lion hath roared, who will not fear? the Lord God hath spoken, who can but prophesy?” Amos iii. 6. 8. When the Pharisees spake to our Saviour to rebuke his disciples for their loud praises of the Lord with hosannas, He tells them, “If they should hold their peace, the stones would immediately cry out,” Luke xix. 39, 40. And we read in Habakkuk, chap. ii. 11.

"Of the stone crying out of the wall, and the beam out of the timber making answer." Certainly we in London have lately heard the cry of stones and walls, of timber and beams in their fall and flames; I mean in the late dreadful fire, which hath laid our Jerusalem in heaps; or rather, we have heard the voice of God in this and other terrible things which have come upon us: let none then rebuke, if one so unfit, do make an attempt to speak something of the meaning of London's fire, or of God's terrible voice in this and other judgments, when by the mouth of babes God can declare his will.

SECT. I.

"By terrible things in righteousness wilt thou answer us."

THIS whole Psalm breathes forth nothing but grace and goodness unto the people of God, from the beginning of it, to the end; yea, in the verse of my text where God speaks most terribly and rightepusly in the judgments and destructions which he bringeth upon their enemies, yet he is called the God of their salvation; and those terrible things by which God speaks, are not only a righteous answer unto their enemies' sins, but also a gracious answer unto his people's prayers: by terrible things in righteousness wilt thou answer us,

I shall not speak of terrible things in the

restrained sense, as they befall only the enemies of God's people, and the wicked, whilst the righteous do escape, and it may be hereby are preserved; but as they may befall any people, not excluding God's people, whom the Lord may answer by terrible things in righteousness.

Two doctrines we may observe.

Doct. 1. *That God doth sometimes speak unto a people by terrible things.*

Doct. 2. *That when God doth speak most terribly, He doth answer most righteously.*

First. *That God doth speak sometimes unto a people by terrible things.*

Here I shall show,

1. *How God may be said to speak.*

2. *What those terrible things are by which God doth sometimes speak.*

3. *Why God doth sometimes speak unto a people by terrible things; and then apply,*

1. *How God may be said to speak.*

God, being a Spirit, hath no mouth nor tongue properly as men have, who have bodies; and therefore his way of speaking is not like ours (though sometimes he hath created a voice in as articulate a sound, as if it had proceeded from the mouth of man, to declare his will,) but there are several ways in which God hath spoken, and doth speak unto the children of men, by which he doth as really and effectually make known his mind, as if he spake with man's voice.

1. God hath spoken formerly unto men imme-

diately, in extraordinary ways, and that sometimes more terribly; as when he gave the law upon Mount Sinai, when the Mount burned with fire, and there was blackness, and darkness, and tempest, thunderings and lightnings, and the sound of the trumpet exceeding loud, and the voice of words so exceeding terrible, that it made the whole camp to tremble; and Moses himself said, "I exceedingly fear and quake," *Exod. xix. 16; Heb. xii. 18—21.*

This way of God's speaking, the children of Israel were not able to bear; therefore they desired that Moses might speak unto them; but that God would not speak unto them thus any more, lest they should die, *Exod. xx. 19.*

At other times God spake with a more still and gentle voice, and in a more mild way, as when he spake to Samuel in the night, he thought at first that it had been the voice of Eli, *1 Sam. iii. 4, 5.* Thus God spake unto Abraham, unto Jacob, unto Moses, to whom it is said, "He spake face to face, as a man speaketh to his friend," *Exod. xxxiii. 11.*

God spake also in an extraordinary way to his prophets of old, when he made known unto them his counsel, that they might declare it unto the people; sometimes he spake unto them with an audible voice, which he created when no shape was seen; sometimes by angels, who appeared in bodies, which they laid down again when they had delivered their message; sometimes by dreams and visions in the night; sometimes by Urim and Thummim; sometimes by more secret inspirations of the Spirit.

In the last days of God's extraordinary speaking, he spake by the most extraordinary person, namely, by his own most dearly beloved, and only begotten Son, Heb. i. 1, 2; whom he sent out of his bosom to declare himself, John i. 18; and reveal what he had heard of the Father, John xv. 15, who brought life and immortality to light by the Gospel, and made known God's purpose and grace in man's salvation; 2 Tim. i. 9, 10; and uttered such things as were kept secret from the foundation of the world, Matt. xiii. 35. The Gospel began to be spoken of by the Lord Jesus himself, and was continued and confirmed by his Apostles, who were his witnesses, to whom God also did bear witness with signs, and wonders, and divers miracles, and gifts of the Holy Ghost, according to his will, Heb. ii. 3, 4.

2. And now, though not so immediately, and in such extraordinary ways, yet still God doth speak unto the children of men. There are two ways of God's speaking now unto men, namely, his *word* and his *works*.

1. His *word* contained in the Scriptures of the Old and New Testament, which holy men wrote as they were inspired by the Holy Ghost, 2 Pet. i. 21. And thus God speaketh either externally by his word alone, or internally with his word by his Spirit.

1. God speaketh now unto men *externally* by his word alone, to some more silently, unto whom he gives his Scriptures only to be read, and brings to their view his written word alone, without the advantage of other ordinances, which

might more powerfully declare unto them his will.

Unto others he speaks more audibly, where the Gospel doth sound in their ears, and with the Scriptures God sendeth his ministers to preach unto them.

God speaketh by his ministers, who are his watchmen, in his name to warn the people of his judgments temporal and eternal, which in the Scriptures he hath threatened, Ezek. iii. 17, 18, &c.; Isaiah lxii. 6, who are the Lord's ambassadors, 2 Cor. v. 20; from whom they have a commission to preach the Gospel, and declare the glad tidings of salvation unto all such as repent, and believe, and yield up themselves unto the obedience of the word.

Ministers stand in the room of Christ; and it is well for us that God speaks unto us by ministers, because we should not be able to endure, should he speak unto us immediately by himself; should he speak unto us with an audible voice, as he did to the children of Israel on Mount Sinai, when he gave the law, this would be so terrible, that with them we should desire to hear Moses, and choose ministers rather to speak unto us; yea, if Christ Jesus himself should come down from heaven, however he might have been heard in his state of humiliation, when his Deity was so much veiled; yet if he should now appear in the glory he hath with the Father, or as he appeared unto John his beloved disciple, when his eyes were as a flame of fire, and his countenance like the sun when it shined in its full strength, and his voice like the sound of

many waters: I say, if Christ should thus appear, and preach unto us, such a dread and amazement would fall upon us, that we should fall down dead at his feet, as his disciple John did, Rev. i. 13-17. Therefore it is better for us in this state of weakness, that God speaketh to us by ministers, men of like passions and infirmities with ourselves, whom we may be able to bear, and whose words, notwithstanding our weakness, we may be able to hear.

2. God doth now also speak unto men *internally*, with his word by his Spirit; when God sends his Spirit with his word, for conviction only, or some common work: thus God calls upon the wicked, who sit under the preaching of the word, moves and strives with them by his Spirit, but they resist the Spirit, stifle convictions, and will not hearken to his calls and motions, Gen. vi. 3; Acts vii. 51.

But especially God speaks with his word by his Spirit; when he sendeth his Spirit for conversion, and to effect a saving change: thus God speaks when he calleth blind sinners out of darkness into his marvellous light, 1 Pet. ii. 9; quickeneth dead sinners, putting into them a new principle of spiritual life, Ephes. ii. 1; rescueth enslaved sinners out of Satan's snare; 2 Tim. ii. 26; delivering them from the power of the devil, and translating them into the kingdom of his dear Son, Col. i. 13; when by his Spirit he draweth sinners, John vi. 44; and joins them unto Jesus Christ, 1 Cor. vi. 17; God speaketh unto men with his word by his Spirit, when he doth thus effectually call them; and

he speaketh unto men also by his Spirit, when he graciously visiteth them which are called, when he teacheth, melteth, warmeth, quickeneth, strengtheneth, and refresheth them by his Spirit, as they sit under the influence of his ordinances, when he speaketh peace unto their consciences, sheweth them his reconciled face, shedding abroad his love in their hearts, and giveth such sweet comforts, and ravishing joy as is unspeakable, and full of glory, John vi. 45; John xiv. 26; Luke xxiv. 32; Psal. cxliii. 11; Ephes. iii. 16; Acts iii. 19; Psalm lxxxv. 8; Rom. v. 5; Psalm xciv. 19; 1 Pet. i. 8.

2. God speaketh unto men by his *works*; and that either by his works of creation, or by his works of providence.

1. God speaketh by his works of *creation*; and heavens have a voice, and declare God's glory, Psalm xix. 1; and the earth hath not only an ear to ear, Isa. i. 2; but also a tongue, as it were, to speak God's praise. We read of the seas roaring, and the floods clapping their hands; of the mountains singing, and the trees of the wood sounding forth their joyful acclamations; yea, beasts and all cattle, creeping things, and flying fowl, dragons and all deeps; fire, hail, snow, rain, and stormy wind, as they fulfil his word, so they speak, and in their way declare what their Maker is; or rather in them, and by them God doth speak, and make known something of himself, Psal. cxlviii. 7, 8, 10, &c.

We read of the voice of the Lord in power, the voice of the Lord in Majesty, the voice of the Lord upon the waters, the voice of the Lord

dividing the flames of fire, the voice of the Lord shaking the wilderness of Kadesh, breaking the cedars of Lebanon, and the like, which is the voice of the Lord in the terrible noise of thunder, Psal. xxix. 3—8.

And there is no one work of the Lord (though not with such a noise) which doth not with a loud voice, as it were, in the name of the Lord, proclaim unto the children of men how great and glorious the Lord is, who hath given it its being, and use, and place in the world; especially the work of God in the make of Man, his body, the members and senses; his soul (its powers and faculties) doth without a tongue speak the praise of that God who curiously framed the body in the womb, and immediately infused the living soul, Psal. cxxxix. 14, 15; Zech. xii. 1.

2. God speaketh by his works of *providence*, and that both merciful and afflictive.

1. God speaketh by his *merciful* providences; by his patience, and bounty, and goodness, He calleth men unto repentance, Rom. ii. 4. He giveth witness of himself, in giving rain and fruitful seasons, Acts xiv. 17.

God's providing mercies, God's preventing mercies, God's preserving mercies, God's delivering mercies; the number of God's mercies which cannot be reckoned; the order and strange method of God's mercies, which cannot be declared; the greatness of God's mercies in the kinds and strange circumstances which cannot be expressed, do all with open mouth call upon men from the Lord to repent of their sins which

they have committed against him, and to yield all love, thankfulness, and obedience unto him.

2. God speaketh by his *afflictive* providences: there is a voice of God in his rod, as well as in his word, Mic. vi. 9. "Hear the rod, and who hath appointed it;" when God "chasteneth, he teacheth," Psalm xciv. 12. When God lifteth up his hand, and strikes, he openeth his mouth also, and speaks; and sometimes openeth men's ears too, and sealeth their instruction, Job xxxiii. 16.

Sometimes God speaks by *rods* more mildly, by lesser afflictions; sometimes God speaks by *scorpions* more terribly, by greater judgments: which leads to the second particular.

SECT. II.

What are those terrible things by which God doth sometimes speak?

THE word in the original is *Noraath* (from *Jera* which signifieth, he feared;) *terrible* things are such great judgments of God, as do usually make a general impression of *fear* upon the hearts of people.

Take some instances.

1. *The plague is a terrible judgment by which God speaks unto men.* It is a speaking judgment; where God sends the plague, he speaks, and he speaks terribly; the plague is very terrible, as it effecteth terror: the pestilence which

walketh in darkness, is called the "terror by night," Psalm xci. 5, 6.

The plague is very terrible, in that,

1. It is so *poisonous* a disease; it poisons the blood and spirits, breeds a strange kind of venoms in the body, which breaketh forth sometimes in boils, and blains, and great carbuncles; or else works more dangerously, when it preyeth upon the vitals more inwardly.

2. It is so *noisome* a disease; it turns the good humours into putrefaction, which putting forth itself in the issues of running sores, doth give a most noisome smell: such a disease for loathsomeness we read of, Psalm xxxviii. 5. 7. 11. "My wounds stink and are corrupt, my loins are filled with a loathsome disease, and there is no soundness in my flesh: my lovers and my friends stand aloof off from my sore, and my kinsmen stand afar off."

3. It is so *infectious* a disease: it spreadeth itself worse than the leprosy amongst the Jews; it infecteth not only those which are weak, and infirm in body, and full of ill humours, but also those that are young, strong, healthful, and of the best temperature: and that sometimes sooner than others. The plague is infectious, and greatly infectious, whole cities have been depopulated through its spreading, many whole families have received infection, and death one from another thereby: which is the third thing that rendereth the plague so terrible.

4. It is so *deadly*; it kills, where it comes without mercy; it kills (I had almost said cer-

tainly;) very few do escape, especially upon its first entrance, and before its malignity be spent; few are touched by it, but they are killed by it: and it kills *suddenly*; as it gives no warning before it comes; suddenly the arrow is shot which woundeth unto the heart; so it gives little time of preparation before it brings to the grave: under other diseases men may linger out many weeks and months; under some divers years; but the plague usually killeth within a few days; sometimes within a few hours after its first approach, though the body were never so strong and free from disease before.

The plague is very *terrible*; it is terrible to them that have it; insomuch as it usually comes with grim Death, the king of terrors, in its hand; and it is terrible to them which have it not, because of their danger of being infected by it; the fear of which have made such an impression upon some, that it hath razed out of their hearts, for the while, all affections of love and pity to their nearest relations and dearest friends; so that when the disease hath first seized upon them, and they have had the greatest need of succour, they have left their friends in distress, and flown away from them, as if they had been their enemies.

2. *A deluge by water is a terrible judgment.* There have been several floods which we read of in histories, that have suddenly broken in upon some places, and overwhelmed habitations and inhabitants together.

But God never did, and never will speak so terribly by a deluge of water, as by the great

deluge in the days of Noah, when the whole world was drowned thereby, excepting Noah, and those which were with him in the ark.

And because the judgment was so dreadful, and the history so affecting, I shall set it before your eyes out of Gen. vii. from the 11th verse to the end of the chapter. "In the sixth hundredth year of Noah's life, in the second month, and the seventeenth day of the month, in the same day were all the fountains of the great deep broken up." God withdrew the bounds which he had set to the great sea, so that the waters covered the earth as they did at the beginning, "and the windows of heaven were opened," out of which God looked forth in anger upon the earth, and poured forth a "vial of his wrath," causing it to rain forty days and forty nights in dreadful showers, accompanied, as is probable, with stormy winds, and hideous tempests, which put the world into a fright and amassment; when the element of air seemed to be changed into water, and such a torrent flowed in upon them on every side; we may guess what fear they were overwhelmed withal; but Noah and his family were got into the ark, and the Lord "shut them in;" when the waters increased, and bare up the ark, and it was lift up above the earth, and the waters increased, and prevailed greatly upon the earth; and the ark went upon the face of the waters, so that all the high hills and mountains were covered fifteen cubits: then all flesh died, fowl, and cattle, and beast, and every thing that crept or moved on the earth, and every man; and Noah only remained alive, and they that

were with him in the ark." God spake then terribly indeed unto the wicked world by the flood, which devoured them altogether in the midst of their security and sin; but God hath promised he will never speak thus by water any more.

3. *Fire is another terrible thing whereby God sometimes is pleased to contend with a sinful people.* Fire is very dreadful when it hath a commission from God, and meets with much combustible matter, and prevails without resistance. God spake terribly by fire unto Sodom and Gomorrah, when he rained fire and brimstone on those cities, and consumed them. See Gen. xix. from the 24th verse to the 29th. "The Lord rained fire and brimstone out of heaven, and overthrew those cities and the inhabitants together; and when Abraham looked toward Sodom and Gomorrah, and the land of the plain, he saw the smoke of the country go up like the smoke of a furnace."

God spake terribly, though not so terribly, to Jerusalem, when he suffered their city to be set on fire by the Babylonians, and their temple to be burnt to the ground. See Jer. lii. 12, 13.

But the most fearful instances of God's terrible voice by fire are yet to come: thus God will speak by fire unto spiritual Babylon, which may easily be proved to be Rome, from Rev. xvii. 18. She then being the great city, which reigned over the kings of the earth. Babylon's burning with fire you may read, Rev. xviii. 8—10, &c. "Therefore shall her plagues come in one day, death and mourning, and famine, and she shall be utterly burnt with fire; for strong is the Lord God

who judgeth her: and the kings of the earth who have committed fornication, and lived deliciously with her, shall bewail her, and lament for her, when they shall see the smoke of her burning; standing afar off for fear of her torment, saying, Alas, that great city Babylon! that mighty city! for in one hour is thy judgment come," &c.

God spake terribly by fire when London was in flames, of which in the application; but he will speak far more terribly when Babylon shall be in flames; and not only in part, but wholly, and utterly, and irreparably burnt, and turned into ashes: when not only the city shall be consumed, but also the Whore herself "shall be hated and made desolate, and devoured with fire by the kings of the earth," Rev. xvii. 10.

The last instance of God's speaking terribly by fire will be the *last day*, when the Lord Jesus Christ, the judge of quick and dead, shall come down from heaven in flaming fire, to take vengeance on all those that know not God, and obey not the Gospel," 2 Thess. i. 7, 8. And the Apostle Peter tells us, that "the heavens and the earth are reserved in store for fire against this day; when the heavens shall pass away with a great noise, and the elements melt with fervent heat, and the earth and all the works therein shall be burnt up," 2 Pet. iii. 7—10. Then God will speak terribly by fire, and above all, most terribly to the ungodly world; when he will sentence them unto, and cast them into the fire of hell, where they must dwell with devouring fire, and inhabit everlasting burnings.

4. *The sword is a dreadful judgment, whereby*

God speaks sometimes very terribly; especially when he draws it forth against his own and his people's enemies. Hear how terribly God speaks in Deut. xxxii. 39—42. “See now that I, even I, am he, and there is no God with me; I kill and I make alive; I wound, and I heal; neither is there any that can deliver out of my hand: For I lift up my hand to heaven, and say, I live for ever. If I whet my glittering sword, and my hand take hold on judgment, I will render vengeance to mine enemies, and reward them that hate me: I will make mine arrows drunk with blood (and my sword shall devour flesh) and that with the blood of the slain, and of the captives, from the beginning of revenges upon the enemies.”

When God furbisheth his sword, and whets it; when God girdeth his sword upon his thigh, and marcheth against his enemies; when he draweth his sword, and maketh slaughter with it; when his sword devoureth much flesh, and is made drunk with the blood of the slain; when God gives commission to the sword, saying, “Sword, go through such a land;” as Ezek. xiv. 17. And “pours out his fury on the land in blood;” as verse 19. So that the sword is bathed in blood, and garments are rolled in blood, and the land is soaked in blood; when blood is poured forth like water, and dead bodies are cast forth into the open field without burial; and God makes an invitation to all feathered fowl to gather themselves together, and feast themselves upon the carcasses of the slain; as Ezek. xxxix. 17—20. When God comes with “died garments

from Borsah," Is. lxiii. 1. "When he gathereth the nations, and brings them into the valley of Jehoshaphat, and thither causeth his mighty ones to come down against them." Joel iii. 2. 11. When the day of God's indignation doth come, and he makes such a slaughter amongst his enemies, that the "earth doth stink with their carcases, and the mountains do melt with their blood," Isa. xxxiv. 2, 3. When God "treadeth the wine-press of his wrath without the city, and the blood comes out of the wine-press, even to the horses' bridles," Rev. xiv. 20. In a word, when the Lord shall come forth upon his white "horse" with his armies; and shall destroy the beast, and all the powers of the earth that take part with him; as Rev. xix. from the 11th verse to the end: then God will speak terribly indeed against his enemies by the sword, then he will "roar out of Zion, and utter his voice from Jerusalem," and that in such a manner, as will "make both the heavens and the earth to tremble," Joel iii. 16.

And indeed God speaks with a terrible voice, wherever he sends the sword, and makes the alarm of war to be heard; as sometimes he sends it amongst his own people for their sin, 1 Kings viii. 38.

When God brings into a land a people of another language and religion, of a fierce countenance and cruel disposition; and gives them power to prevail, and bring the land under their feet, so that the mighty men are cut off by them, and the men of valour crushed in the gate; the young men fly and fall before them, and there is none to make any resistance; when they break in

upon cities; plunder houses, ravish women and maids, strip and spoil, and put all to the sword, the young with the grey head, cruelly rip up women with child, and without any pity on little infants, dash them against the stones. God speaks more terribly by such a judgment, than by plague or fire.

5. *The famine is a dreadful judgment, whereby God speaks sometimes unto a people very terribly; when God "stretcheth upon a place the lines of confusion, and the stones of emptiness,"* as Isa. xxxiv. 11. When God sendeth cleanness of teeth into cities, as Amos iv. 7. When God shooteth into a land the evil arrows of famine, and it becomes exceeding sore; this is one of the most dreadful of all judgments in this world,—far beyond plague, or fire, or sword. See how pathetically the famine amongst the Jews is described, by Jeremiah in his Lamentations, chap. iv. from the 4th verse to the 12th. "The tongue of the sucking child cleaveth to the roof of his mouth for thirst; the young children ask for bread, and no man breaketh it unto them. They that fed delicately are desolate in the streets. They that were brought up in scarlet embrace dunghills. For the punishment of the iniquity of the daughter of my people is greater than the punishment of the sin of Sodom, that was overthrown in a moment, and no hands stayed on her. Her Nazarites were purer than snow; whiter than milk; they were more ruddy in body than rubies; their polishing was of sapphire; their visage is blacker than a coal; they are not known in the streets; their skin cleaveth to their bones; it is

withered, it is become like a stick. They that be slain with the sword, are better than they which be slain with hunger ; for these pine away stricken through for want of the fruits of the earth. The hands of the pitiful women have sodden their own children, they were their meat in the destruction of the daughter of my people. The Lord hath accomplished his fury, he hath poured out his fierce anger."

6. *The sixth terrible judgment is a famine of the Word*, which is threatened, Amos viii. 11, 12. "Behold, the days come, saith the Lord, that I will send a famine in the land ; not a famine of bread, nor a thirst for water, but of hearing the words of the Lord : and they shall wander from sea to sea, and from the north even to the east, and they shall run to and fro to seek the word of the Lord, and shall not find it."

A famine of the Word is a worse judgment than a famine of bread ! Indeed few do really think so, because the most judge according to sense ; but that it is so, is evident to a man of faith and consideration : for as the soul is more excellent than the body ; and the concerns of the other life, far beyond the concerns of this life : so the provisions for the soul are more excellent than the provisions for the body, and the means of getting eternal life, to be preferred before the means of preserving temporal life ; and therefore by consequence the death and scarcity of provisions for the soul, must needs be a greater judgment than a scarcity of provisions for the body. Unto which I might add, that the famine of the Word doth usually bring with it many

temporal judgments; the burning of the temple at Jerusalem, and the failing of vision was accompanied with slaughter by the sword, and captivity of the land.

7. And lastly, *God speaks most terribly unto a people when he sends divers of these judgments together, as Lam. i. 20.* "Abroad the sword be-reaveth, at home there is death;" when enemies without, plague and famine within. God speaks terribly, when fire and sword go together, or sword and famine, or famine and plague, or famine of bread, and famine of the Word.

These are some of the terrible things by which God doth sometimes speak.

SECT. III.

Why is it that the Lord doth speak unto a people by such terrible things?

THE reason is, because people do not hearken unto him, speaking any other way. "God speaketh once, yea, twice, but men perceive it not," Job xxxiii. 14. God's gentle voice is not heard or minded, therefore he speaks more loudly and terribly, that people might be awakened to hear. Particularly God speaks thus terribly,

8. *Because people do not hearken to the voice of his Word and messengers; God speaks audibly*

by ministers, and when they are not regarded, he speaks more feelingly by judgments; he speaks first by threatenings, and when they are slighted, he speaks by executions. God first lifts up his voice, and warns by his Word, before he lifts up his arm, and strikes with his rod: when men grow thick of hearing the sweet calls of the Gospel, God is even forced to thunder, that he may pierce their ear: when God speaks to the ears and they are shut, God speaks to the eyes and other senses, that his mind may be known; especially when men obstinately refuse to hear, God is exceedingly provoked to execute his terrible judgments upon them. See Zech. viii. 11, 12. "But they refused to hearken, and pulled away the shoulder, and stopped their ears that they should not hear: yea, they made their hearts like an adamant stone, lest they should hear the law, and the words which the Lord of Hosts had sent in his Spirit by the former prophets: therefore came there a great wrath from the Lord of Hosts." So also when God gave up Jerusalem to desolation and ruin, see the sin which provoked the Lord hereunto, 2 Chron. xxxvi. 16. "They mocked the messengers of God, and despised his words, and misused his prophets, until the wrath of the Lord, arose against his people, till there was no remedy.

2. *Because they do not hearken to the voice of his goodness and mercies.* The goodness and forbearance of God, doth speak unto men from him, and call upon them to forbear sin for shame; to repent and return to him, Rom. i. 4. But when men despise the riches of his goodness, and deafen their ear unto the language of his mercies,

and trample his patience under foot, (though God hath appointed a day of wrath hereafter, wherein he will reckon with the whole ungodly world together, and give them the just demerit of their sin;) yet sometimes his patience is turned hereby into fury, and his anger doth break forth into a flame, and consumes them by the blow of dreadful temporal judgments.

8. *Because they will not hearken to the voice of lesser afflictions.* When God's word is not heard, he speaks by his rod; when his rod is not heard, he shoots with his arrows and strikes with his sword; and if lesser afflictions be not minded, then God speaks by more dreadful awakening judgments: as the sins of men do precede the judgments of God, so usually lesser judgments do precede greater judgments; and as there are degrees and steps which men usually do make before they arrive to a great height in sin, *Nemo repente fit turpissimus*, so there are degrees and steps which God usually doth take, in inflicting his judgments for sin. Look into one place for all, which shews how God doth proceed from less to greater judgments, Lev. xxvi. from the 15th verse to the 40th. When his "statutes are despised, and covenant broken;" first he threateneth to send upon them "consumption and a burning ague;" then he threatened that "they shall fall before their enemies;" and if "they will not hearken to his voice" in these judgments, he threateneth to "punish them seven times more for their sins;" and to "make the heavens as iron, and the earth as brass;" and "send a dearth amongst them." And if they will not "yet

hearken," he threateneth to "send wild beasts, which should devour their children and cattle." And if they would not be reformed by these things, but still "would walk contrary unto him," he threateneth "to walk contrary unto them, and to punish them yet seven times more for their sins:" he threateneth to bring a "sword upon them, to avenge the quarrel of his covenant; and when they should be gathered together in their cities, to "send the pestilence amongst them: and hereunto to add the "famine." And if they would not yet "hearken unto God, but still walk contrary unto him," he threateneth "that he will walk contrary to them in fury, and make them eat the flesh of their sons and their daughters, and lay waste their cities, and make their sanctuaries a desolation: and upon them that are left alive," he threateneth "to send such faintness of heart, that they should flee at the sound of a shaken leaf, and fall when none pursued them; and that they should pine away in their iniquities in the land of their enemies. Thus God proceeds by steps and degrees, in the execution of his fierce anger upon a rebellious people; when God speaks by ordinary diseases and is not heard, then sometimes he sends a plague: and if after a plague, people will not return to him that smiteth them, nor seek to pacify God's anger which is kindled against them; but walk so much the more contrary unto him, he will walk contrary to them in fury, and send fire into their cities to devour their habitations. And if the voice of the fire be not heard, he hath other judgments in readiness, sword, famine, and the like.

And if temporal judgments be not heeded, he will bring upon them eternal judgments.

God is not heard any other way, therefore he doth speak by such terrible things.

SECT. IV.

THE APPLICATION.

God speaks sometimes to a people by terrible things.

THESE few last years have given sad instances hereof in England, especially the two last years in our city of London.

The voice of the Lord hath been in the city, it hath been loud and full of terror! the Lord hath come forth against us with armed vengeance. Frowns have been in his brow; death and desolation in his looks; thunder hath been in his voice: flames of fire in his hand: "the pestilence hath gone before him, and burning coals at his feet," Hab. iii. 5. "He hath sent forth his arrows, which have scattered us, and shot forth his lightnings which have discomfited us; the Lord hath thundered in the heavens, and the highest gave his voice, hail-stones and coals of fire," Psalm xviii. "The Lord hath visited us with storm and tempest, and great noise," Isa. xxix. Yea, He "hath caused his glorious voice to be

heard, and shewed the lighting down of his arm, with the indignation of his anger, and with the flame of devouring fire, with scattering, and tempest, and hail-stones," Isa. xxx. "Then the furrows of the earth were seen, and the foundations of the city were discovered, the earth also shook, because he was wroth, and the inhabitants of *London* trembled, because of his fierce anger; then the snares of death compassed us, and the fears of hell gat hold on us; and our hearts were moved within us, as trees when they are moved by the wind," Isa. vii. Dreadful have God's late judgments been in *London*, the noise of which hath gone forth, not only throughout the land, but also unto the outermost parts of the world.

Three things we should remark in this terrible voice of God's judgments. . .

1. The judgments themselves.
2. The cause of the judgments.
3. The design of the judgments.

In the first, we have the sound of the voice. In the two last, the interpretation of the voice. .

1. *Concerning the judgments themselves.* Here I might speak of the judgment executed, August 24, 1662, when so many ministers were put out of their places; and the judgments executed, March 24, 1665, when so many ministers were banished five miles from corporations; the former by way of introduction to the plague which some time after did spread in the land, but chiefly raged in the city; the latter by way of introduction to the fire, which quickly after did burn down *London* the greatest corporation in

England. These judgments having been so lately, and general in the land; and I presume, so generally known, with all their circumstances, it would be needless to give here a narration of them. But this I must say, I could wish they were as generally believed to be judgments, and accordingly laid to heart: for I fear that the great insensibility, which people have been under of these judgments, because they have not reached the flesh, and their seditious inconsideration of God's dreadful displeasure herein, hath provoked the Lord to send such judgments as have come nearer to sense;—that they might perceive God was angry indeed before, and that his greater displeasure in the former might be known by his more sensible displeasure in the latter.

Let London seriously consider whether her *Gospel-privileges* were not her best defence against temporal calamities; and whether, since her slighting, abuse, and forfeiture, and God's seizure and stripping her so much of these, she hath not been laid naked to those heavy strokes of extraordinary judgments which she hath lately received.

London had the Gospel ordinances, powerful, pure, plentiful; ministers excellently qualified and rarely furnished with ministerial abilities: London had as many burning and shining lights as any one such spot of ground under the cope of heaven.

Not to speak of their abilities for preaching and defence of the truth: such gifts of prayer London-ministers had, which were no small de-

fence of the city, as I believe no city in the world could parallel.

O what prayers have there formerly been in London pulpits, especially on days of solemn humiliation! How have the spirits of ministers been carried forth sometimes in prayer for several hours together, (without tautologies and vain repetitions) in such variety of affectionate enlargements, and with such raisedness and transports of spirit, as if they had been just leaving the body, and going to live and abide with God, and would converse no more with men or worldly things!

In their confessions of sin, how have they raked into the dunghill of a rotten heart, and laid abroad its inward filthiness! How have they traced the foot-steps of its deceitfulness, through the maze and wilderness of its many windings and turnings! How have they pierced into the very bowels of sin, and ript it up as it were to the back-bone, bringing forth its very entrails to open view! How have they anatomized as it were the "body of death" in all the parts and members of it; discovering withal, the several diseases of every part, with their cause and manner of working! and all this in such pathological cutting expressions, accompanied with such brokenness and bleeding of heart, as no form can imitate or effect.

In their supplications for the pardon of sin, for spiritual and heavenly riches; O with what feeling and fervour did they express themselves! O with what faith and importunity did they wrestle and plead at the throne of grace for such favours, beyond the importunity of poor prisoners

through the grates, or poor beggars at the doors, when they are most earnest for relief! Yea, how did they besiege God as it were, and seem "as if they would scale the walls of heaven itself, and take the kingdom of heaven with violence and force?" How have they even pressed in upon God with the dint of argument, and laid hold on him with the hand of faith, resolving not to let him go without a blessing!

In their supplications for the church and land, they have behaved themselves as if they had no private concerns. But how did they bear London upon their hearts when they came to the throne of grace! What yearning bowels had they towards, and for the city! How many tears have they shed in bewailing her sins! How have they stood in the breach, when the Lord hath been coming forth against this place! How have they held his arm when it hath been lifted up to strike! How have they stood "weeping between the porch and the altar, crying, spare thy people, O Lord, and do not destroy London!" and many times have they prevailed to appease God's wrath, and turn away his fierce anger which hath been kindled against us. Gospel-ordinances, and Gospel-ministers were the safeguard of London, the glory and defence. But when the ordinances were slighted, and the ministers were mocked and misused by some who called themselves professors, and both were fallen so much, in the esteem of the most; and London did not yield the fruit which God looked for under such dressing (of which more when I come to speak of London's sins,) God is provoked not only to call

some of his messengers home to himself, but also to suffer the rest which were more conscientious, to be thrust into corners.

This did presage London's near approaching ruin and desolation, though few did believe it; and because they did not believe it, and were insensible of God's wrath in his judgment, therefore their danger was the greater of the other judgments which have come upon them: when so many stakes were plucked out, no wonder if the hedge be broken; when so many pillars were removed, no wonder if the building tumble to the ground.

But I proceed to give a narration of the latter judgments of plague and fire.

SECT. V.

THE Plague so great, so lately, should not be forgotten; yet lest the Fire more lately, and proportionably more great, and the amazing fears, which since have risen within us, should shuffle former thoughts out of our minds, and raze out the impressions, which by the plague we had, and should labour to retain to our dying hour: therefore I shall give a brief narration of this sad judgment, and some observations of mine own (who was here in the city from the beginning to the end of it) both to keep alive in myself and others, the memory of the judgment, that we may be the better prepared for compliance with God's design in sending the plague amongst us.

It was in the year of our Lord 1665, that the Plague began in our city of London, after we were warned by the great Plague in Holland, in the year 1664, and the beginning of it in some remote parts of our land the same year; not to speak any thing whether there was any signification and influence in the blazing stars not long before, that appeared in the view of London, and struck some amazement on the spirits of many. It was in the month of May that the Plague was first taken notice of; our bill of mortality did let us know but of three which died of the disease in the whole year before; but in the beginning of May the bill tells us of nine, which felt by the plague, one in the heart of the city, the other eight in the suburbs. This was the first arrow of warning that was shot from heaven amongst us, and fear quickly begins to creep upon people's hearts; great thoughts and discourse there is in town about the plague, and they cast in their minds whether they shall go if the plague should increase. Yet when the next week's bill signifieth to them the decrease from nine to three, their minds are something appeased; discourse of that subject cools; fears are hushed, and hopes take place, that the black cloud did but threaten, and give a few drops; but the wind would drive it away. But when in the next bill the number of the dead by the plague is amounted from three to fourteen, and in the next to seventeen, and in the next to forty-three, and the disease begins so much to increase, and disperse.

Now secure sinners begin to be startled, and those who would have slept at quiet still in their

nets; are unwillingly awakened. Now a great
 consternation seizeth upon most persons, and
 fearful bodings of a desolating judgment. Now
 guilty sinners begin to look about them, and think
 with themselves into what corner of the land they
 might fly to hide them. Now the profane and sen-
 sual, if they have not remorse for their sins, yet
 dread and terrors, the effects of guilt, they could
 not drive from them; and if by company, and
 carousing, and soft pleasures they do intoxicate
 and smoothen their spirits in the day; yet we
 may guess what dread doth return upon them, if
 they give but any room for retirement; and what
 hideous thoughts such persons have in the silent
 night, through fears of death which they are in
 danger of. Now those who did not believe an
 unseen God, are afraid of unseen arrows; and
 those which slighted God's threatenings of
 eternal judgments do tremble at the beginning
 of his execution of one, and not the greatest
 temporal judgment. Now those which had as it
 were challenged the God of Heaven, and defied
 him by their horrid oaths and blasphemies, when
 he begins to appear, they retreat, yea fly away
 with terror and amazement. The great orbs
 begin first to move; the lords and gentry retire
 into their countries; their remote houses are
 prepared, goods removed, and London is quickly
 upon their backs: few ruffling gallants walk the
 streets; few spotted ladies to be seen at windows:
 a great forsaking there was of the adjacent places
 where the plague did first rage.

In June the number increaseth from 43 to
 112; the next week to 168, the next to 267, the

next to 470, most of which increase was in the remote parts; few in this month within or near the walls of the city; and few that had any note for goodness or profession, were visited at the first: God gave them warning to bethink and prepare themselves; yet some few that were choice were visited pretty soon, that the best might not promise themselves a supersedeas, or interpret any place of Scripture so literally, as if the Lord had promised an absolute general immunity and defence of his own people from this disease of the plague.

Now the citizens of London are put to a stop in the career of their trade; they begin to fear whom they converse withal, and deal withal, lest they should have come out of infected places. Now roses and other sweet flowers wither in the gardens, are disregarded in the markets, and people dare not offer them to their noses lest with their sweet savour, that which is infectious should be attracted: rue and wormwood are taken into the hand: myrrh and zedoary into the mouth; and without some antidote few stir abroad in the morning. Now many houses are shut up where the plague comes, and the inhabitants shut in, lest coming abroad they should spread infection. It was very dismal to behold the red crosses, and read in great letters, LORD HAVE MERCY UPON US, on the doors, and watchmen standing before them with halberts; and such a solitude about these places, and people passing by them so gingerly, and with such fearful looks as if they had been lined with enemies in ambush, that waited to destroy them.

Now rich tradesmen provide themselves to depart; if they have not country-houses, they seek lodgings abroad for themselves and families, and the poorer tradesmen, that they may imitate the rich in their fear, stretch themselves to take a country journey, though they have scarce wherewithal to bring them back again. The ministers also (many of them) take occasion to go to their country-places for the summer time; or (it may be) to find out some few of their parishioners that were gone before them, leaving the greatest part of their flock without food or physic, in the time of their greatest need. (I don't speak of all ministers, those which did stay out of choice and duty, deserve true honour.) Possibly they might think God was now preaching to the city, and what need their preaching? or rather did not the thunder of God's voice affrighten their guilty consciences and make them fly away, lest a bolt from heaven should fall upon them, and spoil their preaching for the future; and therefore they would reserve themselves till the people had less need of them. I do not blame any citizens retiring, when there was so little trading, and the presence of all might have helped forward the increase and spreading of the infection; but how did guilt drive many away, where duty would have engaged them to stay in the place? Now the highways are thronged with passengers and goods, and London doth empty itself into the country; great are the stirs and hurries in London by the removal of so many families; fear puts many thousands on the wing, and those

think themselves most safe, that can fly furthest off from the city.

In July the plague increaseth, and prevaiileth exceedingly, the number of 470, which died in one week by the disease, ariseth to 725 the next week, to 1089 the next, to 1843 the next, to 2010 the next. Now the plague compasseth the walls of the city like a flood, and poureth in upon it. Now most parishes are infected both without and within; yet there are not so many houses shut up by the plague, as by the owners forsaking of them for fear of it; and though the inhabitants be so exceedingly decreased by the departure of so many thousands, the number of dying persons increaseth fearfully. Now the countries keep guards, lest infectious persons should from the city bring the disease unto them; most of the rich are now gone, and the middle sort will not stay behind: but the poor are forced (through poverty) to stay, and abide the storm. Now most faces gather paleness, and what dismal apprehensions do then fill their minds, what dreadful fears do there possess the spirits, especially of those whose consciences are full of guilt, and have not made their peace with God? The old drunkards, and swearers, and unclean persons are brought into great straits; they look on the right hand, and on the left, and death is marching towards them from every part, and they know not whither to fly that they may escape it. Now the arrows begin to fly very thick about their ears, and they see many fellow sinners fall before their eyes, expecting every hour themselves to be smitten;

and the very sinking fears they have had of the plague, hath brought the plague and death upon many; some by the sight of a coffin in the streets, have fallen into a shivering, and immediately the disease hath assaulted them, and serjeant Death hath arrested them, and clapt to the doors of their houses upon them, from whence they have come forth no more, till they have been brought forth to their graves. We may imagine the hideous thoughts, and horrid perplexity of mind, the tremblings, confusions, and anguish of spirit, which some awakened sinners have had, when the plague hath broke in upon their houses, and seized upon near relations, whose dying groans, sounding in their ears, have warned them to prepare; when their doors have been shut up and fastened on the outside with an inscription, "Lord have mercy upon us," and none suffered to come in but a nurse, whom they have been more afraid of than the plague itself; when lovers, and friends, and companions in sin have stood aloof, and not dared to come nigh the door of the house, lest death should issue forth from thence upon them; especially when the disease hath invaded themselves, and first began with a pain and dizziness in their head, then trembling in their other members; when they have felt boils to arise under their arms, and in their groins, and seen blains to come forth in other parts; when the disease hath wrought in them to that height, as to send forth those spots which (most think) are the certain tokens of near approaching death; and now they have received the sentence of death within themselves, and have certainly concluded, that within

a few hours they must go down into the dust, and their naked souls, without the case of their body, must make its passage into eternity, and appear before the highest Majesty, to render their accounts and receive their sentence. None can utter the horror which hath been upon the spirits of such, through the lashes and stings of their guilty consciences, when they have called to mind a life of sensuality and profaneness, their uncleanness, drunkenness, injustice, oaths, curses, derisions of saints and holiness, neglect of their own salvation; and when a thousand sins have been set in order before their eyes, with another aspect than when they looked upon them in the temptation; and they find God to be irreconcilably angry with them, and that the day of grace is over, the door of mercy is shut, and that pardon and salvation (which before they slighted) is now unattainable: that the grave is now opening its mouth to receive their bodies, and hell opening its mouth to receive their souls; and they apprehend that they are now just entering into a place of endless woe and torment, and they must now take up their lodgings in the inferior regions of utter darkness, with devils, and their fellow-damned sinners, and there abide for evermore in the extremity of misery, without any hopes or possibility of a release; and that they have foolishly brought themselves into this condition, and been the cause of their own ruin; we may guess that the despairful agonies and anguish of such awakened sinners, hath been of all things the most unsupportable; except the very future miseries themselves, which they have been afraid of.

In August how dreadful is the increase: from 2010, the number amounts up to 2817 in one week; and thence to 3880 the next; thence to 4237 the next; thence to 6102 the next; and all these of the plague, besides other diseases.

Now the cloud is very black, and the storm comes down upon us very sharp. Now Death rides triumphantly on his pale horse through our streets; and breaks into every house almost, where any inhabitants are to be found. Now people fall as thick as leaves from the trees in autumn, when they are shaken by a mighty wind. Now there is a dismal solitude in London's streets, every day looks with the face of a Sabbath day, observed with greater solemnity than it used to be in the city. Now shops are shut in, people rare and very few that walk about, insomuch that the grass begins to spring up in some places, and a deep silence almost in every place, especially within the walls; no rattling coaches, no prancing horses, no calling in customers, nor offering wares; no London Cries sounding in the ears: if any voice be heard, it is the groans of dying persons, breathing forth their last: and the funeral knells of them that are ready to be carried to their graves. * Now shutting up of visited-houses (there being so many) is at an end, and most of the well are mingled among the sick, which otherwise would have got no help. Now in some places where the people did generally stay, not one house in a hundred but is infected; and in many houses half the family is swept away; in some the whole, from the eldest to the youngest; few escape with the death of but one or two; never

did so many husbands and wives die together; never did so many parents carry their children with them to the grave, and go together into the same house under earth, who had lived together in the same house upon it. Now the nights are too short to bury the dead; the long summer days are spent from morning unto the twilight in conveying the vast number of dead bodies unto the bed of their graves.

Now we could hardly go forth, but we should meet many coffins, and see diseased persons with sores and limping in the streets; amongst other sad spectacles, methought two were very affecting: one of a woman coming alone, and weeping, by the door where I lived (which was in the midst of infection) with a little coffin under her arm, carrying it to the new church-yard: I did judge that it was the mother of the child, and that all the family besides was dead, and she was forced to coffin up, and bury with her own hands, this her last dead child. Another, was of a man at the corner of the Artillery wall, that, as I judge, through the dizziness of his head with the disease, which seized upon him there, had dashed his face against the wall, and when I came by, he lay hanging with his bloody face over the rails, and bleeding upon the ground; and as I came back, he was removed under a tree in Moorfields, and lay upon his back; I went and spake to him; he could make me no answer, but rattled in the throat, and, as I was informed, within half an hour died in the place.

It would be endless to speak what we have seen and heard of some in their phrenzy,

rising out of their beds, and leaping about their rooms; others crying and roaring at their windows; some coming forth almost naked, and running into the streets: strange things have others spoken and done when the disease was upon them; but it was very sad to hear of one who being sick alone, and it is like frantic, burnt himself in his bed. Now the plague had broken in much amongst my acquaintance; and of about sixteen or more whose faces I used to see every day in our house, within a little while I could find but four or six of them alive; scarcely a day passed over my head, for I think a month or more together, but I should hear of the death of some one or more that I knew. The first day, that they were smitten, the next some hopes of recovery, and the third day, that they were dead.

In September, when we hoped for a decrease, because of the season, because of the number gone, and the number already dead; yet it was not come to its height, but from 6102, which died by the plague the last week of August, the number is augmented to 6988 in the first week in September; and when we conceived some little hopes in the next week's abatement to 6544, our hopes were quite dashed again, when the next week it did rise to 7165, which was the highest bill, and a dreadful bill it was! and of the 130 parishes in and about the city, there were but four parishes which were not infected; and in those, few people remaining that were not gone into the country.

Now the grave doth open its mouth without measure; multitudes! multitudes! in the valley of

the shadow of death thronging daily into eternity ; the church-yards now are so stuffed with dead corpses, that they are in many places swelled two or three feet higher than they were before ; and new ground is broken up to bury the dead.

Now "Hell from beneath is moved" at the number of the guests that are received into its chambers ; the number of the wicked which have died by the plague, no doubt, hath been far the greatest, as we may reasonably conclude, without breach of charity ; and it is certain, that all the wicked which then died in sin were turned into hell ; how then are the damned spirits now increased ! some were damning themselves a little before in their oaths, and God is now damning their souls for it, and is passing the irreversible sentence of damnation upon them. Some were drinking wine in bowls a little before, and strong drink without measure ; and now God hath put another cup into their hands, a cup of red wine, even the wine of the wrath and fierceness of the Almighty. Some were a little before feasting their senses, pleasing their appetite, satisfying the desires of the flesh, and being past feeling, had given themselves up to lasciviousness, to work all uncleanness with greediness ; but now their laughter is turned into mourning, and their joy into howling and woe ; and they have recovered their feeling again, but instead of the pleasures which they felt, and their sensual delights, which took away the feeling of their consciences, they are made to feel the heavy hand of God ; and to endure such anguish and horror, through the sense of God's wrath, as no tongue can express.

Now the atheists believe there is a God, and the anti-scripturists are convinced of the truth of God's word, by the execution of God's threatenings in the Word upon them. Now the covetous and unjust, the malicious and cruel, the scoffers and profane, begin to suffer the vengeance of eternal fire: and the ignorant person with the civil, who are acquainted with Jesus Christ, are not excused; yea, the hypocrites, with all impenitent and unbelieving persons, are sent down to the place of weeping: and surely Hell wonders to see so many come amongst them from such a city as London, where they have enjoyed such plenty of such powerful means of grace; and place is given to them, even the lowest and hottest, where Judas and others are of the chiefest note.

Yet Hell doth not engross all that die by the visitation; some there are (though not the first or most) who have room made for them in the mansions which are above. The plague makes little difference between the righteous and the wicked, (except the Lord by a peculiar providence do shelter some under his wing, and compass them with his favour, as with a shield, hereby keeping off the darts that are shot so thick about them,) yet as there is little difference in the bodies of the righteous, and of others; so this disease makes little discrimination, and not a few fearing God are cut off amongst the rest; they die of the same distemper with the most profane, they are buried in the same grave, and there sleep together till the morning of the resurrection; but as there is a difference in their

spirits whilst they live, so there is a difference, and the chiefest difference, in their place and state after their separation from the body. Dives is carried to hell, and Lazarus to Abraham's bosom, though he died with his body full of sores: devils drag the souls of the wicked after they have received their final doom at the bar of God, into utter darkness, where there is weeping, and wailing, and gnashing of teeth; but angels convey the souls of the righteous into the heavenly paradise, the New Jerusalem which is above, where God is in his glory; and the Lord Jesus Christ at his right hand, and thousand thousands stand before him, and ten thousand times ten thousand administer unto him, even an innumerable company of angels; and where the spirits of all just men and women made perfect, were before gathered; where there is fulness of joy, and rivers of eternal pleasures running about the throne of God, the streams of which do make glad all the inhabitants of New Jerusalem. Now the weak prison-doors of the body are broken down, and the strong everlasting gates of their Father's palace are lifted up, and the saints are received with joy and triumph, into glory; and they come with singing into Zion, and everlasting joy in their hearts, and all sorrow and sighing doth fly away like a cloud, which never any more shall be seen. Now the veil is rent, and they enter the Holy of Holies, where God dwells, not in the darkness of a thick cloud, as in the temple of old, but in the brightness of such marvellous light and glory, as their eyes never did behold, neither

could enter into their heart to conceive ; there they have the vision of God's face without any eclipse upon the light of his countenance : there they have the treasures of God's love opened, and his arms to receive them with dearest and sweetest embracements ; which kindles in their hearts such a flame of love, so ravishing and delightful, as words cannot utter : there they are entertained by the Lord Jesus Christ, whom in the world they have served ; and he that showed them his grace, which they had wondered at when they were in the body, doth now show them his glory, which they wonder at much more. There they are welcomed by angels, who rejoice, if at their conversion, much more at their coronation, there they sit down with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, in the kingdom of their Father : there they find Moses, and David, and Samuel, and Paul, and all the holy martyrs and saints, which have died before them, amongst whom they are numbered and placed, who rejoice in their increased society.

And as there is a great difference between the condition of the souls of the righteous and the wicked, who died by the same disease of the plague, after their death and separation ; so there is a great difference between the carriage of their spirits at their death, and upon their sick-bed. Some wicked men are stupid and senseless, and are given up to a judiciary hardness, and die in a sleep of carnal security, out of which they are not awakened, till they are awakened in the midst of flames : others more sensible, and considering what hath been, and what is coming

upon them, are filled with inexpressible terror, through the roarings and tearings of a guilty accusing conscience, and the fore-thoughts of that horrible unsupportable torment they are so near unto. Now scaring dreams do terrify them, and fearfulness of the bottomless pit, and the burning lake below, doth surprise them; and some breaketh forth in the anguish of their despairing souls, "Who can dwell with devouring fire, who can inhabit everlasting burnings?" and however jovial and full of pleasure their life hath been, yet at their latter end they are utterly consumed with terrors. But mark the perfect man, and behold the upright, the end of that man is peace; whatsoever storms they have had in their passage through a rough sea, the wind blowing, and the waves roaring, and sometimes have been ready to sink through opposition and discouragement, sometimes have been overwhelmed with grief and doubtings, sometimes have been dashed upon the rocks of terror and perplexity; yet now they are come to the haven of death, the winds are hushed and still, the waves are smooth and silent, the storm is over, and there is a great calm upon their spirits; they are past the rocks, and are out of the danger they feared, when they are in the greatest danger of approaching death.

It was generally observed amongst us, that God's people who died by the plague amongst the rest, died with such peace and comfort, as Christians do not ordinarily arrive unto, except when they are called forth to suffer martyrdom for the testimony of Jesus Christ. Some who

have been full of doubts and fears, and complaints whilst they have lived and been well, have been filled with assurance, and comfort, and praise, and joyful expectation of glory, when they have lain on their death-beds by this disease. And not only more grown Christians, who have been more ripe for glory, have had these comforts, but also some younger Christians, whose acquaintance with the Lord hath been of no long standing.

I can speak something of mine own knowledge concerning some of my friends whom I have been withal: I shall instance only in the house where I lived. We were eight in family, three men, three youths, an old woman, and a maid, all which came to me, hearing of my stay in town, some to accompany me, others to help me. It was the latter end of September before any of us were touched; the young ones were not idle, but improved their time in praying and hearing, and were ready to receive instruction, and were strangely borne up against the fears of the disease and death, every day so familiar to the view. But at last we were visited, and the plague came in dreadfully upon us; the cup was put into our hand to drink, after a neighbour family had tasted it, with whom we had much sweet society in this time of sorrow. And first our maid was smitten, it began with a shivering and trembling in her flesh, and quickly seized on her spirits; it was a sad day, which I believe I shall never forget; I had been abroad to see a friend in the city, whose husband was newly dead of the plague, and she herself visited

with it; I came back to see another whose wife was dead of the plague, and he himself under apprehensions that he should die within a few hours: I came home, and the maid was on her death-bed, and another crying out for help, being left alone in a sweating fainting fit. What was an interest in Christ worth then? What a privilege to have a title to the kingdom of heaven?—

But I proceed. It was on the Monday when the maid was smitten; on Thursday she died full of tokens: on Friday one of the youths had a swelling in his groin; and on the Lord's day died with the marks of the distemper upon him: on the same day another youth did sicken, and on the Wednesday following he died: on the Thursday night his master fell sick of the disease, and within a day or two was full of spots, but strangely beyond his own, and others expectations, recovered. Thus did the plague follow us, and came upon us one by one; as Job's messengers came one upon the heels of another, so the messengers of death came so close one after another, in such dreadful manner, as if we must all follow one another immediately into the pit. Yet the Lord in mercy put a stop to it, and the rest were preserved. But that which was very remarkable in this visitation, was the carriage especially of those youths that died, who I believe were less troubled themselves, than others were troubled for them. The first youth that was visited, being asked by his father concerning the provision he had made for his death and eternity; told him, he hoped, if he died,

he should go to heaven ; being asked the grounds of his hopes, said, the Lord had enabled him to look beyond the world ; and when he was drawing near to his end, boldly inquired whether the tokens did yet appear, saying, that he was ready for them, and so a hopeful bud was nipped : but let not the father or the mother weep, and be in sadness for him, he is, I do not doubt, with their father, and his heavenly Father, which may be their comfort. 'The other also was a very sweet hopeful youth, so loving and towardly, that it could not choose but attract love from those that were acquainted with him ; but the grace he had gotten in those years, being I suppose under seventeen, did above all beautify him, and stand him in the greatest stead ; in his sickness he had much quiet and serenity upon his spirit, and lay so unconcerned at the thoughts of approaching death, that I confess I marvelled to see it ; the sting and fear of death were strangely taken out, through the hopes which he had of future glory ; yet once he told his mother he could desire to live a little longer, if it were the will of God. She asked him why he desired it ? He told her he desired to live till fire and faggot came ; and above all, he would fain die a martyr. She said, if he died now, he should have a crown : he answered, but if he died a martyr, he should have a more glorious crown ; yet he was not unwilling to receive his crown presently ; and went away with great peace and sweetness in his looks, to his Father's house ; and I could not blame the mother's grief for the loss of such an only son ;

but to be so immoderate, was not well: now I am sure it is time to dry up tears, and lay aside sorrows for the loss of him who hath been so long filled with joys in the heavenly mansions.

I might speak of the carriage of the master in his sickness, under the apprehensions of death, when the spots did appear on his body, he sent for me, and desired me to pray with him; told me he was now going home, desired me to write to his friends, and let them know, that it did not repent him of his stay in the city, though they had been so importunate with him to come away; but he had found so much of God's presence in his abode here, that he had no reason to repent: he told me where he would be buried, and desired me to preach his funeral sermon on Psalm xvi. ult. "In thy presence is fulness of joy, and at thy right hand there are pleasures for evermore." But the Lord raised him again beyond the expectation of himself, friends, or physician. Let him not forget God's mercies, and suffer too much worldly business to crowd in upon him, and choke the remembrance and sense of God's goodness so singular; but let him show by his singularity in meekness, humility, self-denial and love, zeal, and holy walking, that the Lord hath been singularly gracious unto him. But when I speak of home concerns, let me not forget to look abroad.

The plague now increaseth exceedingly, and fears there are amongst us, that within a while there will not be enough alive to bury the dead, and that the city of London will now be quite depopulated by this plague.

Now some ministers (formerly put out of their places, who did abide in the city, when most of ministers in places were fled and gone from the people, as well as from the disease, into the countries) seeing the people crowd so fast into the grave and eternity, who seemed to cry as they went, for spiritual physicians; and perceiving the churches to be open, and pulpits to be open, and finding pamphlets flung about the streets, of pulpits to be let, they judged that the law of God and nature did now dispense with, yea, command their preaching in public places, though the law of man (it is to be supposed in ordinary cases) did forbid them to do it. Surely if there had been a law that none should practise physic in the city, but such as were licensed by the College of Physicians; and most of those, when there was the greatest need of them, should in the time of the plague have retired into the country, and other physicians who had as good skill in physic, and no license, should have stayed amongst the sick, none would have judged it to have been breach of law, in such an extraordinary case, to endeavour by their practice, though without a license, to save the lives of those who by good care and physic were capable of a cure; and they could hardly have freed themselves from the guilt of murder of many bodies, if for a nicety of law in such a case of necessity, they should have neglected to administer physic. The case was the same with the unlicensed ministers which stayed, when so many of the licensed ones were gone, and as the need of souls was greater than the need

of bodies, the sickness of the one being more universal and dangerous than the sickness of the other; and the saving or losing of the soul, being so many degrees beyond the preservation or death of the body; so the obligation upon ministers was stronger, and the motive to preach, greater; and for them to have incurred the guilt of soul-murder, by their neglect to administer soul-physic, would have been more heinous and unanswerable: that they were called by the Lord into public, I suppose that few of any seriousness will deny, when the Lord did so eminently own them, in giving many seals of their ministry unto them.

Now they are preaching, and every sermon was unto them, as if they were preaching their last. Old Time seems now to stand at the head of the pulpit, with its great scythe; saying with a hoarse voice, work while it is called to-day, at night I will mow thee down. Grim Death seems to stand at the side of the pulpit, with its sharp arrow, saying, do thou shoot God's arrows, and I will shoot mine. The grave seems to lie open at the foot of the pulpit, with dust in her bosom, saying,

Louden thy cry
To God,
To men,
And now fulfil thy trust :
Here thou must lie,
Mouth stopp'd,
Breath gone,
And silent in the dust.

Ministers now had awakening calls to serious-

ness and fervour in their ministerial work; to preach on the side and brink of the pit, into which thousands were tumbling; to pray under such near views of eternity, into which many passengers were daily entering, might be a means to stir up the spirit more than ordinary.

Now there is such a vast concourse of people in the churches where these ministers are to be found, that they cannot many times come near the pulpit doors for the press, but are forced to climb over the pews to them: and such a face is now seen in the assemblies, as seldom was seen before in London; such eager looks, such open ears, such greedy attention, as if every word would be eaten which dropped from the mouths of the ministers.

If you ever saw a drowning man catch at a rope, you may guess how eagerly many people did catch at the Word, when they were ready to be overwhelmed by this overflowing scourge, which was passing through the city; when death was knocking at so many doors; and God was crying aloud by his judgments; and ministers were now sent to knock, cry aloud, and lift up their voice like a trumpet: then, then the people began to open the ear and the heart, which were fast shut and barred before. How did they then hearken as for their lives, as if every sermon were their last, as if death stood at the door of the church, and would seize upon them so soon as they came forth; as if the arrows which flew so thick in the city would strike them before they could get to their houses; as if they were immediately to appear before the bar of that God,

who by his ministers was now speaking unto them! Great were the impressions which the Word then made upon many hearts, beyond the power of man to effect, and beyond what the people before ever felt, as some of them have declared. When sin is ript up and reprovèd! O the tears that slide down from the eyes, when the judgments of God are denounced. O the tremblings which are upon the conscience, when the Lord Jesus Christ is made known and proffered! O the longing desires and openings of heart unto him, when the riches of the Gospel are displayed, and the promises of the covenant of grace are set forth and applied! O the inward burnings and sweet flames which were in the affections! Now the net is cast, and many fishes are taken, the pool is moved by the angel, and many leprous spirits, and sin-sick souls, are cured; many were brought to the birth, and I hope not a few were born again, and brought forth: a strange moving there was upon the hearts of multitudes in the city; and I am persuaded that many were brought over effectually unto a closure with Jesus Christ; whereof some died by the plague with willingness and peace; others remain steadfast in God's ways unto this day; but convictions (I believe) many hundreds had, if not thousands, which I wish that none have stifled, and "with the dog returned to their vomit," and with the sow, "have wallowed again in the mire" of their former sins. The work was the more great, because the instruments made use of were more obscure and unlikely; whom the Lord did make choice of the rather, that the glory

by ministers and people might be ascribed in full unto himself.

About the beginning of these ministers preaching, especially after their first Fast together, the Lord begins to remit and turn his hand, and cause some abatement of the disease.

From 7155 which died of the plague in one week, there is a decrease to 5538 the next, which was at the latter end of September; the next week a farther decrease to 4929, the next to 4327, the next to 2665, the next to 1421, the next to 1031; then there was an increase the first week in November to 1414, but it fell the week after to 1050, and the week after to 652, and the week after that to 338; and so lessened more and more to the end of the year. Then we had a bill of 97,306 which died of all diseases, which was an increase of more than 79,000, over what it was the year before; and the number of them which died by the plague was reckoned to be 68,596 this year; when there were but 6 which the bill speaks of who died the year before.

Now the citizens, who had dispersed themselves abroad into the countries, because of the contagion, think of their old houses and trades, and begin to return, though with fearfulness and trembling, lest some of the after-drops of the storms should fall upon them; and O that many of them had not brought back their old hearts and sins, which they carried away with them! O that there had been a general repentance and reformation, and returning to the Lord that had smitten the city! The Lord gave them leisure and vacation from their trades for the one necessary

thing; which had they improved, and generally mourned for sin, which brought the plague upon the city, had they humbly and earnestly sought the Lord to turn from his fierce anger, which was kindled against London, it might have prevented the desolating judgment by fire: but alas! how many spent their time of leisure in toys and trifles, at best about feeding and preserving their bodies, but no time in serious minding the salvation of their souls; and if some were a little awakened with fear, whilst the plague raged so greatly, and they looked upon themselves to be in such danger; yet when they apprehended the danger to be over, they dropped asleep faster than before: still they are the same or worse than formerly: they that were drunken, are drunken still; they that were filthy, are filthy still; and they that were unjust and covetous, do still persevere in their sinful course; cozening, and lying, and swearing, and cursing, and Sabbath breaking, and pride, and envy, and flesh-pleasing, and the like God-displeasing, and God-provoking sins (of which in the catalogue of London sins) do abound in London, as if there were no signification in God's judgments by the plague; some return to their houses, and follow their worldly business, and work as hard as they can to fetch up the time they have lost, without minding and labouring to improve by the judgment, and God's wonderful preservation of them; others return, and sin as hard as they can, having been taken off for a while, from those opportunities and free liberties for sin, which they had before; most began now to sit down at rest in their houses

when the summer was come, and the plague did not return, and they bring back all their goods they had carried into the country because of the plague; they did not imagine they should be forced to remove them again so soon.

Thus concerning the great Plague in London.

SECT. VI.

I PROCEED next to give a narration of the judgment of the Fire; in which I shall be more brief, it being dispatched in fewer days, than the plague was in months.

It was the 2d of September 1666, that the anger of the Lord was kindled against London, and the fire began: it began in a baker's house in Pudding Lane, by Fish-street Hill: and now the Lord is making London "like a fiery oven in the time of his anger," Psal. xxi. 9, and in his wrath doth devour and swallow up our habitations. It was in the depth and dead of the night, when most doors and senses were locked up in the city, that the fire doth break forth and appear abroad; and like a mighty giant refreshed with wine, doth awake and arm itself, quickly gathers strength, when it had made havock of some houses, rusheth down the hill towards the bridge, crosseth Thames Street, invadeth Magnus Church at the Bridge-Foot, and though that

church were so great, yet it was not a sufficient barricado against this conqueror; but having scaled and taken this fort, it shooteth flames with so much the greater advantage into all places round about; and a great building of houses upon the bridge is quickly thrown to the ground; then the conqueror being stayed in his course at the bridge, marcheth back towards the city again, and runs along with great noise and violence through Thames Street, westward, where, having such combustible matter in its teeth, and such a fierce wind upon its back, it prevails with little resistance, unto the astonishment of the beholders.

My business is not to speak of the hand of man, which was made use of in the beginning and carrying on of this fire. The beginning of the fire at such a time, when there had been so much hot weather, which had dried the houses, and made them the more fit for fuel; the beginning of it in such a place, where there were so many timber-houses, and the shops filled with so much combustible matter; and the beginning of it just when the wind did blow so fiercely upon that corner towards the rest of the city, which then was like tinder to the sparks; this doth smell of a popish design, hatched in the same place where the Gunpowder-plot was contrived, only that this was more successful. The world sufficiently knows how correspondent this is to popish principles and practices; those, who could intentionally blow up king and parliament by gunpowder, might (without any scruple of their kinds of conscience) actually burn an heretical

city (as they count it) into ashes: for besides the dispensations they can have from his Holiness, (or rather his Wickedness) the pope, for the most horrid crimes of murder, incest, and the like; it is not unlikely, but they count such an action as this meritorious, (in their kind of merit) which, in the issue, they will find to merit the flames of eternal fire, instead of a crown of glory, which I wonder that in their way they can have the least hopes of: I believe that the people will now take more heed of them and their ways; and instead of promoting their cause, I hope that a contrary effect is produced; and that the before indifferency of a generation more newly sprung up, who did not know them, is now turned into loathing and detestation of such a religion, as can allow of such practices. My work is not to declare what hath been proved against the papists before the honourable committee of parliament appointed to enquire into their insolencies; and the proofs which have been given in, concerning the fire, and who have been accessory thereunto.

No; I would rather endeavour to turn people's eyes from men to God; for whoever were the instruments, God was the author of this evil, which hath come upon us; there being no evil in the city (that is, evil of punishment) which the Lord as a righteous, and the supreme Judge, doth not inflict. And surely more of the extraordinary hand of God, than of any men, did appear in the burning of the City of London. God could have prevented men, by discovering their plots (as he did that of the gunpowder-

treason) before they had taken effect. God could have directed and given a blessing unto means for the quenching of it when it was first kindled. God, who hath the winds in his fist, could have gathered in the wind, and laid it asleep; or so turned it the other way, that it should have been a defence to the city: or God, who hath the clouds at his command, and the bottles of heaven in his hand, could have gathered his thick clouds together, and squeezed them; opened his bottles, and poured down rain in abundance upon the city; so that if the wind had blown as it did, it should have blown water upon the fire, which would quickly have put it out. But the heavens at that time were brass, no showering clouds to be seen: the fire begins, is quickly taken notice of, though in the midst of the night; fire, fire, fire, doth resound the streets; many citizens start out of their sleep, look out of their windows, some dress themselves, and run to the place. The Lord Mayor of the city comes with his officers, a confusion there is, counsel is taken away; and London, so famous for wisdom and dexterity, can now find neither brains nor hands to prevent its ruin. The hand of God was in it; the decree was come forth: London must now fall; and who could prevent it? No wonder when so many pillars are removed, if the building tumbles; the prayers, tears, and faith, which sometimes London hath had, might have quenched the violence of the fire; might have opened heaven for rain, and driven back the wind: but now the fire gets mastery, and burns dreadfully: and God with his

great bellows blows upon it, which makes it spread quickly, and go on with such force and rage, overturning all so furiously, that the whole city is brought into jeopardy of desolation. That night most of the Londoners had taken their last sleep in their houses; they little thought it would be so when they went into their beds; they did not in the least suspect, when the doors of their ears were unlocked, and the casements of their eyes were opened in the morning, to hear of such an enemy's invading the city, and that they should see him, with such fury, enter the doors of their houses, break into every room, and look out of their casements with such a threatening countenance; as it is said, Lament. iv. 12. "The inhabitants would not have believed that the adversary should have entered the gates of Jerusalem:" so the inhabitants of the city, would not have believed that the fire should have entered and prevailed to burn London to the ground.

That which made the ruin the more dismal, was, that it was begun on the Lord's day morning; never was there the like Sabbath in London; some churches were in flames that day; and God seems to come down, and to preach himself in them, as he did in Mount Sinai, when the Mount burned with fire; such warm preaching those churches never had; such lightning dreadful sermons never were before delivered in London. In other churches ministers were preaching their farewell sermons, and people were hearing with quaking and astonishment: instead of a holy rest, which Christians have taken on this day,

there is a tumultuous hurrying about the streets towards the place that burned, and more tumultuous hurrying upon the spirits of those that sat still, and had only the notice of the ear, of the quick and strange spreading of the fire.

Now the train-bands are up in arms, watching at every quarter for outlandish men, because of the general fears and jealousies, and rumours that fire-balls were thrown into houses by several of them, to help on and provoke the too furious flames. Now goods are hastily removed from the lower parts of the city; and the body of the people begin to retire, and draw upwards, as the people did from the tabernacles of Corah, Dathan, and Abiram, when the earth did cleave asunder and swallow them up: Numb. xvi. 27. 31, 32, or rather as Lot drew out from his house in Sodom before it was consumed by fire from heaven, Gen. xix. Yet some hopes were retained on the Lord's day, that the fire would be extinguished, especially by them who lived in the remote parts; they could scarcely imagine that the fire a mile off should be able to reach their houses.

But the evening draws on, and now the fire is more visible and dreadful: instead of the black curtains of the night, which used to be spread over the city, now the curtains are yellow, the smoke that arose from the burning parts, seemed like so much flame in the night, which being blown upon the other parts by the wind, the whole city at some distance seemed to be on fire. Now hopes begin to sink, and a general consternation seizeth upon the spirits of people: little sleep is taken in London this night; the amaze-

ment, which the eye and ear doth effect upon the spirit, doth either dry up, or drive away the vapour which used to bind up the senses: some are at work to quench the fire with water, others endeavour to stop its course, by pulling down of houses; but all to no purpose: if it be a little allayed, or beaten down, or put to a stand in some places, it is but a very little while; it quickly recruits and recovers its force; it leaps and mounts, and makes the more furious onset, drives back its opposers, snatches their weapons out of their hands, seizes upon the water-houses and engines, burns them, spoils them, and makes them unfit for service. Some are upon their knees in the night, pouring out tears before the Lord, interceding for poor London, in the day of its calamity; but alas, I fear there were too few weeping Jeremiahs at the throne of grace, too few Moseses to stand in the gap; too few Jacobs to wrestle with the Lord, and hang about his arm. London's sins were too great, and God's anger against the city was too hot, so easily and presently to be quenched and allayed; and if by the intercession of some, a mitigation be obtained, so that the Lord doth not stir up all his wrath, utterly to destroy the place as he did Sodom and Gomorrah; yet none can prevail to call back that wrath, and reverse that decree which is gone forth against the city: the time of London's fall is come; the fire hath received its commission from God to burn down the city, and therefore all attempts to hinder it are in vain.

On the Lord's day night the fire had run as far as Garlick-hithe, in Thames-street; and had

crept up into Cannon-street, and levelled it with the ground, and still is making forward by the water side, and upward to the brow of the hill, on which the city was built.

On Monday Gracechurch-street is all in flames, with Lombard-street on the left hand, and part of Fenchurch-street on the right, the fire working (though not so fast) against the wind that way: before it were pleasant and stately houses, behind it ruinous and desolate heaps. The burning then was in fashion of a bow, a dreadful bow it was, such as mine eyes never before had seen; a bow which had God's arrow in it with a flaming point: it was a shining bow, not like that in the cloud, which brings water with it, and withal signifies God's covenant, not to destroy the world any more with water: but it was a bow which had fire in it, which signified God's anger, and his intention to destroy London with fire.

Now the flames break in upon Cornhill, that large and spacious street; and quickly cross the way by the train of wood that lay in the streets untaken away, which had been pulled down from houses to prevent its spreading, and so they lick the whole street as they go; they mount up to the top of the highest houses; they descend down to the bottom of the lowest vaults and cellars; and march along on both sides of the way, with such a roaring noise, as never was heard in the city of London; no stately building so great as to resist their fury; the Royal Exchange itself, the glory of the merchants, is now invaded with much violence; and when once the fire was entered, how quickly did it run

round the galleries, filling them with flames ; then descendeth the stairs, compasseth the walks, giving forth flaming volleys, and filled the court with sheets of fire ; by and by, down fall all the kings upon their faces, and the greatest part of the stone building after them, (the founder's statue only remaining) with such a noise, as was dreadful and astonishing.

Then, then the city did shake indeed, and the inhabitants did tremble, and flew away in great amazement from their houses, lest the flames should devour them. Rattle, rattle, rattle, was the noise which the fire struck upon the ear round about, as if there had been a thousand iron chariots beating upon the stones ; and if you opened your eye to the opening of the streets, where the fire was come, you might see in some places whole streets at once in flames, that issued forth, as if they had been so many great forges from the opposite windows, which folding together, were united into one great flame throughout the whole street, and then you might see the houses tumble, tumble, tumble, from one end of the street to the other with a great crash, leaving the foundations open to the view of the Heavens.

Now fearfulness and terror doth surprise the citizens of London ; confusion and astonishment doth fall upon them at this unheard of, unthought of judgment. It would have grieved the heart of an unconcerned person, to see the rueful looks, the pale cheeks, the tears trickling down from the eyes, (where the greatness of sorrow and amazement could give leave for such a vent,) the smiting of the breast ; the wringing of the

hands ; to hear the sighs and groans, the doleful and weeping speeches of the distressed citizens, when they were bringing forth their wives, (some from their child-bed) and their little ones (some from their sick-bed) out of their houses, and sending them into the countries, or somewhere into the fields with their goods. Now the hopes of London are gone, their heart is sunk ; now there is a general remove in the city, and that in a greater hurry than before the plague ; their goods being in greater danger by the fire, than their persons were by the sickness. Scarcely are some returned, but they must remove again, and not as before, now without any more hopes of ever returning, and living in those houses any more.

Now carts, and drays, and coaches, and horses, as many as could have entrance into the city, were loaden, and any money is given for help ; £5. £10. £20. £30. for a cart, to bear forth into the fields some choice things, which were ready to be consumed ; and some of the countries had the conscience to accept of the highest price, which the citizens did then offer in their extremity ; I am mistaken if such money do not burn worse, than the fire out of which it was raked. Now casks of wine, and oil, and other commodities are tumbled along, and the owners shove as much of their goods as they can towards the gates : every one now becomes a porter to himself, and scarcely a back, either of man or woman, that hath strength, but had a burden on it in the street ; it was very sad to see such throngs of poor citizens coming in and going forth from the unburnt

parts, heavy loaden with some pieces of their goods, but more heavy loaden with weighty grief and sorrow of heart, so that it is wonderful they did not quite sink under these burdens.

Monday night was a dreadful night, when the wings of the night had shadowed the light of the heavenly bodies, there was no darkness of night in London, for the fire shines now round about with a fearful blaze, which yielded such light in the streets as it had been the sun at noon-day.

Now the fire having wrought backward strangely against the wind to Billingsgate, &c. along Thames-street eastward, runs up the hill to Tower-street, and having marched on from Gracechurch-street, making further progress in Fenchurch-street, and having spread its wing beyond Queen-hithe in Thames-street westward, mounts up from the water side through Dowgate, and Old Fish-street into Watling-street: but the great fury of the fire was in the broader streets; in the midst of the night it was come down Cornhill, and laid it in the dust; and runs along by the Stocks, and there meets with another fire, which came down Threadneedle-street; a little further with another, which came up from Wallbrook: a little further with another, which comes up from Bucklersbury; and all these four joining together, break into one bright flame at the corner of Cheapside, with such a dazzling light, and burning heat, and roaring noise by the fall of so many houses together, that was very amazing; and though it was something stopt in its swift course at Mercers' Chapel, yet with great force in a while, it conquers the place, and burns

through it, and then with great rage proceedeth forward in Cheapside.

On Tuesday was the fire burning up the very bowels of London; Cheapside is all in a light fire in a few hours time; many fires meeting there, as in the centre; from Soper-lane, Bow-lane, Bread-street, Friday-street, and Old-change, the fire comes up almost together, and breaks furiously into the broad street, and most of that side of the way was together in flames, a dreadful spectacle! and then partly by the fire which came down by Mercers' Chapel, partly by the fall of the houses across the way, the other side is quickly kindled, and doth not stand long after it. Now the fire gets into Blackfriars, and so continues its course by the water, and makes up toward Paul's church, on that side, and Cheapside fire besets the great building on this side, and the church, though all of stone outward, though naked of houses about it, and though so high above all buildings in the city, yet within a while doth yield to the violent assaults of the conquering flames, and strangely takes fire at the top; now the lead melts and runs down, as if it had been snow before the sun; and the great beams and massy stones, with a great noise fall on the pavement, and break through into Faith Church underneath, and great flakes of stone scale and peel off strangely from the side of the walls. The conqueror having got this high fort, darts its flames round about; now Paternoster-row, Newgate-market, the Old Bailey, and Ludgate-hill have submitted themselves to the devouring fire, which, with wonder-

ful speed rusheth down the hill into Fleet-street. Now Cheapside fire marcheth along Ironmonger-lane, Old Jury, Lawrence-lane, Milk-street, Wood-street, Gutter-lane, Foster-lane; now it runs along Lothbury, Cateaton-street, &c. From Newgate-market, it assaults Christ-church and conquers that great building, and burns through Martin's-lane towards Aldersgate, and all about so furiously, as if it would not leave a house standing upon the ground.

Now horrible flakes of fire mount up the sky, and the yellow smoke of London ascendeth up towards heaven, like the smoke of a great furnace: a smoke so great, as darkened the sun at noon-day, (if at any time the sun peeped forth, it looked red like blood,) the cloud of smoke was so great, that travellers did ride at noon-day some miles together in the shadow thereof, though there were no other cloud beside to be seen in the sky.

And if Monday night was dreadful, Tuesday night was more dreadful, when far the greatest part of the city was consumed: many thousands who on Saturday had houses convenient in the city, both for themselves, and to entertain others, now have not where to lay their head; and the fields are the only receptacle, which they can find for themselves and their goods; most of the late inhabitants of London lie all night in the open air, with no other canopy over them, but that of the heavens. The fire is still making towards them, and threateneth the suburbs; it was amazing to see, how it had spread itself several miles in compass; and amongst other

things that night, the sight of Guildhall was a fearful spectacle, which stood the whole body of it together in view, for several hours together, after the fire had taken it, without flames, (I suppose because the timber was such solid oak) in a bright shining coal, as if it had been a palace of gold, or a great building of burnished brass.

On Wednesday morning, when people expected that the suburbs would be burnt, as well as the city, and with speed were preparing their flight, as well as they could, with their luggage into the countries, and neighbouring villages; then the Lord hath pity on poor London; his bowels begin to relent, his heart is turned within him, and he "stays his rough wind in the day of the east wind;" his fury begins to be allayed: he hath a remnant of people in London, and there shall a remnant of houses escape; the wind now is hushed; the commission of the fire is withdrawing, and it burns so gently, even where it meets with no opposition, that it was not hard to be quenched, in many places with a few hands: now the citizens begin to gather a little heart, and encouragement in their endeavours to quench the fire. A check it had at Leaden-hall, by that great building; a stop it had in Bishopsgate-street, Fenchurch-street, Lime-street, Mark-lane, and towards the Tower; one means under God, was the blowing up of houses with gunpowder. Now it is stayed in Lothbury, Broad-street, Coleman-street; towards the gates it burnt, but not with any great violence; at the Temple also it is stayed, and in Holborn, where it had got no great footing; and when once the

fire was got under, it was kept under, and on Thursday the flames were extinguished.

But on Wednesday night, when the people late of London, now of the fields, hoped to get a little rest on the ground, where they had spread their beds, a more dreadful fear falls upon them than they had before, through a rumour that the French were coming armed against them to cut their throats, and spoil them of what they had saved out of the fire; they were now naked and weak, and in an ill-condition to defend themselves, and the hearts, especially of the females, do quake and tremble, and are ready to die within them; yet many citizens having lost their houses, and almost all that they had, are fired with rage and fury; and they begin to stir up themselves like lions, or like bears bereaved of their whelps, and now Arm, arm, arm, doth resound the fields and suburbs with a great noise. We may guess at the distress and perplexity of the people this night, which was something alleviated when the falseness of the alarm was perceived.

Thus fell great London, that ancient city! that populous city! London! which was the queen city of the land, and as famous as most cities in the world; none so famous for the gospel and zealous profession of the reformed religion. And yet how is London departed like smoke, and her glory laid in the dust! How is her destruction come, which no man thought of, and her desolation in a moment! How do the nations about gaze and wonder! How doth the whole land tremble at the noise of her fall! How

do her citizens droop and hang down their heads; her women and virgins weep, and sit in the dust! Oh, the paleness that now sits upon the cheeks! the astonishment and confusion that covers the face, the dismal apprehensions that arise in the minds of most concerning the dreadful consequences which are likely to be of this fall of London! How is the pride of London stained, and beauty spoiled, her arm broken, and strength departed, her riches almost gone, and treasures so much consumed! The head now is sick, and the whole body faint; the heart is wounded, and every other part is sensible of its stroke; never was England in greater danger of being made a prey to a foreign power, than since the firing and fall of this city, which had the strength and treasure of the nation in it. How is London ceased, that rich city! that joyous city! One corner indeed is left; but more than as many houses as were within the walls, are turned into ashes.

The merchants now have left the Royal Exchange; the buyers and sellers have now forsaken the streets: Gracechurch-street, Cornhill, Cheapside, Newgate-market, and the like places, which used sometime to have throngs of traffickers, now are become empty of inhabitants; and instead of the stately houses which stood there last summer, now they lie this winter in ruinous heaps. The glory of London is now fled away like a bird, the trade of London is shattered and broken to pieces, her delights also are vanished, and pleasant things laid waste: now no chaunting to the sound of the viol, and dancing to the

sweet music of other instruments; now no drinking wine in bowls, and stretching upon the beds of lust: now no excess of wine and banquettings; no feasts in halls and curious dishes; no amorous looks, and wanton dalliances; no ruffling silks, and costly dresses; these things in that place are at an end. But if houses for sin alone were sunk, and fuel for lust only were consumed, it would not be so much: but the houses also for God's worship, (which formerly were a bulwark against the fire; partly through the walls about them, partly through the fervent prayers within them,) now are devoured by the flames, and the habitations of many who truly fear God, have not escaped: and in the places where God hath been served, and his servants have lived, now nettles are growing, owls are screeching, thieves and cut-throats are lurking: a sad face there is now in the ruinous part of London, and terrible hath the voice of the Lord been, which hath been crying, yea, roaring in the city by these dreadful judgments of the plague and fire, which he hath brought upon us.

Thus you have the narration of the judgments themselves:

SECT. VII.

Concerning the Cause of these judgments; why hath the Lord spoken by such terrible things in the city of London?

In giving an account hereof, I shall make use of the second Doctrine observed from the words:

Doct. 2. *That when God speaks most terribly he doth answer most righteously.*

They are God's judgments, and therefore they must needs be righteous judgments: can there be unrighteousness in God? No, in no wise; for how then could he be God? How then "could he judge the world? Let God be true, and every man a liar," Rom. iii. 5, 6. Let God be righteous, and all the world unrighteous; for light may more easily depart from the sun, and heat be separated from the fire, and the whole creation may more easily drop into nothing, than God cease to be just and righteous, in the severest judgments which he doth inflict upon the children of men.

If any profane mockers do reply against God, and reflect upon his righteousness and goodness towards his own people, because these judgments have fallen so sore upon London, the glory of the land, yea, of the world, for the number of godly persons (as in scoff they call them) which dwell in it: if God were so righteous and favourable to the godly, would he bend his bow and shoot so many arrows amongst them as he did in the visitation by the plague, whilst he suffered so many notoriously wicked persons to escape? Would he send the fire to consume so many habitations of the godly, whilst the houses of the most vicious and vile were preserved? I shall labour to stop the mouths of such who are ready to open them against the King of heaven, by proposing to consideration these following particulars.

1. "That God's way is sometimes in the sea,

and his paths in the great waters; and his footsteps are not known," Psal. lxxvii. 19. "That his judgments are unsearchable, and his ways past finding out," Rom. xi. 33. And that even then "he is righteous in all his ways, and holy in all his works," Psal. cxlv. 17. "And when clouds and darkness are round about him, righteousness and judgment are the habitation of his throne," Psal. xcvii. 2. And when "his judgments are a great deep, his righteousness is like the great mountains," Psal. xxxvi. 6. We do not understand all the mysteries of nature, neither are we acquainted with all the mysteries of state; and if there be some mysteries in God's way of governing the world, and distributing temporal mercies and judgments, which we do not apprehend in every thing the meaning of, and cannot so fully trace God's righteousness and goodness therein, let us say it is because our eyes are shut, and that we are covered with darkness; therefore let us shut our mouths too, and seal up our lips with silence, not daring in the least to utter any thing which may derogate from these attributes in God, which are as inviolable and unchangeable as his very being: this might be said, if the reason were more abstruse than it is.

2. But secondly, the reason of God's judgments and righteousness therein, with the salve of his goodness towards his own people, may be apprehended, if we consider,

First, that these judgments of plague and fire, are both of them national judgments.

1. The judgment of the plague was national;

inasmuch as London was the chief city; inasmuch as the King's court was here, and most countries had relations here: and all countries had concerns here: moreover the plague was not only in London and Westminster, and places near adjacent; but it was dispersed into the countries at a farther distance, as Cambridge, Norwich, Colchester, and other towns, where it raged either the same or the next year, as much proportionably as it did in London.

2. The judgment of the fire, which burned down only the City, and left Westminster and the suburbs standing, and did not reach into the countries, yet was a national judgment, because London was the metropolis of the land; because the beauty, riches, strength, and glory of the whole kingdom lay in London; and it was not the inhabitants of the city who alone did suffer by this fire, but the whole land, more or less, do and will feel the smart hereof.

Secondly, These judgments then being national, it is not unreasonable to say, that national sins have been the cause of them; and if so, we may readily find a reason of God's righteousness in these proceedings, when the sins of the land are so obvious and so heinous. He is a great stranger in England that doth not know, how wickedness hath abounded in these later years; his eyes must be fast shut, who doth not see what a deluge of profaneness and impiety hath broken in like a mighty torrent, and overflowed the land; that hath not taken notice of those barefaced villanies which have been committed amongst us, which is a great question whether

any ages before us could parallel: we read in Scripture of Sodom and Gomorrah, and the wickedness sometime of Jerusalem: profane histories and travellers make mention of Rome, Venice, Naples, Paris, and other places very wicked; but who can equal England, which calls itself Christian and Protestant, for such desperate and audacious affronts and indignities which have been offered to the highest Majesty by the gallants (as they are called) of our times? How was hall, as it were, broke loose; and how were men worse than those which, in our Saviour's time, were possessed with devils, who cut themselves with stones, and tore their own flesh; even such who went about like so many hell-hounds and incarnate devils, cursing and banning, swearing and blaspheming, inventing new oaths, and glorying therein, delighting to tear the name of God, and to spit forth their rancour and malice in his very face? And can we then be at a loss for a reason of God's righteousness in his thus punishing England, by beginning thus furiously with London? When were there so many atheists about London, and in the land, who denied the very being of God; when so many gentlemen (who looked upon it as one piece of their breeding to cast off all sentiments of a Deity) did walk our streets, and no arguments would work them to a persuasion of the truth of God's being, shall we wonder, if the Lord appears in a terrible way, that he might be known by the judgments which he executeth? When so many denied the Divine authority of the Scriptures, the very foundation of our Christian faith, and

reckoned themselves, by their principles, amongst Turks, Pagans, and other infidels, however, they called themselves Christians, and hereby put such an affront upon the Lord Jesus Christ, the only Son of the Most High God; is it strange that the Lord should speak so terribly, to shew his indignation? When there was such blowing at, and endeavours to put out that light which would shew men the way to heaven; such hatred and opposition against the power of godliness; when the name of a saint was matter of derision and scorn; when there was such wallowing in filthy fornication and adultery, in swinish drunkenness and intemperance; when such oppression, bribery, such malice, cruelty, such unheard of wickedness, and hideous impiety, grown to such a height in the land, may we not reasonably think that such persons as were thus guilty, being in the ship, were a great cause of the storm of God's anger, which hath made such a shipwreck?

The plague indeed, when it was come, made little discrimination between the bodies of the righteous and the bodies of the wicked; no more doth grace; the difference is more inward and deep; it is the soul begins to be glorified hereby; and hath the seed of eternal life put into it, when it doth pass the new birth; but the body is not changed with the soul; the body remains as it was, as frail, and weak, and exposed to diseases and death, as before, and as the body of any wicked person; and therefore the infectious disease of the plague coming into a populous city, the bodies of the righteous, amongst the rest,

receive the contagion, and they fall in the common calamity: there is a difference in the manner of their death, and a difference in their place and state after death, as hath been spoken of before, but the kind of death is the same.

But the fire doth make no discrimination between the houses of the godly, and the houses of the ungodly; they are all made of the same combustible matter, and are enkindled as bodies infected, one by another: indeed the godly have God to be their habitation, and they are citizens of the New Jerusalem, which is above; a city which hath foundations, whose builder and maker is God; an abiding city, which the fire cannot reach; and their persons are secured from the flames of eternal fire in hell; but they have no promise nor security for the preservation of their houses from fire here in this world. The judgments of the plague and fire being sent, work according to their nature, without distinguishing the righteous.

But if we further enquire into the reason, Why the plague was sent the last year, and such a plague as hath not been known these forty years; which raged so sorely, when there was no such sultriness of weather (as in other years) to increase it; and why the fire was sent this year, and such a fire as neither we, nor our forefathers ever knew, neither do we read of in any history of any so great in any place in time of peace: what shall we say was the cause of these extraordinary national judgments, but the extraordinary national sins. It was an extraordinary hand of God which brought the plague, of which

no natural cause can be assigned why it should be so great that year more than in former years, but that sin was grown to greater height; and that a fire should prevail against all attempts to quench it, to burn down the city, and that judgment just following upon the heels of the other; what reason can be assigned, but that England's sins, and God's displeasure have been extraordinary; God is a God of patience, and it is not a light thing will move him; he is slow to anger, it must needs be then some great provocation which makes him so furious; he is highly offended, before he lifts up his hand; and he is exceedingly incensed, before his anger breaks forth into such a flame. For my part, I verily think, if it had not been for the crying abominations of the times, which are not chiefly to be limited to the city of London; and if the means of God's prescription, according to the rule of his Word, which England sometime could, had by England been made use of, that both plague and fire had been prevented.

Thirdly, moreover, it may be said that some particular persons, by some more peculiar and notorious sins in the city, may have provoked the Lord to bring punishment upon the whole place, if the land were not so generally profane and wicked. The heathen could say, "A whole city may be punished for the wickedness of one man;" yea, we read of David, though so good a man, yet when he numbered the people (a small sin in comparison with the sins of some others in our days) God was provoked to send such a dreadful plague, not on himself, but upon his people, that

there died 70,000 men by it in three days; and David said, "I have sinned and done wickedly; but these sheep what have they done?" 2 Sam. xxiv. 10, 18.

Fourthly, If it be enquired how God's mercy to his people doth appear, when these judgments have fallen so heavy upon many of them?

I answer,

1. Those of God's own people who have fallen by the plague, are received to greater grace and mercy in heaven, than here they were capable of; and they are moreover delivered from evil to come, which hath since, and may further come upon us.

2. Those whose houses have fallen by the fire, the Lord could, and confident I am, the Lord hath made them greater gainers another way: they have lost, it may be, much in temporal things; but they are, or may be (if they be not wanting to themselves) gainers of spiritual things, which are of a higher and more excellent nature. I have known and heard of many of God's people whose houses are burnt and goods spoiled, who have taken the loss with so much cheerfulness, humility, meekness, patience, contentment, and thankfulness, that any thing was saved, if it were only their lives, that it hath been my wonder and joy; to gain such a spirit, hath more of good, than the loss of all external enjoyments hath of evil.

3. Further, If these judgments have fallen upon God's people, we must know that they have their sins, which have deserved them; possibly some have begun to comply with the wicked in their

wicked ways: it may be they were grown more loose in their walking, and formal in the service of God, and their hearts more set on the world; of which sins more largely, when I come to speak of the sins of the city: and the sins of God's people have more heinous aggravations than the sins of the wicked, being committed against clearer light, dearer love, sweeter mercies, stronger obligations, and therefore provoke God the more to wrath; therefore he threateneth his own people, especially, to punish them when they transgress, Amos iii. 2: "You only have I known of all the families of the earth, and therefore I will punish you for your iniquities."

4. Besides, they have need of awakening judgments to rouse them, and humble them for sin; to loosen and wean them from the world; and it is in love and faithfulness, that God doth inflict such judgments upon them.

5. We must remember that it is God's usual course to begin with his own house, 1 Pet. iv. 17. "Judgment begins at the house of God."

Fifthly, To conclude, Do any of the ungodly question God's righteousness, because in these common calamities they have hitherto survived and escaped?

1. It is but an ill requital, and ill use which they make of God's patience and goodness, which he hath exercised towards them, that hereby he might lead them unto repentance, Rom. ii. 4, 5.

2. Let them stay awhile, and God will answer them himself, and give them an experimental conviction of his righteous judgments, 1 Pet.

iv. 17, 18. "If judgment begin at the house of God, what shall the end be of them that obey not the Gospel? and if the righteous scarcely be saved, where shall the ungodly and sinners appear?" We read, Psalm lxxv. 8. "Of a cup of red wine in the hand of the Lord;" he may give his people to drink the top of it; but the most bitter and dreggish part, which is at the bottom, the wicked shall wring forth and drink; if God whip his children with rods, he will scourge his enemies with scorpions.

I am persuaded that the notoriously ungodly of this generation, will not go out of this world without some remarkable temporal judgment; and that the Lord will make them feel something even here, what an evil thing and a bitter it is so audaciously to fly in the face of the great God, by their hideous oaths and blasphemies; by their horrid wickedness and abominations; whereby they do, as it were, challenge God to do his worst against them; and when God doth draw forth his glittering sword, and make ready his sharp arrow upon the string; when God doth clothe himself with fury as with a garment, and his hand doth take hold on vengeance: when their iniquities are grown fully ripe, and the day of their visitation and recompence is come, how then will these sinners of England be afraid? and what amazing terror will there then surprise this vile generation? "Can their hearts endure, or their hands be strong in the day that the Lord shall deal with them?" Ezek. xxii. 14. Then the Lord will roar from his holy habitation with such a terrible voice, as shall make their ears to

tingle, their hearts to quake and tremble ; he will roar like a lion, and tear them in pieces, when there shall be none to deliver. If the shaking of his rod hath moved them, and the beginning of his judgments, which he hath executed upon others, hath affrighted them, what will their behaviour be when the scourge is laid upon their own backs, and judgment shall fall upon their own heads ! Surely the judgments intended purposely for the most ungodly, are not yet come ; yet, as they are like to be exceeding great, because more of pure and unmixed wrath will accompany them ; so they are like to be very near, because they are filling up the measure of their wickedness so fast, and they seem to be arrived even to the uttermost of sin ; surely their judgment doth neither linger nor slumber, but is upon the wing, hastening towards them ; surely the arm of the Lord is awakened, and lifted up on high ; and though infinite patience doth hold it up a little while, to try whether the judgments already executed upon others, before their eyes will work any good effect upon them, so as to awaken them and stop them, and turn them from their evil ways ; yet, if they proceed in their sinful course, his arm, I am persuaded, will come down with such force and fury upon them, that their destruction shall be remarkable to all that are round about them : and I have much of that persuasion, that the Lord will, as it were, hang up many of the villains of our times, who have been guilty of such treachery and rebellion against the great King of heaven, as it were in chains, and make their punishment here as no-

torious as their sins have been, that the whole world may hear and fear, and take heed of such vile practices. I suppose they may not now expect it, nor fear it, any more than the whole world did their drowning, or Sodom and Gomorrah did their burning, because deceitful sin hath hardened their hearts; long custom in sin, with impunity, hath seared their consciences as with a hot iron; but then they are in the greatest danger, when they sleep with the greatest security: when men grow desperately hardened against often and all reproofs, by word and rod too, what follows but sudden destruction, and that without remedy? Prov. xxix. 1. "And when men cry peace and safety, then sudden destruction cometh upon them, as travail upon a woman with child, and they shall not escape," 1 Thess. v. 3. And if some of this untoward and wicked generation do drop away without a remarkable temporal destruction, God will make his righteousness evident to them in the other world, when he claps up their souls close prisoners in the lowest dungeon of hell, appointing black devils to be their gaolers, flames of fire to be their clothing, hideous terrors and woe to be their food; Cain, Judas, and other damned tormented spirits to be their companions, where they must lie bound in the chains of darkness, till the judgment of the great day: and when the general assize is come, and the angels have blown the last trumpet, and gathered the elect to the right hand of Christ, then they will be sent with the keys of the bottomless pit, and the prison will be opened for a while, and like

so many rogues in chains, they shall, together with all their fellow sinners, be brought forth, and find out the dirty flesh of their bodies, which, like a nasty rag, they shall then put on, and with most rueful looks, and trembling joints, and horrible shrieks, and inexpressible confusion and terror, they shall behold the Lord Jesus Christ, whom in life-time they despised and affronted, come down from heaven in flaming fire, to take vengeance upon them; who will sentence them to the flames of eternal fire, and drive them from his throne and presence, into utter darkness, where they must take up their lodging for evermore. Then, then there will be a clear revelation of the righteous and dreadful judgments of this great God unto the world, and upon this accursed generation.

But more fully to clear up the reason of London's judgments, and the righteousness of God herein, God hath, indeed, spoken very terribly, but he hath answered us very righteously. London was not so godly, as some speak by way of scoff. No! if London had been more generally godly, and more powerfully godly, these judgments might have been escaped, and the ruin of the city prevented: No! it was the ungodliness of London which brought the plague and fire upon London. There was a general plague upon the heart, a more dangerous infection, and deadly plague of sin, before there was sent a plague upon the body; there was a fire of divers lusts which was enkindled, and did burn in the bosom: sometimes issuing out flames at the door of the mouth, and at the windows of the eyes of the inhabitants,

before the fire was kindled in the city, which swallowed up so many habitations. We have fallen (thousands of persons) into the grave by the plague; thousands of houses, as a great monument upon them, by the fire; and whence is it? "We are fallen by our iniquities," Hosea xiv. 1. "The crown is fallen from our heads:" and what is the reason? "because we have sinned against the Lord," Lam. v. 16. God hath spoken terribly; but he hath answered righteously; as he gives great and especial mercies in answer unto prayer, so he sendeth great and extraordinary judgments in answer unto sin; there is a voice and loud cry, especially in some sins, which "entereth into the ears of the Lord of Sabaoth," James v. 4. When God speaks by terrible things, he makes but a righteous return to this cry.

And though these judgments of plague and fire are national judgments, and may be the product of national sins, and I verily am persuaded, that God was more highly provoked by some that dwelt out of the city, than with those which dwelt in it; I mean the profane and ungodly generation, who chiefly did inhabit more remotely; and that God, being so provoked, was the more ready to strike, and let his hand fall so heavy upon London: yet, since many of the ungodly crew were got into the city itself, and most in the city, that were not of them, and did not dare to commit their impieties, yet made themselves guilty, by not mourning for them, and labouring in their place what they could after a redress; and since London itself hath been guilty of so many crying sins (as I shall endeavour to

shew), God's righteousness in the terrible things of London will be evident, especially if we consider,

1. *That God hath punished London no more than their iniquities have deserved.*

2. *That God hath punished London less than their iniquities have deserved.*

1. *God hath punished London no more than their iniquities deserved.* Great sins deserve great plagues, and have not the sins of London been great? Let us make an enquiry after London's sins.

Here I shall offer some sins to consideration, and let London judge whether she be not guilty, and whether the Lord hath not been plaguing her, and burning her, and possibly, yea, probably, will bring utter ruin and desolation upon her, except she see, and mourn, and turn the sooner. It is out of dear and tender love to London (with whom I could willingly live and die) that I write these things to put them in mind of their sins, that they might take some speedy course for a redress and turning away the fierce anger of the Lord which is kindled against them for sin, lest he next proceed to bring utter ruin upon them: surely they have not more reason to think that God's anger is turned away since the fire, than they had to think it was turned away after the plague; but rather they may conclude, that though the fire of the city be quenched, yet the fire of God's anger doth burn still more dreadfully than the other fire, and that his hand is stretched out still to destroy. Therefore, O all ye inhabitants about London, open your eyes,

and ears, and hearts, and suffer a word of reproof, for your sins; and deal not with this catalogue of your sins, as Jehoiachim did with Jeremiah's roll, who burnt it in the fire, not being able to bear his words; but do with it as John did with his little book, eat it, and digest it; though it be bitter in the mouth, as well as in the belly, it is bitter physic, but necessary for the preservation of a sick, languishing city, which is even ready to give up the ghost.

And here I shall begin with more gospel sins, which, though natural, conscience is not so ready to accuse of, yet in the account of God are the most heinous sins. And I would have a regard not only to latter, but to former sins, which, possibly, may now be more out of view, and forgotten, and which some may be hardened in, because the guilty have not been so particularly and sensibly punished, (though God's sparing of them, hath been in order to their repentance) or their punishments in some kind hath been accounted by them no punishments, or their punishments have been mistaken, and their hearts have swelled against instruments made use of by God therein, instead of accepting of the punishment of their iniquity, and humbling themselves deeply before the Lord. I say, I would call to remembrance former sins, as well as latter, which are more visible now, and apparent; for as God, being so slow to anger, hath not been quickly moved to such indignation; but, as we have reason to think, that his wrath hath been a long time boiling in his breast, before it was raised to this height as to

boil over, and pour down plague and fire upon the city of London; so we may reasonably infer, that sins committed by London long ago, were the fuel put under, that caused this boiling of his anger, which, because other judgments have not wrought the kindly effect of repentance, the Lord hath been provoked to express this way, which hath been more feeling and dreadful. Moreover, when I reckon up London's sins, I would not reflect alone upon any one party, inasmuch as all parties have sinned; and I believe the Lord hath been offended with all, as in his judgments he hath made no difference, that all might be awakened to see their faults with sorrow and shame. And if it were fit, I would begin here with myself, being persuaded that my sins, more than thousands of others, have helped to fill up the vial of God's anger: but as I go along, I shall endeavour, by the grace of God, to apply to myself the sins which conscience will accuse of, that I may bewail and amend: and I will beseech every one of you that cast your eyes upon these lines, to do the like, and to compare them with those lines which are written in the book of your consciences: and where you find a transcript, read and read again; consider and lay to heart; get to your knees, confess, and labour to drop at least some tears into the bottle, which, if this little book might help gather from your eyes, and you could be persuaded to pour forth such waters before the Lord, they might help to quench the violence of the fire of God's anger, which we have reason to fear is still burning against us.

SECT. VIII.

A Catalogue of London's Sins, which have provoked the Lord to speak with so terrible a Voice in the City.

1. *THE first sin of London is slighting of the Gospel.* The Gospel in England hath above this hundred years shined forth out of the clouds of Popery and Antichristianism, which before did overspread the land ; and in no place of England hath the Gospel been preached with greater power and purity than in London ; and what entertainment hath it found ? hath it been valued according to its worth and excellency ; hath it been received as if it had come down from the God of heaven, expressing his love and good-will towards the children of men, as if it had brought such good news and tidings, as salvation by Jesus Christ ?

Read the eulogium which the Apostle Peter gives of the salvation made known by the Gospel, 1 Pet. i. 10—12. “ Of which salvation the prophets have enquired, and searched diligently, who prophesied of the grace that should come unto you ; searching what, or what manner of time the Spirit of Christ which was in them, did signify, when it testified beforehand the sufferings of Christ, and the glory that should follow ; unto whom it was revealed, that not unto themselves, but unto us, they did minister the things which

are now reported unto you, by them that have preached the Gospel unto you, with the Holy Ghost sent down from heaven, which things the angels desire to look into." The prophets of old did enquire and search, but did not so clearly understand the Gospel, as now it is revealed: our Saviour tells his disciples, Luke x. 24, that "many prophets and kings have desired to see the things which they saw, and had not seen them; and to hear the things which they did hear, and had not heard them; for indeed this mystery was hid from ages and generations, which God then made manifest unto the saints," Col. i. 26. And the Apostle Paul tells us, that "though the ministration of the law were glorious, insomuch that it made the face of Moses to shine," unto whom the law was revealed upon the Mount, "yet that it had no glory, in comparison with the ministration of the Gospel, whose glory did so far excel," 2 Cor. iii. 7—10: the mysteries of God's wisdom and love revealed in the Gospel, being so glorious, surely are worthy of acceptance and esteem, especially when the angels, who are not so much concerned, desire to look into these things, unto whom it is said, Eph. iii. 10, "Is made known by the church, the manifold wisdom of God." And yet these great things, which have been reported by them, who have preached the Gospel, with the Holy Ghost sent down from heaven, have been undervalued in London. The Gospel hath been slighted in London; and though some have been more notoriously guilty; yet who can altogether excuse themselves from this sin? Now that the convic-

tion may be more full, I shall charge the sin more particularly.

1. The *ignorant* persons in London have been guilty of this sin, the light of the Gospel hath shined about them; but they have muffled up themselves in darkness, and suffered Satan to keep them hoodwinked, lest the light of the glorious Gospel should enter, and lead them out of his snare; thousands in the city have been *affectedly* ignorant: though they have had means of knowledge, so near, and so easy to come by; multitudes have perished out of London, and multitudes still remain in their ignorance. O the neglect that there hath been of learning catechisms! and how few have endeavoured to acquaint themselves with the principles of the Christian religion, that they might have the more full and clear understanding of the Gospel?

2. The *vicious* and *profane* have been guilty of slighting the Gospel; how many such persons have there crowded, and are still crowding out of London into hell, when the light of the Gospel shined upon them, which would have guided them in the way to heaven; because this light hath been too troublesome in its discovery, and reproof of their dear and sweet sins, they have hated it, and endeavoured to fly as far as they could from it, or to shut their eyes as hard as they could against it.

3. The *civil* persons also have been guilty; there have been many sober citizens, and matrons, civil youths, and virgins, who have been free from the gross pollutions which are in the world

through lust; who have been diligent in their calling, just in their dealings, courteous, and sweet-natured in their demeanour, and yet without the least degree of the power of godliness, without which it is impossible they should be saved. Alas! none of these have given any warm welcome unto the Gospel in their hearts, which hath been so long preached in the city: the kindness of a friend hath been esteemed by them; but the kindness of God hath not been regarded. If a messenger had come and told them how they might save their estates, when in danger of loss, or how to save their relations when in danger of death, O how welcome would such a messenger and tidings have been! but when ministers have preached the Gospel unto them, which tells them how they should save their souls, in danger of death and hell, such tidings have had no relish with them, as if they had no souls, or were in no danger: the light hath shined before them, but there hath been a cloud in their eye, they could not discern it; or they have looked upon it afar off, they have not drawn near, and brought it home, and set it up in their bosoms, that they might order themselves, and whole conversations, according to its guidance and direction.

4. The *hypocrites* have been guilty of this sin; these have drawn nearer to this light, than any of the former; so near that they have seemed to be clothed with its beams, they have lighted their lamps hereby, and have shined forth in a glorious blaze of an outward profession; yet there hath been, even in these, an inward secret dis-

relish of the Gospel, especially of some things in it: there have been some secret rooms in their hearts, into which they would not suffer the light to enter, lest it should discover those beloved Delilahs, which there they have nourished and brought up; they have been rotten at the core, and have had some unmortified lust within, which the world hath not taken notice of; so that if the Gospel hath been received by them, it hath been only in the outward form, not in the inward power; if the light hath been received, it hath been without its heat and life. Hence it hath come to pass, that some of these hypocrites, who seemed to be stars of the first magnitude, have proved only blazing stars and comets, which in a short time have fallen and sunk into wild opinions, or fearful apostacy.

5. The *erroneous* have been guilty of this sin; some, and not a few, in London, under this glorious sunshine of the Gospel, which hath come from heaven, have lighted a candle at the fire of hell, and laboured to set it up in opposition to the true light of the Gospel, crying out, New light, new light! Satan himself hath appeared in London like an angel of light, and employed his emissaries and wicked instruments (who have seemed to be ministers of righteousness, but have had a wolfish ravenous heart under the dress and clothing of the sheep) to vent many damnable and destructive opinions in our church, under pretence of new discoveries and revelations of the Spirit; and through this false and taper-light could never abide the test, and put forth any beams of convincing truth; but darkened and

disappeared upon the approach of the sun, where it shined in its power; yet too many whose eyes were too sore to look upon the glorious beams of the sun, and yet withal their hearts too fearful to remain wholly in the dark, without any shew of light, did withdraw themselves from the former, and sought after the latter in dark corners, where alone such rotten wood could seem to shine, and such candles could give forth any light; and choosing night rather than day, they followed these false wandering fires, though they were led by them into many a precipice.

It is sad to remember, and seriously to consider what errors and strong delusions have abounded and prevailed in our Gospel days. How many false teachers have there been among us, which have crept on unawares; how many Jesuits and Priests sent from Rome and other places, to rend and tear our Protestant church to pieces, that they might make way for the introduction of popery; at least to cast a disgrace upon Protestantism, and delude many of us with the opinions they have broached, and to confirm their own in their delusions. Thus many cunning and learned Jesuits have disguised themselves in the habit of tailors, shoemakers, and of other mechanical tradesmen, that they might seem to the people to have been taught those things by the Spirit, which have been the product of much study: thus these cursed villains, "of old ordained to condemnation, have privily brought in damnable heresies;" some calling themselves Quakers, others Ranters, others Seekers, others Antinomians, others Brownists, others Anabaptists:

putting themselves into any shapes, that they might mislead, and the better "lie in wait to deceive" poor souls: some "denying the Lord that bought them," setting up the fancy of a Christ within them for their Saviour; others denying the foundation, undermining the divine authority of the Scriptures: others labouring to overthrow the doctrine of justification, and striking at most fundamental doctrines of the Christian faith; and all of them endeavouring to undermine the ministry of Christ's institution and sending, calling them Antichristian, Baal's Priests, false prophets, doing what they could to bring them and their ministry out of esteem, that they might the more effectually prevail with the people to receive their false doctrines, and arm them hereby against an undeceivment; and sweetening their poison "with good words, and fair speeches, they have deceived the hearts of the simple, so that many did follow their pernicious ways, by reason of whom the way of truth hath been evil spoken of;" and whatever good words they had, they were but "feigned words, whereby they made merchandize of souls, whose judgment now a long time lingereth not," and whose damnation slumbereth not," 2 Pet. ii. 1, 2, 3.

These the Apostle calls "spots and blemishes, sporting themselves with their own deceivings; wells without water, clouds carried about with a tempest, raging waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame, wandering stars, unto whom is reserved blackness of darkness for ever," 2 Pet. ii. 13—17; Jude 13.

And yet many of these were hearkened unto, and adhered unto, by too many in London, rather than the true Gospel ministers, commissioned by the Lord Jesus Christ himself, and ordained according to the prescription of his word.

Then many laymen, some gifted, (who would have given a better account of their gifts at the great day, had they kept their station) and some without gifts, but with a great measure of ignorance and confidence, did step up sometimes into pulpits, often took upon them to preach in private, invading the office, and intruding into the work of Christ's ambassadors, which he hath appointed a peculiar office for, and which he hath set a hedge about more than any other office we read of in Scripture; but they ventured to break over the hedge, I am confident, to the affronting and displeasing of the great King, whose representatives in the world his ambassadors are; and not only silly women were led captive by the deceivers, which crept in when so many took liberty to preach, but also men who professed themselves to be wise, and to have attained to a degree of light above the vulgar; yet, forsaking the ministry and ordinances of Jesus Christ, appointed to continue unto the end of the world, for the instructing, perfecting, and establishment of saints in knowledge and faith, they became fools, and "children, tossed to and fro with every wind of doctrine, by the sleight of men," which led them aside, Eph. iv. 11—14.

Now all these persons have been slights of the Gospel of Jesus Christ, the ignorant, the profane, the hypocrite, and the erroneous; and

if you place them all in one company, how few will there remain in London, that have sincerely and heartily embraced the truth as it is in Jesus, and upon whom the Gospel hath made a powerful and saving impression ! And even amongst those that have been affected and converted by the preaching of the Gospel, and had it greatly in esteem at first hearing and believing ; how was their esteem of the Gospel fallen, and their affection cooled ! Did not Gospel-ordinances begin to lose their worth and excellency, and grow tedious and wearisome unto them ? O, how generally unthankful was London for Gospel privileges and liberties ! Yea, many began to be very nice and wanton, and the Gospel was not relished, unless it were served up with such neatnesses and dressings, in which some ministers possibly did too much endeavour to please themselves and the people ; and then the sauce was more relished than the food itself, and the appetite of many was so spoiled, that plain, wholesome, soul-saving truths, would not go down with them. Londoners began to be gluttoned with the Gospel ; and like the Israelites in the wilderness, their souls began to loath the manna which came down from heaven. A strange curiosity there was in spiritual palates ; which in many turned to a loathing of the food, insomuch that the Gospel became a burden unto them, and thence it was “ that many turned away their ears from the truth, and were turned into errors ; and they could not endure to hear sound doctrine, but having itching ears, heaped up unto themselves

teachers according to their lusts," 2 Tim. iv. 3, 4.

And those that continued steadfast in the truth, did not duly prize the Gospel, none of them according to its dignity and worth. No wonder then if God grows angry at such contempts and affronts as were hereby offered unto him, and easeth them much of their burden; and withdraws the food so much, which they grew so weary of: no wonder that he suffers so many of their teachers to be thrust into corners, and so much withdraws the beams of that light which was so much abused; and when they are not sensible of his displeasure in this, no wonder if he sends the plague and fire, to awaken them unto a sensibility.

When the "King sent forth his servants to call the guests to the wedding-feast, and they make light of it, and excused themselves, and went away, one to his farm, another to his merchandize, and the remnant took his servants and entreated them spitefully, and slew them; the king was wroth, and sent forth his armies to destroy those murderers, and burn their city," Matt. xxii. 1 to 8. God hath sent forth his servants to call Londoners to this feast; how many invitations have they had to come unto Christ, to accept of him to save them, and to feed upon him, from whom alone they can get any spiritual nourishment. But how many in London have had their excuses; they have been following their merchandize and other business, and could not come; and what entertainment

his servants hath had, the Lord knows. I do not say that London hath entertained them despitefully, and slain them; but has not their message been slighted by London? and is it a wonder then if the king that sent them be wroth, and send a fire to burn down the city? No greater favour could be shewed, no greater privilege could be enjoyed, than to have the Gospel powerfully preached, and ordinances purely administered; but hath it been generally so accounted in London? Hath not merchandize, and thriving in the world, (which yet they have not thrived in) been preferred before this, by many thousands in the city? When God hath been at such an expense to work out a way for man's salvation; when he hath discovered such wonders of astonishing love in sending his only begotten Son out of heaven to clothe himself in our flesh, that therein he might purchase life and salvation for us who were sunk so low from our primitive state by sin, and were exposed to death and wrath, and unavoidable endless misery in hell; and hath sent his ambassadors of peace to bring unto us the glad tidings hereof, and in his name to make known the thing, the author, the terms, the way: and to entreat us that we would accept of life and reconciliation to God, who without any injury to himself could ruin us everlastingly, and get himself a name thereby; and yet, when the Gospel is preached, that we should undervalue and slight both messenger and message; surely this hath been an affront unto the Lord, who hath sent his ambassadors on this errand, and doth

carry with it such ingratitude as cannot be paralleled.

No doubt but this sin of slighting the Gospel is a prime sin, which hath provoked God against London, to come forth in such fury ; and if London do not repent ere long, and labour to recover its relish and esteem of the Gospel, and make more evident demonstrations of it, I fear the Lord will quite remove the Gospel from them ; and then nothing is like to follow but desolation and woe. God doth not remove his glory at once, but by steps ; first, " the glory of the Lord departs from the inner court, to the threshold of the house," Ezek. x. 3, 4 ; " from the threshold of the house to the door of the east-gate," verses 18, 19, " then it goes from the midst of the city, and standeth upon the mountain," chap. xi. 23. The Gospel is the glory of London, and hath the glory of the Lord made none of these removes ? Is it not come forth of the inner court ? Hath it not left the threshold ? is not a departing of it quite from the city threatened ? Will any thing recover it, if we do not recover our appetite, and prize, and cry after it ?

If the Gospel go, God will go ; the Gospel being the sign and means of his special presence ; and " woe be unto us when God shall depart from us," Hos. ix. 12. And if God depart with the Gospel, farewell peace and prosperity in England ; nothing, I dare be confident, but temporal misery and ruin will be the consequence : if the eclipse bring such misery, what will the quite darkening of the sun do ?

2. *The second sin of London is unfruitfulness*

in such a fertile soil. This sin hath been an attendant upon, and a consequent of the former.

London was not only a Goshen, but an Eden ; God chose out London to be his garden, he hath hedged it, planted, watered, pruned and manured it ; no place in the world hath had more plenty of the means of grace ; God hath given the former and the latter rain ; and sweet dews of heaven, both morning and evening, did fall upon this place : in the morning seed was sown, and in the evening the hand was not withdrawn ; plentiful and powerful hath preaching been in London, in season and out of season, on the Sabbath-day, and on the week-day ; but hath London answered all God's care and cost ? Hath not God come for many years together, seeking fruit, and found nothing but the leaves of profession ? Hath he not often threatened to cut down the unfruitful trees, and not suffer them to cumber his ground any longer ? and when, through the intercession of the vine-dresser, he hath spared them this year, and another year, hath not the same unfruitfulness still remained ? What could the Lord have done more to his vineyard than he hath done ? wherefore then, when he looked for grapes, brought it forth only leaves or wild grapes ? And is it then to be wondered at, if the Lord pluck down the hedge thereof, that it might be eaten by the wild boar and beast of the field, if he break down the wall thereof, and make it waste and desolate ? Is it to be wondered at, if he withhold the clouds that they rain not on it, and suffer briars and thorns to spring up in it, where the plants did grow ?

The vine; when it is unfruitful, is the most un-
 useful of all trees, Luke xiii. ; Isa. v. 4, 5, 6, &c. ;
 Ezek. xv. ; it is fit for nothing but the fire ; and
 the Lord hath threatened to gather the unfruitful
 branches, and to cast them into the fire and burn
 them, John xv. 6 ; and the earth which drinketh
 in the rain that often falleth upon it, and instead
 of herbs, meet for the use of him by whom it is
 dressed, bringeth forth nothing but briars and
 thorns, God rejecteth and curseth, and in the
 end burneth, Heb. vi. 7.

O the unfruitfulness of London ! O the briars
 and thorns which have flourished in this ground,
 whereby the seed of the word hath been choked !
 O the hemlock, the thistle, and the wormwood,
 that have sprung up in the furrows of the field !
 O the tares that have abounded and overtopped
 the wheat, and how little good corn hath there
 been brought forth ! O the wild olive-trees which
 have grown up in God's garden, and wild figs and
 wild grapes, which the fig-trees and vines of God
 have yielded unto him ! O the leanness of his
 sheep in such fat pasture ! O the barrenness !
 the barrenness of London, under such plentiful
 showers of the word ! “ Instead of the fruits of
 righteousness, which are to the praise and glory
 of God,” there have been the “ fruits of unright-
 eousness, and wickedness, which are to God's
 dishonour : instead of the fruits of the Spirit,
 which are love, joy, peace, gentleness, meekness,
 temperance, goodness, faith ;” there have been
 the “ works of the flesh, fornication, unclea-
 ness, lasciviousness, hatred, variance, emulations,
 wraths, strifes, seditions, heresies, envyings, mur-

ders, drunkenness, revellings, and such like;" of which the Apostle tells us, "that they which do such things shall not inherit the kingdom of God," Philip. i. 11; Gal. v. 19—24.

And those who have not abounded in the grosser works of the flesh, very few of them have been very fruitful in good works. London hath had the means of grace, and yet most of them without grace, few of them have much grace. London hath had powerful ordinances, but what powerful effect have they produced? what have they to shew of all their prayers, and sermons, and sacraments? Have they attained unto a great measure of mortification? Is grace grown up to a great height? what evidences, what experiences have the best got, which they might have got, had they been more diligent?

Give me leave a little more particularly to instance the unfruitfulness of London in regard of repentance, faith, love, and new obedience, the fruit which God so much looketh for, and so much delighteth in.

(1.) Where have been the fruits of *repentance* in London? Calls there have been to repentance, frequent, fervent: reason for repentance, sins numerous, heinous: need of repentance, that judgments temporal, eternal, might be diverted, that pardon, happiness, might be obtained; and yet, O the impenitency and hard-heartedness of London! few bleeding hearts under the sharp sword of the Word; little tenderness under the most melting discourses; few converts and penitent persons did the most powerful preaching (especially before the Gospel's-eclipse) bring forth

in London ; converting work was at a great stand, though there were so many unconverted persons in the city ; and by the impenitency and hardness of heart in London, God's treasures of wrath hath been filled up, which, in some measure, he hath opened in these late judgments that he hath inflicted, and yet the great day of his wrath is still to come, Rom. ii. 4, 5.

(2.) Where have been the fruits of *faith* in London ? How hath unbelief abounded, the great Gospel sin, more dangerous than any other, and more heinous in London than in any other place ! O the thick vail of unbelief which hath hid Gospel mysteries, and things afar off from the eyes of this people ! O the evil heart of unbelief, which hath shut the door against the Lord Jesus Christ, who hath knocked so long for entertainment ! O the sottishness of London, to believe no more, when truths have been so plain and clear ; when promises have been made known, so great and sure ; when Christ hath been preached and tendered ; and when heaven hath been revealed and proffered ; and when all have such need, for the most to shut the eye, and ear, and heart, and through unbelief to refuse ; to give God the lie, and turn upon him the back ; to give Christ a wound, and tread his blood under foot ; to give the spirit a repulse, and send him away grieved from the heart, as men do by their unbelief : this sin doth provoke the Lord to great displeasure.

(3.) Where have been the fruits of *love* in London ? O the want of love to God, and one to another ! The grace of love is necessary and sweet, and hath been much pressed, but little

exercised in London; there hath been much love of the world, but little love of the Father; hatred of the brethren hath abounded, but there was little brotherly love; burning anger there hath been, little burning love; burning lusts, little burning love; inordinate carnal love, little true spiritual love; carnal love hath exceeded the bounds, but spiritual love hath been in a very low degree; and when love in London hath waxed cold, is it a wonder if God's anger hath waxed so hot, and broken forth into such flames, as we have seen?

(4.) Where have been the fruits of *new obedience* in London? and expression of love to Jesus Christ, by keeping of his commandments, though his commandments are not grievous?

3. *A third sin of London, is hypocrisy in the profession of religion.* This sin exceedingly prevailed in the late times, when profession of religion was grown into fashion: religion was near in the mouths of most, but far from the reins: there was a general face of religion, but it was no more than skin-deep; it was seated in the countenance, not rooted in the heart: how many painted sepulchres had we in London, outwardly fair and beautiful, inwardly full of rottenness and wickedness; how much sounding brass had we then in our streets: a great noise and stir hypocrites did make, but they were hollow at heart; our gold was most of it counterfeit; water we had instead of wine, and dross instead of silver.

O how was religion abused! some made it a stirrup to get up by into the seat of honour; others made it a cloak to cover their covetous

practices; many base and wicked designs were carried on under pretence of religion.

It would take too much time to set forth hypocrites in all their shapes, and to paint hypocrisy in all its colours. London hath formerly abounded with hypocrites, and more lately it hath not been free. If hell-fire be the portion especially of hypocrites hereafter, Matt. xxiv. 51, no wonder then if God be angry with a place, and punish it with plague and fire for this sin here.

4. *The fourth sin of London is, formality and lukewarmness in the worship of God.* There was much formality when there was no form; and I suppose that forms have not quickened unto more loveliness; there was a face of worship indeed in London; and was there only, or little more, than a face in most places? God is holy and jealous, "a great king, and his name is dreadful," Mal. i. 14. "God is a Spirit, and they that worship him, must worship him in spirit and in truth," John iv. 24. But hath his worship been accordingly in London? hath there been that spiritual worship which he requires? Let London seriously reflect upon their carriage towards God in their devotions. Have they had a due awe and dread of the great name of God upon them, when they have seemed to draw near unto him? have they worshipped him with reverence and godly fear? Outward reverence some have used, more than he hath required, in bowing at names and before places; but have they had inward reverence and fear of God upon their hearts? have they clothed themselves with

humility, when they have come into his presence? hath there been inward fervour and delight accompanying their outward acts of worship?

Alas! how *formal* hath London been, especially of late in God's worship; they have prayed, but what kind of prayers have they been? could they deserve the name of prayers? were those prayers likely to prevent judgment, or turn away wrath? Some confessions of sin have been made, but so general and formal, that they have been very unlikely to work up the heart to sorrow and repentance; and where some have been more particular, hath not much formality cleaved to them? Where hath hearty grief for sin and sorrow been to be found? would not a small vial hold all the tears that have dropped from the eyes of great assemblies, even in the day of their solemn humiliations? hath not sin been rolled under the tongue when confession of sin hath been at the end of it? have not the confessions of many been such, as if they came to ask leave to commit sin, rather than humbly to bewail it? at least, have they not taken leave, whatever their confessions have been? Petitions have been made for pardon, and grace, and sanctification, but hath it not been lip-prayer, without hearty desire? hath it not been in such a manner, as if they did not much care whether they did speed or no? as if they could make shift well enough without a pardon? as if they had no need of grace and holiness: but they must say something for form and custom. Hath there not been an enmity in the hearts of many against that which they have seemed to desire with their lips? who

have stirred up themselves to lay hold on God? Who have wrestled in prayer, with fervent desires, with faith, and importunity? Hearing there hath been in London, but how little believing; how little relishing the word, and receiving it with love! Singing there hath been, but how little joy and melody of the heart in the Lord!

O how *formal* and *luke-warm* have Londoners been; how much of the Laodicean temper have they had in all ordinances! And might not God say to London, as he did of old to Jerusalem. Isa. i. 11, 12, 13, 14, "To what purpose is the multitude of your sacrifices unto me?" &c. Such services are to no purpose; they are vain worship, and do not attain the end thereof, either to profit him that offereth him them, or to please him unto whom they are tendered. Can such formal services be effectual to procure pardon or peace? can they bear up the spirit in a day of trouble? will not the morning cloud and early dew of such righteousness flee away and vanish upon the approach of the sun? will not such spiders' webs be broken to pieces by a stormy wind? How do formalists behave themselves, as if they had no religion, when they fall into troubles! when God thunders by his judgments, what can a cold, formal, empty prayer do? when Death appears before them with a grim countenance, what comfort can such reap by reflection on such services? what evidences for heaven can they gather from any of their outside devotions?

And are not they to as little purpose in regard

of God? May not God say unto them of their fastings and prayers, "Did you fast unto me? did you pray at all unto me?" Zech. vii. 5. Or, as here to the Jews, that he was full of their services, even to a loathing; that he took no delight in them; and "who hath required these things at your hands to tread my courts? Bring no more oblations, incense is an abomination unto me; I cannot away with your assemblies, my soul hateth them; they are a trouble to me, I am weary to bear them." The Lord is much offended with formal, hypocritical services; hereby they flatter and mock him, and is he taken with flatteries? Such services are like a dead, cold, black, mangled, rotten, stinking carcase, without the soul and spirit, which must needs be very unsavoury and displeasing; they are like the lame, blind, halt, sick cattle, which were not fit to be offered up in sacrifice under the law, Mal. i. 8. "If ye offer the blind for sacrifice, is it not evil? and if ye offer the lame and sick, is it not evil? Offer it now unto thy governor, will he be pleased with thee?" And will God then be pleased? Such persons, while they seem to serve God with their outward man, they serve the devil, and their own lusts with their inward man: God hath the form sometimes, the devil hath the power; God hath the show, the devil hath the substance; God hath the bark, the rind, the shell, the devil hath the kernel; God hath the cabinet, the devil gets the jewel; they give God the devil's leavings, and refuse, as it were, of their own lusts; for they spend the strength and vigour of soul and body, in serving

the devil, and gratifying their own lusts; and then think to put God off with any thing; giving him only some dead, cold, faint, empty, heartless, lifeless, outward services; and even in them they are swayed by some carnal motives, which are the secret spring to the wheel of all external services. And O how abominable is all such worship in the sight of God! Hath not formality in worship been one sin of London which hath helped to fill up the Ephah? When the means God hath appointed for the turning away of his anger, is used in such a manner, that itself becomes a provocation, no wonder if his wrath break forth without remedy.

5. *A fifth sin of London is division amongst professors.* Different persuasions have made wide breaches and divisions in London, and through divisions have arisen great animosities and contentions, unto the shame of Christianity and the Protestant religion; and hath not God been provoked to anger hereby? Hath not he contended with professors, and by the common scourge he hath brought upon them, called aloud unto them for a union, and more hearty accord and affection than formerly they have had? And hath not he given them liberty and opportunity, had they minded and cared to make use of it, for meeting together in order unto healing? but have professors of different parties been sensible of God's meaning in the scourge upon their backs? have they hearkened unto God's call? have they laid hold of and improved opportunities for closing up their wide breaches? I hope some closing in affection there hath been amongst

some ; but how rarely hath it been to be found ; and when there are such breaches still amongst us, is it not just with God to make further breaches upon us, as he hath done by his judgments.

6. *A sixth sin of London, is neglect of reformation.*—Neglect of, 1. *Personal*, 2. *Family*, 3. *City*, 4. *Church*—*Reformation*.

(1.) Neglect of *personal* reformation in heart and life.

Who in London have seriously and very diligently endeavoured the reformation of their hearts? when so unclean and polluted, who have laboured to get them washed? When such roots of bitterness have been springing forth, and such weeds of lust have been growing there, who hath endeavoured to pluck them up? Outward neatness there hath been in London, washing and rinsing, rubbing and scouring ; but O the inward sluttishness ! they who have had clean houses and clean garments, and clean faces and hands, have had foul hearts. Who have taken care every day to rinse and scour their inside? to bring their hearts to the fountain set open for sin and uncleanness ; and to cleanse themselves from all filthiness of flesh and spirit, that they might arrive every day unto greater perfection in holiness? they who have been careful to dress their bodies every day, have been very careless in dressing their hearts, neglecting to put on the white robes of Christ's righteousness, which alone can cover their spiritual nakedness and deformity ; and to get the jewels of grace, which

alone can adorn the soul, and render it amiable in the sight of God.

Heart-work is hard-work; and it is so hard, that most have let it alone; they have been discouraged with the difficulty; the opposition of Satan and lust to this work, hath been so strong, that they have been quickly overpowered, upon their first attempts and endeavours after a change and rectifying of the disorders which they have perceived.

Heart-work is secret-work. Many have employed themselves in the more open work of religion, few have taken pains with their hearts in secret; many take heed to their tongues what they speak, and before whom; to their hands, what they do; to their feet, whither they go; but few take heed to their hearts; murder, adultery, theft, and the like sins have been committed in the heart by many, who would have been afraid and ashamed of the outward acts.

O the unwatchfulness there hath been in London over the heart! Citizens have watched their gates, and watched their streets, and watched their houses; but how few have watched their hearts, what cometh in, and what goeth forth; how few have set a watch before the door of their lips, and ears, and other senses, which are the inlets of sin, and upon their hearts, from whence are the issues of sin! How few have kept their hearts with all diligence; how few have laboured to govern their thoughts, to rule their passions, to subjugate their wills to Christ; and to deliver up all their affections to his dispose and obe-

dience ! Heart-reformation hath been much neglected.

Who in London have endeavoured *life-reformation* as they should ? How few have there been effectually persuaded to put away the evil of their doings, from before the eyes of the Lord, to cease from evil, and learn to do well. How few have broken off their sins by repentance, and thoroughly amended their ways, measuring out their actions by the rule of the word ! How few have got the law of God written in their hearts, and the transcript thereof in their lives, exemplifying the precepts thereof in their conversations ! How few in London have been like so many Epistles of Christ, in whom the will and grace of their Master might be read ! Who have trodden in Christ's steps, walking as he walked, and followed him in the way of obedience and self-denial ? Who have shined like so many lights in dark places and times, adorning their profession, and living as becometh the Gospel ?

Great irregularities there have been in the lives of most Londoners ; little Gospel-reformation ; little making religion the business ; little holy exact living. If a stranger had looked into our city, and observed the lives of the most, and not known them to have had the name of Christians, would not we have judged them to be heathens, yea many of them in their dealing to be worse than Turks and Infidels ? Thus personal reformation hath been neglected.

(2.) A great neglect there hath been of *family reformation* in London. How few have, with Joshua, resolved, and accordingly endea-

voured, that they and their houses should serve the Lord! How few have set up religious worship in their families! Have not many hundred houses in the city been without family prayer in them from one end of the week to the other? and is it strange that the Lord hath buried down those houses wherein the inhabitants would not vouchsafe to worship him? And where there hath been some prayer in many families, it was but once a day, and that so late at night, and when the body hath been so tired and sleepy, and the soul so dull and unfit for God's service, that the prayers have been no prayers, or lost prayers, such which, instead of pleasing him, have provoked him to anger? How few did labour to instruct their families, catechise their children and servants; to bring them up in the nurture and admonition of the Lord. Hath not God threatened to pour out his wrath upon irreligious families? Jer. x. 25.

(3.) Neglect of *city reformation*. Have not the magistrates of London been faulty here? Let them ask their own consciences, whether to the uttermost of their power, according to the trust and opportunity the Lord hath put into their hands, they have endeavoured the reformation of the city? Whether, as God's under-officers, they have improved their interest for the promotion of religion in the zealous exercise of it? yea, whether they have put the laws made in execution against sabbath-breakers, swearers, drunkards, endeavouring to find out and punish such offenders?

(4.) Neglect of *church reformation*. And is

there no blame to be laid upon church officers? Hath there been that zeal for, and faithful execution of church discipline, according to the rules of the word? Hath not the Lord Jesus Christ been affronted in his kingly office, by some who have imposed precepts of their own upon men's consciences, instead of vigorously endeavouring the execution of his; and taken the power of the keys out of the hands of those unto whom the Lord hath entrusted it, hereby rendering the execution of discipline impossible, according to the laws of Christ? Have not the tender and most conscientious lain under the censures of some, rather than the openly profane, and scandalously wicked?

Neglect of *reformation* am I speaking of? Nay, have not many who call themselves ministers, endeavoured rather the overthrow than the promotion of it? Have they not had sneers in the pulpits at holiness and zealous profession, which they have seconded by a conversation of dissoluteness, malicious opposition, and persecution of those especially, who have been the most religious? Sad neglects there have been of reformation in London, and that when London lay under such obligations to reform; as Christians, they were obliged, by 'baptismal' and renewed vows; as Protestants of the Reformed religion, they were obliged to endeavour a reformation; by mercies they were obliged; and have they been under no other obligations? And hath not the neglect of reformation, notwithstanding all obligations, rendered them guilty of disingenuity, infidelity, yea, of perjury itself? I verily

believe this is the great sin God is scourging London for; God is contending for a reformation, and if they do not endeavour it more vigorously, the sooner, I fear, he will bring desolation upon them.

7. *A seventh sin of London, is fearful apostacy, and a spirit of compliance with the sins of the times.* How many in London, who formerly were great professors, have discovered themselves to be rotten hypocrites; who, casting off the sheep's clothing, and laying aside all profession, have given themselves up to dissoluteness and licentious living. Formerly they have seemed true penitents, and to "be washed from their iniquities;" but they "have returned with the dog to the vomit, and with the sow that is washed, to the wallowing in the mire," 2 Pet. ii. ult. Formerly they have been swept a little within, and garnished outwardly with a fair profession; "but the unclean spirit hath returned," and without any great difficulty "hath entered with seven worse spirits, and defiled them more than before, and made their last state worse than their first," Matt. xii. 43, 44, 45. I speak not so much of those who worship God in this mode, or that mode, and of alterations herein; but of those who sometimes professed religion, and now do not worship God in any mode at all; but wholly addict themselves to their lusts, and are ashamed to be called or thought to be religious.

They would not now look like a saint, or speak like a saint, much less live like a saint. Thus have many, in our days, cast off all fear of God, and devoted themselves, with the hell-

hounds of the times, to the service of the devil; resolving to do what in them lies, to promote the interest of his kingdom. And if some are a little more awkward in his service, and not altogether so like him, and such apt scholars presently, as others whose education hath been in his school from their childhood, yet they learn very fast, and wonderful is their proficiency in a short time; and in regard of apostacy, they come nearer the image of the devil than those that have been always tutored by him.

Now, for any in London to forsake God, that they might serve the devil; to draw off from the ways of holiness, that they might walk in the ways of wickedness, doth cast a great slur upon God and his ways: they do, in effect, say, that the devil is a better master than God; and that the way of sin, that leadeth to hell, is more eligible than the way of holiness, which alone can bring to heaven. The Lord threateneth, "that his soul shall have no pleasure in such" apostates, Heb. x. 38. It is a *Meiosis*, and we are to understand, that the Lord is highly displeased with such persons.

See how God pleads with apostatizing Israel, Jer. ii. 9, 10, &c. Wherefore I will yet plead with you, saith the Lord. Pass ye over to the isles of Chittim, and see, and send unto Kedar, and diligently consider if there be any such thing. Hath any nation changed their gods, which yet are no gods? But my people have changed their glory for that which doth not profit! Be astonished, O ye heavens, at this, and be ye horribly afraid; be ye very desolate, saith

the Lord ; for my people have committed two great evils ; they have forsaken me, the fountain of living waters, and have hewn out unto themselves broken cisterns that can hold no water." And hence follows, ver. 15, " The young lions roared and yelled upon him, and laid his land waste ; his cities are burnt without inhabitant ;" and ver. 17, " Thou hast procured these things unto thyself, because thou hast forsaken the Lord thy God : " and ver. 19. " Thy own wickedness shall correct thee, and thy backslidings shall reprove thee ; know, therefore, and see that it is an evil thing, and bitter, that thou hast forsaken the Lord thy God, and that my fear is not in thee, saith the Lord God of Hosts." And may not God thus plead with the apostates of London, and punish them as he did his people of Israel ?

8. *The eighth sin of London is deafening the ear against all God's calls.* The Lord hath called upon London by his ministers, but they have been like the deaf adder, which will not hearken to the voice of the charmer ; they have stopped the ears, and turned away their shoulder, and made their heart like an adamant stone. God hath called by his mercies ; but this voice hath been too low, and they have slept the more securely in sin. God, after other means, hath called, by afflictions, first lighter, then heavier ; and yet how many in London have, and still do walk contrary unto God, and will not return to him that hath smitten them. They have been incorrigible under all God's correcting rods. When God spake by the plague, they were a little awakened, but quickly dropt asleep again ;

when the plague was a little over, they return to their trades again, to their sins again, but they do not return unto the Lord. And when the judgment of the plague was so much lost, and ineffectual for their good, this, no doubt, hath provoked God so quickly and unexpectedly to turn his hand upon them, and bring the judgment of the fire; and if they will still walk contrary to God, they must expect that God will walk contrary to them, until he have consumed them.

9. *A ninth sin of London is profaneness, and a loose and frothy spirit, especially in the youth and springing generation.* I do not tax all; for I am confident there is a serious and a godly youth growing up. But O that there were not reason to say, that the generality of youth is profane and wicked, as well as those who are grown more mature in wickedness! And this profaneness hath shewed itself in 1. Profane using God's name; 2. Profane breaking of God's day; 3. Profane scoffing at God's people.

1. *In profane using of God's name.* How grossly hath the third commandment been broken in the city. How hath the great and dreadful name of the Lord God, which should make men to tremble in the mention of it, and command their spirits into awe and reverence, been vainly taken by many, and used to fill up the sentence of their ordinary discourse. And not only so, but how hath the name of God been tossed in the black mouths of the children of darkness, and even torn in pieces by their hideous oaths and execrations. What a hellish noise hath

the sound of full-mouthed oaths; made sometimes in the streets, enough to make the hair stand on end, of one who hath a sense of the greatness of that majesty upon his spirit, which hereby is so audaciously affronted. Oh the swearing that hath been used by Londoners in buying and selling! Many parents have been so addicted to this sin in their families, that their little children have no sooner learned to speak, but they have also learned of them to swear by the name of God, which hath been all the teaching of God that they have given them; a devilish teaching indeed, which hereafter they will curse and banish them for in hell!

But if you should have laid your ears unto the taverns, and ale-houses, and whore-houses, and other devil-houses, once standing in London, and hearkened to the speeches of many of the devil's imps, in their drinking and gaming, and other lewd practices, especially when a little crossed and vexed, O what language of hell might have been heard! How have those cursed villains, in the heat of their wine and anger, shot volleys of oaths in the face of the God of heaven! and whetting their tongues like a sharp sword, they have not feared to wound the name of God, when they have received any injury from men. O what poison of asps hath there been under their lips! but a worse poison of sin in their hearts, from the evil treasure and abundance of which these oaths and blasphemies have proceeded.

But who can find words to set forth the evil of this sin, which hath not the temptation of plea-

sure, advantage, or honour, as other sins have; and therefore is a great argument of a monstrous wicked heart? And who can express God's displeasure for this sin, for which he makes sometimes a whole land to mourn? And hath not this sin provoked the Lord to utter his angry voice in plaguing and burning the city, that they might fear to abuse his name any more?

(2.) *In profane breaking of God's day.* Sabbath-breaking was an ordinary sin in London. I say not, it was so much broken in doing the ordinary works of the particular callings, but in that which was worse: how many did spend the Sabbath in eating to excess and drinking till they were drunk, in sleeping, in walking into the fields, in sports, and recreations. Many wholly neglected the worship of God on that day; and instead of that did the devil more service on the Lord's day, than all the days of the week besides.

The many weeks of Sabbaths which London had in the time of the plague, methinks did reprove London for their profaning of the weekly Sabbath: and the great fire, (I will not call it bon-fire, because so destructive to London) which was begun in the city on the Lord's day, did reprove London for those lesser fires, (I will not call them bon-fires, because so offensive to God) which not long before were kindled in the streets on that day, which called for other kind of work. Not to speak any thing, whether there were any just occasion for those fires and ringing of bells, (most of which were melted before they were

rang so generally again) and such a shew of mirth and rejoicing at that time.

The citizens carrying forth their goods, and lying in the fields with grief and fear, might put them in mind how often they had walked out into those fields on the Lord's day for their recreation: when they should rather have been hearing the word preached, or if that were over, repeating it in their own families, giving and receiving instruction, or in their closets at the throne of grace, or employed in meditation. As God delights in those that call "his Sabbaths a delight," and makes sweet promises to them; so he is highly displeased with Sabbath-breakers, and hath denounced severe threatenings against them, Jer. xvii. 27. "If you will not hearken to me to hallow the Sabbath-day; I will kindle a fire in the gates of Jerusalem which shall devour the palaces thereof, and shall not be quenched."

3. *In profane scoffing at God's people.* The name of a saint, and godly man, hath been ridiculous to many profane spirits in London, and used by them in a way of reproach. How have God's people, especially the more strict and zealous, been made the drunkard's song, and laughed at in the streets. Horrid impiety! as if it were matter of more shame to be like the holy God, than to be like the foul devil! and to be employed in the work of angels, than to drudge in Satan's chains.

No wonder if God is angry with such a place, where such vipers have had their abode; pre-

fulness is a great sin that hath brought ruin upon us.

10. *A tenth sin of London is pride.* This sin being so odious to God ; so destructive where it abounds ; and so universal in London ; I shall speak of it the more largely, both in regard of the inward workings, and the outward expressions of it: which, when opened, I believe there are none that will be able to say they are wholly free from it.

(1.) *In regard of the inward workings of pride.* Oh: how hath the poison of this sin envenomed the spirits of the most in a very high degree. How many self-admirers have there been in London, who have been puffed up with an overweening conceit of their own excellencies ; what high, towering, swelling thoughts have they had of themselves. What secret self-pleasing, and lifting up themselves in their own esteem. Some esteeming themselves for that which is matter of shame ; admiring themselves for their own wit and parts, when they have lain fallow, and not been employed for God, or when they have been employed to his dishonour ; when they have been wise, but it hath been to do evil ; when they have been men of understanding, but it hath been to practice iniquity ; when they have had cunning craftiness, but it hath been to deceive ; to defraud, and over-reach, or to plot and contrive others' mischief ; when they have had a ripe wit, quick understanding, rich fancy, fluency of speech : but the employment hath been about toys and trifles, or that which is worse, when the vent hath been in foolish, empty compli-

ments and courtship, jesting with Scripture, scoffing at the religious, or in dirty and obscene discourses.

Others have admired themselves, for that which really they never had, but only in their own imagination. Some for their parts and learning; thinking themselves great scholars when none have thought so but themselves: others for their grace and godliness, when their silver hath been dross; and their grace either counterfeit in whole, or so mixed with unperceived corruption, that upon examination they might find themselves very poor, in that which they thought themselves so much enriched with; and if they looked to the root and principle of their actions, they might find great flaws, and deficiency in those things which they had the highest conceit of.

How many in London have had very honourable esteem of themselves; preferring themselves above others, yea, above the whole world. Few have measured themselves by the rule, but measured themselves by their own fancies, or by other men's esteem. How many have thought themselves to be something, when they have been nothing, and rejoiced in their actions as excellent and admirable, not from their own proof and trial of them by the word; but from others' acceptance and commendations, and by comparing them with the actions of other men, whom they have conceited themselves to exceed. O how have some lifted up themselves above others, looking upon themselves as far more worthy, without any real ground; their eye hath

been upon their own good things, overlooking the secret evil, because it cannot be seen by men : and their eye hath been upon others' evil things, overlooking the good which hath been out of ready view : their eye hath been upon their own best things, and upon others' worst things, aggravating their faults, and extenuating their own. Thus they have in their thoughts brought others down through uncharitableness, and lifted up themselves upon the ruins, which their uncharitableness hath made in others' worth : and when they have had greater esteem because of their greater show, this opinion of themselves hath been confirmed ; whereas, in truth, others who made less show, and had less esteem, have had more sincerity, and secret hidden excellency.

I might further trace the inward workings of pride in the self-love which it hath effected ; what a marvellous affection have proud persons had towards themselves, notwithstanding their ugliness and spiritual deformity, the rottenness and corruption within them, and many lusts of their hearts ; all which pride hath covered, and a thousand faults in themselves, as charity doth cover a thousand faults in others : pride hath put a fair gloss and varnish upon all, and represented men to themselves as very lovely and amiable. Pride also hath chosen for such, their friends, who have been loved, not according to the worth which those persons have had ; but according to the estimation those persons have had of their worth, which, if those have fallen in estimation, these have fallen in affection.

I might shew the workings of pride, in the hatred, anger, spite, revenge, which it hath effected, when it hath met with disesteem or slighting: the grief at the subtraction of its fuel and provision; the solicitous thoughts and cares concerning, and eager propping, and pursuit after others' commendations; the storm of commotion and disturbance which this wind hath raised, when the tide of applause hath run another way; the complacency and delight it hath yielded in drinking out of a full stream of others' esteem, in chewing the cud, and revolving in the mind the praise of men. But so much concerning the inward workings of pride.

(2.) *Concerning the outward expressions of pride, and that,*

1. *In the speech:* London hath been grossly guilty in boasting and vain glory. What company could you come into almost, but you should find many boasting spirits? some foaming out the shame of their own praise in high expressions, and direct self-commendations, (without any regard to God's glory, self-vindication, example, or excitement; in which cases, modestly and sparingly to do it, may be lawful and a duty,) but they have done it only to be well thought on, and admired: others drivelling out their own praises more sily and indirectly; but a Christian of eyes and brains, might easily perceive that the drift and scope of the discourse hath been self, and a tacit begging of a good opinion. As if one should say, "Pray friends, think a little better of me; pray have me higher in your esteem, for to say the truth, by this I give you to understand that

I am a very worthy person." Many we shall find very forward to "declare their own goodness, but few faithful" in speaking forth the praises of God; yea, many there have been, who have discommended themselves, not that they might fall, but rise in esteem. Thus some rotten-hearted hypocrites, as full of pride as they can hold, and some sincere in the main, yet too much like them, have spoken so meanly of themselves, and so much against themselves, as none other would do; and what hath been the design? even that they might be accounted humble: and therefore they have taken care in their self-commendations, to speak of nothing but common infirmities, concealing their more gross faults; and those common infirmities, in a mourning and complaining way, as if they were very sensible of them, as if affected, afflicted, and burdened with them (as the humble, sincere Christian is indeed) that they might be esteemed for sensibility of small faults; and then they have taken care to do it, not to those that are more rigid, severe, and quick-sighted Christians, that would quickly have smelt out their pride; but unto those, which they have looked upon as the most tender, charitable persons, who are ready hereby to advance them higher in esteem; or weaker Christians, who are ready to confess more evil of themselves. And when they have thus spoken against themselves, they have not really thought so, but the contrary; but they have spoken so, that they might be contradicted, and commended to their faces; if they thought they should have fallen in esteem by such words,

they would have held their peace; but, because they supposed discommendation might most effectually promote them, and draw out a good word, therefore they have used it. Proud hypocrites speak ill of themselves that they may be accounted humble; they cannot endure to be humble; they care not for the grace; yea, they hate it; yet they would be thought to have it, because it doth promote esteem; they love the reward of humility, but they care not for humility itself; they love humility in others, because such persons will stoop to them; but they love not humility in themselves, for they will stoop to none.

Thus some also, out of a secret design of pride, have discommended others behind their backs, that they might be thought to exceed them, whom they could correct, and find fault withal; they have laboured to bring down others, that they might set up themselves. And the same design of pride they have had in commending others to their faces, and exalting them in words above themselves, not from a real esteem which they have had of them above themselves; but only that they might draw forth a commendation from them; such expressions of pride have been to be found in professors, and have been more latent.

2. Pride in clothes hath been more gross, and open, and general in the city. We read of the pride of the daughters of Jerusalem, Isaiah iii. 16, &c. "They were haughty, and walked with stretched forth necks, and wanton eyes, walking and mincing as they went, and making a tinkling

with their feet ;” and what it was they were proud of, see from ver. 18 to ver. 25. “ Their ornaments, their cauls, their tires, their chains, their bracelets, their mufflers, their tablets, their head-bands, their rings, their jewels, their changeable suits of apparel,” and the like. And hath there not been this pride in London? Were not the daughters of London like the daughters of Zion for pride and haughtiness? Was there any place in England that could shew such pride of apparel as London could shew, which not only the female sex were guilty of? Were there any fashions, though never so antick and apish, which London did not presently imitate? Who can count the cost which hath been lavished out in clothing and rich apparel ; some pinching their bellies and families to lay it out on this lust.

This pride of apparel is very shameful and absurd, clothes being the badge of apostacy, which were not made use of till after the fall, therefore the word *Baged*, which signifies clothing, comes from *Bagad*, he prevaricated ; and it is as if a thief should be proud of his shackles, or any malefactor of his mark of disgrace : at least the gaudy attire of many persons hath signified the emptiness and frothy mind within ; and that they have had nothing to set them forth, but their clothes.

I might also add, the pride, which the daughters of London have had of their beauty, though it be but skin-deep, and the body but a skin-full of dirt, and the choicest beauty without discretion, like a jewel hanged at the ear or nose of a

swine: and the Lord knows what monstrous, and defiled, and deformed insides, the most of those have had, who have been so fair and adorned outwardly. Many in London have been proud of their fine clothes, and fair faces; and others of their fair shops, and stately houses: pride has hung about the neck like a chain, and covered them like a garment, instead of the clothing and ornament of humility, which before God is of so great price.

Now God is highly offended with the sin of pride, "God resisteth the proud," 1 Pet. v. 5; he doth, as it were, set himself in battle array against them. "Pride goes before destruction, and a haughty spirit before a fall," Prov. xvi. 18. Pride was one of Sodom's sins, which city was burnt with fire from heaven, Ezek. xvi. 49. The Scriptures speak of three cities that were burnt for this sin of pride among other sins, namely, Sodom, Jerusalem, and Babylon: and may not London come in for a fourth? The botches, and blanes, and loathsome sores in the bodies of many, when the plague was in London; and the burning of so much fuel of pride, by the fire, methinks were a very loud reproof and rebuke of London for this sin.

11. *An eleventh sin of London, is fulness of bread, or intemperance in eating: this was another of the sins of Sodom. God did feed London with the finest of the wheat, and gave plenty of corn, and flesh, and other provisions; but how have they abused plenty by their intemperance and luxury. O the excessive feasting in halls, and private houses, of them whose estates have been*

more plentiful! What indulging hath there been to the appetite, as if self-denial in regard of the appetite were no duty, or an enemy, and with the poor to be shut out of doors! What curiosity of palate and daintiness have many in London had; so that air, earth, sea, must be ransacked to please them, and all would not do; what loathing have they had of ordinary food! Many good creatures of God must be cut, and mangled, and spoiled, to make them new dishes; which, however pleasing, have but spoiled their stomachs, and bred diseases in their bodies. Some have not eaten much, but they have been so choice, that scarce any food hath pleased them; and that not through sickness of body, but wantonness of mind: others have been pleased with their food, and over-pleased, and all their pleasure hath been therein; all "whose God," as the apostle speaks, Phil. iii. 19, "hath been their belly." Such, like the rich man, Luke xvi. 19, "have fared sumptuously and deliciously every day;" O the excessive cost that some have bestowed upon their tables daily! O the excessive quantity of meat that some have devoured! O the excessive time that hath been wasted in pampering the flesh! What rioting and banqueting hath there been daily in London, many feeding themselves without fear, as if gluttony were not any sin at all. How many have been like fed horses in the city, or like fatted oxen, who, as the Apostle James speaks, "have lived in pleasure, and been wanton, and nourished themselves as in a day of slaughter," James v. 5. And as Hos. xiii. 6. "According to their pasture, so

were they filled ; they were filled, and their heart was exalted, therefore have they forgotten me."

This kind of intemperance hath so strangely brutified many, that they have been even degenerated into beasts, only that they have been more unuseful ; for hereby they have unfitted themselves for all kind of service, as if they were born only to eat : but withal, they have prepared themselves for those ruining and slaughtering judgments which have come upon the city.

12. *A twelfth sin of London is idleness.* A consequent of the former ; " only that idleness" hath been more general : this was also a sin of Sodom ; I will not say but many citizens of London were diligent in their calling, but how many idle vagrant persons were there in the city ? What idleness in many of the youth, if not held in the more strictly ; and some breaking forth, and lavishing away stolen time, which was not at their own disposal, whatever strictness was used ! Moreover, what an ill example for idleness did many governors themselves give to their children and servants ! When masters were idle abroad, no wonder that servants were idle at home ; when mistresses were idle in their chambers, no wonder if the kitchen did imitate :

Though eating, and drinking, and clothing were necessary, and called for some time ; yet the excess of time spent about these things, if not worse, was no better than idle time. Many, especially of the females in the city, have spent so much time in the morning in their beds, if not in sleeping, at least in idle foolish fancies, and so much time after in neat and curious

dressing their bodies; that they have had no time before dinner for prayer or reading, no time to dress their souls; and the afternoon being far spent in eating and drinking, and the rest of the time hath run away either in visitings or entertainments, wherein, (if not worse) vain, idle, unprofitable things have been the chief, if not the only subject of their discourse: and by that time they have again refreshed them with food at night, they have been too sleepy and unfit for prayer, and the service of God. And thus many careless women in the city have lived in ease and idleness from one end of the week, and one end of the year, unto another. But methinks the Lord hath, by his terrible things in London, spoken unto them much in the same language as he did, Isa. xxxii. 9-11. "Rise up, ye women that are at ease, hear my voice ye careless daughters, give ear to my speech, many days and years shall ye be troubled, ye careless women: tremble ye women that are at ease, be troubled ye careless ones, strip ye, make ye bare, and gird sackcloth upon your loins."

But I would not charge this sin of idleness only upon the female sex: many men have been more shamefully guilty, especially those who have mis-spent so much time in gaming, (not to speak of dressing, eating and drinking, and other time-consuming sins, which are reprov'd in their proper place.) O the time that many have spent in gaming! Some recreations, wherein the body is exercised, may be lawful and necessary at some times; so they do not steal away too much of their time and affections; but for men to sit at

games as hard as scholars at their books, what rational plea can be used for such wicked idleness? Thus silver and gold, and great estates have been consumed; and O the golden hours, the days and nights, and precious time, that have been lost in gaming! Thus some have run out of all, and removed into the country to hide their shame, after their high port in the city; some have gone into the high-ways, not to beg, but to do that which is far worse, which in some hath had a dreadful conclusion. And not only this kind of idleness hath brought poverty, but also that heedless, slothful spirit, which many of the city have had in their callings; which hath made them blemishes to the city, and hath been an helper on of our ruin.

13. *A thirteenth sin of London is unmercifulness*, another of Sodom's sins, Ezek. xvi. 49. "She strengthened not the hands of the poor and needy." I shall not blame the whole for this sin, for the charity of London hath sounded throughout the land, and throughout the world. But yet have not many of the great men of the city been guilty of unmercifulness, who, though more able, yet have been less forward to contribute to the relief of such as have been in distress? It hath been the comfort of some who have lost much by the fire, that they had saved what before they had given to the poor, by putting it out of the reach of moth, or rust, or thieves, or flames of fire. But O, what marble-bowels have some had towards the poor! so that they could, (whatever abundance they had by them beyond what themselves did want) so that

they would as soon give so many drops of their blood; as pieces of money, though to help some of the needy and distressed members of Jesus Christ: not considering that the Lord Jesus is the heir of all things, and whatever estate they had, they were but his stewards; and that relief of the needy is a debt, which, though man cannot require it of them, yet God can: and it is unequal, if for want of payment of God's debts (which they owed out of their estates, by virtue of God's command, to the poor) if the Lord hath dispossessed them of his houses, and burned them with fire, and taken away part of the estates which he gave them, because they have employed them no more for his glory.

14. *A fourteenth sin of London is uncleanness*, another sin of Sodom; their sin indeed was unnatural uncleanness. I would hope that this sin hath been little known and practised in the city. But fornication and adultery have been too common. Indeed, there hath not been that boldness and impudence in this sin as elsewhere; there hath not been that whore's-forehead so generally in London, and declaring the iniquity like Sodom: but let the consciences of many Londoners speak, whether they have not been secretly guilty of this sin? Would it not be a shame to tell of the chambering, and wantonness, and privy lewdness which hath been committed in London? Suppose that in all the remaining churches the sin of uncleanness should be re-proved; and all, both men and women, that have been actually guilty of it, should be forced by an inward sting of conscience (as formerly

those were upon the words of our Saviour, that accused the woman taken in adultery) immediately to go forth out of the place: what a stir would there be in some churches; what an emptying of some pews; what a clearing of some aisles; and how few would there be remaining in some places!

Suppose a visible mark were put by God upon the foreheads of all the adulterers in the city of London, as God put a mark upon Cain after he had been guilty of murder; would not many, who walk now very demurely, and with much seeming innocency, walk with blushes in their cheeks? would not many keep house and hide their face, and not stir abroad except in the night? or if in the day, would they not shuffle through the streets, and hate the fashion of little hats, and the court mode of wearing them behind their head; and rather get such whose brims are of a larger size; which might the more conveniently cover their brows? And would not many unsuspected and seemingly modest women also, stain their cheeks with a vermilion dye upon their husbands' or friends' search into their countenance? would not many of them walk with thick hoods, and wear continually deep forehead-clothes, as if they were troubled with a perpetual headach, that they might hide their shame from the view of man?

This sin is so nasty and filthy, that whatever swinish pleasure is found in the commission of it, usually those that are guilty (unless the brow be brass) are ashamed that it should be known: the holy and jealous eye of God hath seen them

in their filthiness; their secret sins are set in the light of his countenance, which above all should make them ashamed; "Whoremongers and adulterers God will judge," Heb. xiii. 4, which above all should make them afraid.

I have heard of Smithfield haunts, and Moorfield walks, whither there hath been too great a resort from the city under the shadow of the wings of the night, about these deeds of darkness; the words and signs which such lewd persons have used to signify their minds one to another I am unacquainted withal: the many whore-houses, under the name of ale-houses, about London, by report, have had too many customers: and if the constables had been as zealous at other times, as they were when the strict press was in the city, to disturb those conventicles, they might possibly have found more of that coat, and tribe, who should have given better example.

If there have not been public stews in London, as in other cities in the world; yet have not some made their own houses little better, some men bringing in their whores in little better than public view; and of the other sex some by the open wear of naked breasts, and their light attire and carriage, have enticed the eye and courtship, and after, basely prostituted their bodies to the lusts of filthy ruffians. O the boiling, burning lusts that have been in London! O the wanton eyes and looks! the speculative uncleanness, and secret self-pollutions! the obscene and filthy speeches! the toying and lustful dalliances! and the gross actual uncleanness which God hath

been witness to every day in London! This sin of uncleanness doth debase the spirit, made at first after God's own image; defiles both soul and body, which should be the temple of the Holy Ghost; and renders men unfit for communion with an holy God, who is of such pure eyes that he cannot approve of the least iniquity, much less of this, which is so gross; and not only so, but doth exceedingly provoke him unto anger and jealousy.

This may be one sin that hath brought down such fearful judgments upon the city; we read of twenty-and-four-thousand men that fell in one day by the plague, for the sin of fornication, Numb. xv. 9. And have not many thousand inhabitants and habitations of London fallen for this sin? It is said of the Israelites, Hos. vii. 6. "They have made ready their heart like an oven; while they lie in wait, their baker sleepeth all night; in the morning it burneth as a flaming fire." Have not the hearts of many in London been like an oven for lust, and themselves like bakers putting fuel into it, and stirring it up; and if whilst they have lain in wait, and have not had present opportunity for satisfaction of their lusts, they have seemed to be asleep, no sooner hath the morning light of a fit occasion offered itself to their adulterous eyes, but their adulterous hearts have burned within them, and broken forth into a flaming fire, in the actual commission of the sin.

And hath this been the practice only of the court, and of Westminster side? Hath not the cursed leaven of this common sin of the times

spread itself also in the city? Therefore the Lord also hath made ready his wrath as in an hot oven; and though like a baker he hath seemed to sleep while he lay in wait, and delayed to execute his judgments; yet in the morning of his great provocation, by this and other sins, his anger hath broke forth like a flaming fire, from whence that fire hath been kindled which hath burnt the greatest part of London down to the ground, Jer. v. 8, 9. When "the Israelites were like fed horses in the morning, every one neighing after his neighbor's wife;" the Lord speaks to them in his wrath, "Shall not I visit for these things? Shall not my soul be avenged on such a nation as this?"

15. *A fifteenth sin of London is drunkenness.* This sin hath been more visible and apparent; I believe that scarcely any nation under heaven hath proportionably more taverns and ale-houses than England, and no place in England so many as London, and its adjacent parts: and of all the many thousands of these houses, I believe there hath been scarce any but could give many instances of this sin, besides, the many private houses where this sin hath been practised. How have men "risen early in the morning, to follow strong drink, and continued unto night, till wine inflamed them," Isa. v. 11. "Come ye, say they, and I will fetch wine, and we will fill ourselves with strong drink, and to-morrow shall be as this day, and much more abundant," Isa. lvi. 12. The corners and beds full of vomit, the reelings about the streets, the contentions and wranglings, "the wounds without cause, the red-

ness of the eyes," and such like, have been too evident a demonstration of men's "tarrying too long at the wine," and distemperring themselves with excessive drinking, Prov. xxiii. 29, 30. To be overtaken with drunkenness is a great sin, which makes men more brutish than their very horses, who will not exceed their measure in drinking, except they be forced to it by barnacles: and if none in the city had yielded to receive the drench of a cup beyond the measure, without barnacles upon their noses, I suppose, that with their horses they would have been more sober; and hereby prevented many distempers of body, and worse distempers of mind; and, which is worst of all, much dishonour of God, as well as of themselves, which excess in this kind hath been the cause of: but for men to follow after this sin, and make it their trade and common practice, to delight in it, and seek for their God and chief happiness in a cup of wine or ale, and to grow men of might in drinking; to exceed the bounds by many degrees without reeling, to entice others to it, yea, to force them to drink healths (that ungodly practice) which could not in the least promote another's health, but was likely to destroy their own, through the excess which such practices do introduce; to take pleasure in drinking down others under their feet, and after to glory in their shame and wickedness; this is a sin that doth so far exceed brutish, that it becomes devilish, and doth highly provoke the Lord to pour forth his fury like water upon the places where such sins are committed.

And hath not London been guilty of this sin of

drunkenness, with the aggravation of it? Have not some of London's magistrates been guilty, who should have punished this sin; and too many ministers, who should have reproved it both by word and example of sobriety? And for such to be seen drunk and reeling in the streets, was very shameful, and a great provocation. Have not the late judgments in some sort pointed out this sin? the dizziness of head and reeling of persons that have been smitten with the plague; the flaming of the heart of the city, and reeling of the houses, and tumbling of them to the ground by the fire, methinks were a reproof of the dizziness and reeling about the streets and houses of such persons as had inflamed and distempered themselves with excessive drinking.

16. *A sixteenth sin of London is perverting of judgment.* This is a God provoking sin: "when none calleth for justice, nor any pleadeth for truth; when men make to themselves crooked paths, and there is no judgment in their goings; yea, when judgment is turned away backward, and justice standeth afar off, and truth is fallen in the streets, and equity cannot enter; when truth faileth, and he that departeth from evil maketh himself a prey," &c. as the prophet speaks, Isa. lix. 4, &c. When magistrates are "lovers of gifts, and followers after rewards; when they judge not the fatherless, neither doth the cause of the widow come unto them;" then the Lord crieth, "Ah! I will ease me of mine adversaries, and avenge me of mine enemies," Isa. i. 13, 24. I cannot charge London deeply with

this sin ; not having been myself present much in their courts of judicature ; and I would hope that justice hath taken place here, as much as in most cities in the world : but when I read what the Lord saith concerning Jerusalem, Jer. v. 1, " Run ye to and fro through the streets of Jerusalem, and see now and know, and seek in the broad places thereof, if ye can find a man, if there be any that executeth judgment, that seeketh the truth, and I will pardon it : " and when withal I consider the dreadful judgments of God upon the city of London, whereby the glory of the magistracy and government of the city is so much stained ; I would submit it to enquiry, whether there hath not been a failure and perverting of judgment in the city ? whether bribes and rewards have not blinded the eyes, and the edge of the law hath not been turned against well-doers, instead of evil-doers ? whether the fatherless and the widow have not been sent weeping to their heavenly Father to complain of injustice ? It is not a time to cover faults, but to confess and leave them ; least unavoidable ruin come upon us when it will be too late.

17. *A seventeenth sin of London is covetousness.* How universally hath this sin reigned in the city ; so that it may almost be said of London, as it was of Jerusalem, Jer. vi. 13, " From the least of them even unto the greatest of them, every one is given to covetousness." Those who have been free from gluttony, drunkenness, adultery, and the like expensive sins, have on the other hand, addicted themselves to the sin of covetousness. I do not charge all, but O, how

almost universal hath this sin among tradesmen been; which has evinced itself both in their getting and keeping riches!

(1.) In *getting*. What eager desires after the world, and the obtaining an estate by their trades! What studies and consultations, what racking the brains, and torturing the wits, to find out the best way of thriving in the world! What earnest prosecutions have there been, and laborious endeavours, rising up early, and sitting up late, and wearying the body, and the mind all the day, eating the bread of carefulness, and mingling the drink with solicitousness, crowding up the whole time with worldly business, so that their own health hath been disregarded, as well as the worship of God neglected in the families of these worldlings, and all to scrape a little worldly riches together, which some have missed of, notwithstanding all their endeavours; and if they have obtained, yet they have remained more poor in contentment, than when they were more poor in their estates; for as their estates have increased, so their desires have increased, and been farther off from satisfaction; as they have enlarged their shops and trades, and wealth hath flowed in upon them; so they have enlarged their desires like hell, and, like the grave, have never said, It is enough: when they have added bag to bag, and house to house, the more cares and fears, and sometimes piercing sorrows have accompanied their gains; but far have they been from finding the contentment and comfort in their riches that they looked for.

(2.) This covetousness hath appeared in *keeping*

what they have gotten : keeping, I say, for covetous persons have had little heart to spend, though in necessary uses, what they have scraped together : they have had wealth, but the use of it they have not had ; it hath been to them like a treasure in a chest, of which they had lost the key ; or like another man's money in their keeping, which they must not meddle withal. What ever abundance they have had in the bag, and in the coffer, their families have been in want ; the table hath been penurious, the back and belly have been pinched ; they have lived at a meaner rate than those that have been of a meaner degree. The poor might starve at their doors ; no pity towards others in want and misery, and the least pity towards themselves ; whilst they have saved, for fear least afterwards they should want, they have all along wanted, whilst they have been saving ; and it may be at last they have lost what they have been keeping, to the inexpressible grief, and it may be, breaking of their hearts, which have been so set upon these things.

This sin of covetousness in some hath had deeper rooting, in most hath had too much footing ; and in all hath been very heinous and abominable before God. This sin is termed idolatry in Scripture, and the covetous are stigmatized with the name of idolaters, Colos. iii. 5 ; Ephes. v. 5. It is heart-idolatry forbidden in the first commandment. That thing we make a God to ourselves, which we chiefly affect ; if it be the world, then we make the world our God ; which is inconsistent with the true love of God the Father, the only true God. 1 John ii. 15 ; Love

not the world, neither the things that are in the world; if any man love the world the love of the Father is not in him." This sin of covetousness is hateful to God and provokes his wrath, Isa. lvii. 17, "for the iniquity of his covetousness was I wroth, and smote him." Hath not God smitten London with the plague and fire, among other iniquities, for this iniquity of covetousness? When London was eagerly pursuing after the world, and all minding and seeking their own interest, without any regard to the interest of God's glory and kingdom, or care of their soul-interest and salvation, which their worldly business would not allow time for; did not the Lord send a plague, to put a stop to their trade; and give them time to seek him, and to make their peace with him in their retirements, which they could not, or rather would not find before? And when they returned with more eagerness to their trades, after the plague was a little over, that they might fetch up, if they could, what they had missed by that intermission, did not the Lord send a fire to consume much of that which they had set their hearts upon, and in large legible letters write vanity upon this idol, which so many had worshipped? Let London consider, and lay to heart this sin of covetousness.

18. *The eighteenth sin of London is extortion.* Thus covetousness hath expressed itself more grossly in some. I shall not here discourse concerning usury; but the extorting use, which some have taken of those who have been in want; the taking use upon use, and grinding the faces of the poor in their distress, no doubt is a great sin.

and very offensive to God. How many extortioners have there been in London, who have enriched themselves by impoverishing of others; "who, panting after the dust of the earth on the head of the poor," have lent money to them, not for their help, but to catch them at an advantage, that so, without mercy, they might catch away all that they had, not leaving them so much as a bed to lie on? Thus some have been like lions for cruelty, and like evening wolves, unto the poor, "tearing their flesh from their bones, and reserving their very bones to gnaw in the morning," as the Prophet speaks, Zeph. iii. 3. This sin of extortion was one of the abominations reckoned up by the prophet Ezekiel, for which God was so highly offended with Jerusalem, chap. xxii. 22: "Thou hast taken usury and increase, and hast greedily gained of thy neighbour by extortion; and hast forgotten me:" for this and other sins there mentioned, it is said, ver. 3, "Therefore have I poured out my indignation upon them; I have consumed them with the fire of my wrath." Unto this sin of extortion I may add several other ways, that many in the city have had of getting estates, which some may dispute for the lawfulness of, and because so common and gainful, the sin is little heeded; but when the Lord hath been contending with the whole city, and hath inflicted a general stroke upon tradesmen, yea, one stroke upon another, and hath trodden their trade under his feet, as seeming to be offended with something therein; methinks they should be awakened, and open their eyes, and impartially search, and labour to find

out whatever it is that doth offend him, whatever seeming disadvantage may come to them thereby: And if they will not hearken, God can take away the remainder, as he hath done a great part, and so force them to a sense of their sin.

One sinful way of getting estates, and, I am perswaded, displeasing to God, is *engrossing and monopolizing of commodities*, which many in London have done, that, having all the commodities of that kind in their hands, they might make their own market, and set their own price upon them; which, if they sold as cheap as otherwise they would do, or as others do when they are shared into many hands, (as possibly some might,) I could not condemn the thing: but when, by getting the whole into their hands, they hoist and raise the price beyond the just value, which they necessitate people to give, and that only that they might enrich themselves; this I dare confidently affirm to be unlawful: and my reason is, because hereby they prefer a lesser good, before a greater; namely, the enriching of themselves, and their families, before the more public good of making the commodity more cheap to the commonwealth. If they say, the injury which they who buy of it, will sustain, (they being so many) will be very small and inconsiderable; but the good they shall get hereby will be great, and they may be in a better capacity of doing good; I answer, that none ought to do the least injury for the reaping of the greatest advantage: it being absolutely unlawful "to do evil, that good may come thereby, and the damnation of such will be just," Rom. iii. 8, and

consequently a greater injury will come to themselves, than to those whom they injure; yea, the injury will be greater than the good which they obtain. And as for their being in a capacity of doing more good; I believe that such persons, if they do spend such gains, are more forward to spend them on their lusts, than to lay them out in charitable uses: I have not heard that the greatest monopolizers in London have been the most charitable persons.

If I were more acquainted with the mysteries of trades in the city, I fear I might find out more than one mystery of iniquity among them. If the Lord would put into the hearts of magistrates and citizens to look into trades, and to consider the equity that they bear, and take some course for rectifying abuses in them; it might be one way to obtain a more favourable aspect from heaven; and the Lord might revive again the trade of London, which now is dying and sinking to the ground.

19. *A nineteenth sin of London is lying.* It is said of Nineveh, Nah. iii. 1, that it was "a city full of lies." O the lies that have been in London! who can reckon them? Lies in the streets, loud lies, which have been cried, false news which we daily hear. Lies in the chambers, secret lies, privy false tales, which are whispered in the ears. Lies in the shop, trading lies, lies told in buying and selling. Officious lies, which some tell to do their friends a kindness. Mischievous lies, which some tell to do another an injury. We read of some, "that bend their tongue like their bow for lies, that will not speak the truth, but teach their

tongues to speak lies," Jer. ix. 3, 5. How many
 liars have there been in London? What age is
 free from this sin? The children have learned
 to lie, as soon as they have learned to speak.
 What house hath been free? How have trades-
 men been guilty of lying, which some account a
 necessary adjunct to their trade, without which
 they could not live! How many servants have
 excused one another, and themselves, when they
 have committed faults, with their lies! But of
 all lies, mischievous lies have been the worst,
 which some have invented to do an injury to
 their neighbour; such lies are more immediately
 begotten by the devil, the father of lies, and such
 liars are his most genuine offspring. But all lies
 in a sense are mischievous lies; they are mis-
 chievous to the party that tells them; even the
 officious liar cannot do so much kindness to his
 friend by his lie, as he doth injury to himself.
 What! will a man stab himself, to do his friend a
 courtesy? He that wounds his conscience doth
 worse; he that gains in his trade by his lie,
 loseth more than he gains: a bag of gold is not
 to be compared with inward peace, and the fa-
 vour of God (better than life), which, by this sin,
 is lost. Surely the Lord, being a God of truth,
 is much offended with this sin of lying. "God
 delights," saith Solomon, "in them that deal
 truly; but lying lips are an abomination to him,"
 Prov. xii. 22. Lying was one sin of Israel, for
 which "their land did mourn," Hos. xiv. 2, 3.
 And God threateneth to give "all liars their part
 in that lake which burneth with fire and brim-
 stone," Rev. xxi. 8. Methinks that one place

should make all liars to tremble. And is not this one sin which some professors also in the city have been guilty of, to the shame of their profession; for which the Lord hath sent the fire to burn down the city, to awaken us to flee from this sin, as we would escape the future fire of hell?

20. *Another sin of London is cozening, and defrauding.* This sin hath been the product of covetousness, and the companion of lying; and how ordinary hath it been among tradesmen, which many have been so accustomed to, that it hath been as easy to persuade the Ethiopian to change his skin, as to persuade them to leave off their cozening? This they have looked upon as even essential to their trade, at least as necessary to their gains; yea, some have pleaded a necessity thereof, to get a livelihood for themselves and families. But there is no necessity of any sin; duties are necessary, but sins are never necessary; and the gain which is gotten by sin, is like the gain of a garment, which hath the plague in it, which, if it bring warmth for the present, quickly also may bring sickness and death; and if cozening brings gain into the purse, it presently brings the plague into the heart, and quickly will bring the pain and punishment of hell.

To defraud another in dealing, is but a more covert way of stealing, and it is as lawful to take a purse upon the highway, as to take a shilling by fraud in the shop; the difference lies only in the degree, the nature of the sin, which is theft, is the same in both. And the Lord, as

he hath expressly forbidden this sin, so he hath threatened to avenge it, 1 Thess. iv. 6. "That no man go beyond or defraud his brother (not only in a greater thing but) in any matter, because the Lord is the avenger of all such." The several ways which tradesmen have had of defrauding, would be too large for me to speak of, neither am I so skilful as to understand. The falsifying of weights and measures is gross, a sin practised among the Jews of old, which God threatens to punish them for, Hos. xii. 7. "Ephraim is a merchant, the balances of deceit are in his hand." And both their sin and God's anger are set forth, Mic. vi. 10—13. "Are there yet the treasures of wickedness in the houses of the wicked, and the scant measure which is abominable? shall I count them pure with the wicked balances, and with the bag of deceitful weights? For the rich men thereof are full of violence, and the inhabitants thereof have spoken lies, and their tongue is deceitful in their mouth: therefore also will I make thee sick in smiting thee, in making thee desolate, because of thy sins." And was it not thus with London? Did they not falsify weights and measures, and falsify commodities, and speak falsely concerning the price of them, and take unconscionable gains, and yet profess kind usage of their customers, whom they did most exact upon? But if I could, I should not open the cunning ways which some have found out, of defrauding and over-reaching, lest any should learn, and be enticed to practice the sin by the very reproof of it, as I have heard some have done.

Now such persons, who have gotten their wealth by defrauding and over-reaching their brethren, bring themselves into such a snare of the devil, that very few ever get out, but are dragged by him thereby into hell: because it is not bare grieving for this sin, which is necessary to the obtaining of a pardon; but restitution is necessary; they must refund, they must restore, either to the parties themselves, or to the poor, what they have gotten wrongfully, if they be able; if not, as much as they have, otherwise they cannot be saved. No salvation came to Zacchæus till he was resolved upon restitution of what he had wrongfully gained, Luke xix. 8, 9. "God smites his hand at dishonest gain," Ezek. xxi. 18, and this is one sin which I believe God hath smitten London for.

1621. *The one-and-twentieth sin of London is prodigality and profuse spending.* Some have sinned too much through covetousness, others have spent too much through prodigality. Liberality is a great virtue, and bountiful charity an excellent grace, which London hath not been without; but prodigality is a great sin. Thus some have spent above their degree, lavishing out their estates on their tables, on their houses, on their clothes; but the worst prodigality hath been, in that which men have lavished out in the satisfaction of their lusts, in drunkenness, gaming, whoring, and the like; and especially those, who have spent profusely that which hath been none of their own, but what they have taken up on credit of others, have been most grossly guilty of this sin.

And unto this sin of prodigality and profuseness, I may refer the sin of excessive mirth and jollity, which hath been in London. There is a harmless mirth, which is lawful; and there is a spiritual cheerfulness, which is the duty of Christians; though in times of great sin, and affliction of God's people, sackcloth and mourning doth become Christians; and some expressions of joy which are more carnal, should be much forborne; but I am speaking of the mirth of such, who have had the least ground for mirth of any, namely the wicked, unto whom no peace nor joy in that estate doth belong: for them to be so excessively merry, and jovial, and frolic, expressing it in their profane, obscene, and scurrilous jesting; in their music, singing, and dancing; in their ranting, roaring, and carousing; in many wasteful and profuse ways of spending; when the church is in sackcloth, and lies a bleeding; as too many in London have done: surely God hath been offended with this, and hath been provoked to send down his judgments, to alter the cheer of London, and hereby to put them into mourning, which they were so averse unto.

Had they foreseen the plague, and how many of them should have fallen by it, surely it would have damped their mirth; had they foreseen the burning of the city of London, and that their houses should have fallen by the fire, surely their laughter would have been turned into heaviness. These judgments they could not foresee; but future judgment, far more dreadful, they might have foreseen, which should have

made an impression of sorrow upon them; if possibly by repentance they might avoid and escape it. "Be afflicted, and mourn, and weep, let your laughter be turned into mourning, and your joy into heaviness," James iv. 9. Such mourning, if for sin, might be a means to prevent future miseries, and eternal woe and weeping; others they have reason to mourn for these miseries which will come upon them. "Go to now, ye rich men, weep and howl, for the miseries that shall come upon you," James v. 1. But for profane wicked persons to sing, and rejoice upon the brink of the grave and hell, is very unreasonable, and an aggravation of their other sins.

82. *The twenty-second sin of London is envying.* And this sin was to be found not only in women, which envied others that exceeded them in beauty of body, in clothes, and dressing, and such like toys; but also in men, who envied them who were of the same trade, which had better houses and shops, more custom and wealth, than themselves. Yea, this envying was to be found among many ministers, who envied others that had better parts, and more learning, greater applause, and more auditors than themselves. There was a "spirit among us which lusteth to envy," James iv. 5, which, besides the great torment that it brings to the spirit where it reigns, is a very great provocation to the Lord.

83. *The twenty-third sin of London is slandering and backbiting,* which hath been the consequent of the former. The ninth commandment hath been exceedingly broken in London, espe-

cially in a private way of bearing false witness against the neighbour, and wounding his reputation by a slanderous tongue, some inventing lies, and raising slanders, which they have in their consciences known to be false; others taking up slanders, readily believing them without any just reproach. This sin you have set forth with a caution to take heed of such persons, Jer. ix. 4, 5. London hath been full of backbiters and tale-bearers, and too many professors have been guilty of this sin; few have entertained backbiters with an angry countenance, which, as the wind driveth away rain, would have driven them out of sight. I might here add the hatred of one another that hath been in London (much through slanders), the emulation that hath risen from hatred, the wrath that hath risen from emulation; and the wrath of God, which hath arisen from these and other works of the flesh, spoken of, Gal. v. 19, 20.

24. *The twenty-fourth sin of London is murmuring;* and that not only in want, and under losses and crosses, but also in fulness and plenty. Many farmers in the country have murmured at the plenty and cheapness of corn: many tradesmen in the city have murmured at the plenty of the commodities which they have dealt in: because, however such plenty is a public and unspeakable mercy, yet they have had the less private advantage, which hath been chiefly regarded by them. Yea, some, in their murmurings have wished for a plague, that the survivors might have the better trade; and I have heard that a fire also had been

wished for, to take off the plenty of such commodities, that the remainder might bear the higher rate. Is it a wonder, then, if God have sent plague and fire, which some have called for by such murmuring speeches? The Israelites in the wilderness were plagued for their murmuring, and the murmuring company of Corah, that were not swallowed up with him, were consumed by a fire from heaven.

25. *The twenty-fifth and last sin of London which I shall speak of, is carnal security, another of Sodom's sins. It is said of the Sodomites, Luke xvii. 28, 29. "In the days of Lot, they did eat, they drank, they bought, they sold, they planted, they builded: but the same day that Lot went out of Sodom, it rained fire and brimstone from heaven, and destroyed them all."* When London had provoked God so highly by so many sins, yet how secure were they before his judgments broke forth upon them; they ate and drank, they bought and sold, &c. They sat at ease, and put far from them the evil day; as, Amos vi. 1, 3., they were still and at rest, little expecting such changes as have come upon them, and took little care to prevent them: they were secure and trusted in arms of flesh, broken reeds, which have always failed. And I might add here, as a cause of the security of some, the presumptuous confidences of future events, which belong only to God to foreknow, which some have taken upon them so absolutely to determine, as if they had looked into the book of God's decrees, or had an infallible revelation from him of what should come to pass. O the good days that some

have looked for, upon presumption of what they had no ground for. Great expectations many had of the fall of Antichrist and Babylon in the year 1666; and other events, limiting times, which God hath not clearly revealed, which is an entrencing upon God's prerogative, and I believe a greater provocation than such persons are aware of. This may be one reason why London is fallen instead of Babylon, in this year of such expectation and presumption.

By this time, it may be, the reader may be wearied with reading, as I am with thinking and writing of London's sins. But how hath the Lord been wearied with the bearing of them! how hath he been pressed with the weight of them, as a cart is pressed that is full of sheaves! Amos ii. 13. If, when you have read of London judgments withal, you consider London's provocations, you must needs acknowledge that God is righteous, in that he hath punished London no more than they have deserved for these sins.

SECT. IX.

God's righteousness will further appear, if we consider that he hath punished London less than her iniquities deserved.

1. God might have punished London deservedly with more dreadful judgments here, and that both in the same and another kind.

1. God might have deservedly punished London worse in the same kind.

1. In the judgment of the plague. It was a dreadful plague indeed; but God could have made it more dreadful: where he shot one arrow, he might have shot an hundred: he visited many families, he might have visited every family, and swept every house with the besom of destruction. Though so many fell, yet I believe that five parts in six of the inhabitants of London were preserved. God might have taken away the five parts, and have left but one alive; yea, it might have been said of London, as it was of Israel, Amos v. 2, 3. "The virgin of Israel is fallen, she shall rise no more; the city that went out by a thousand shall have an hundred." God might have trebled the hundreds that died by the plague; he might have sent out his arrows after all the inhabitants of London that were gone into the country, and smitten them wheresoever he found them; or he might have met with them upon their return home, and given commission to Death to lay hold on them as soon as they entered into their doors. He might have depopulated the city of London by the plague; so that every house should have had dead corpses lying, and none to bury them. He might have made our plague wonderful, fearful, and of long continuance.

We that have survived so great a mortality, have reason to say, that deservedly it might have been greater; that we deserved as much or more to fall for our more heinous sins, than thousands that are gone down into the pit: surely "it is of

the Lord's mercies that we are not consumed : " he was merciful in sparing of us ; he would have been righteous if he had destroyed us.

Think with yourselves, you that are alive, and remain escaped, how fearful would the plague have been if it had come home to your houses : you were afraid to hear of others' houses visited and shut up, what would you have been if it had entered your doors ? You were afraid when others were struck with the disease, what would you have been if you had been struck yourselves ? Sinners, what would you have done if the arrow had pierced through your livers, if, under such guilt and wrath, you had been smitten ? When you had such a plague of sin in your hearts, if you should have had the plague of pestilence in your bodies ; if when you were so rotten and corrupt, and defiled inwardly, you should have had boils, and blains, and running sores outwardly ; if when conscience was so filled with guilt, your bodies should have been filled with this disease : in a word, if, when you had the marks of hell and damnation in your souls, you should have had the marks of inevitable death in your bodies. O the dread that would have seized upon you ! The judgment of the plague might have been worse to you : you might have spent above a year in hell by this time among devils and damned spirits ; you might by this time have been inured to those torments which yet you could not have endured, but must have endured, without any possibility of deliverance for ever.

Many of you who have escaped, have your families unbroken, when other whole families are

swept away. Suppose thy dear wife had fallen, or thy hopeful children had been nipt by death in the very bud, and your families had been maimed, the judgment would have been much sorer on you. None can say but God might have righteously punished London more severely by the plague.

(2.) God might have punished London also more severely by the *fire*. The greatest part of the city is fallen; it might have been the whole: most of the city within the walls is consumed; the flames might have issued forth at all the gates, and consumed all the suburbs too: all the goods might have been burnt with the houses, and all the inhabitants with the habitations.

The fire, though it burned dreadfully, yet it began at one end, and came on so slowly, that most of the inhabitants of London had time to remove themselves and the choicest of their goods: some livelihood was left, and materials for a future trade.

Suppose the fire had been so sudden, or had been kindled in so many places, that there had been no possibility of removing any thing, except the persons themselves. Suppose all the silver, and gold, and rich plate of the city had been melted by this fire; that all the wares and merchandize, all the garments, beds, and household goods had been turned into ashes, and many thousand families that had been turned out of house, had been turned out of all, and quite bereaved of all their substance, so that nothing had remained to them for necessary use; this would have been very sore.

Alas ! what would they have done ? Whither would they have gone for relief ? Would the court have supplied them ? Could the country have helped and maintained so many, when so much impoverished themselves, that in many places they are hardly able to live ? Could they have hoped for relief from foreign nations ? Are not all the world almost our enemies ? Is charity so warm abroad ? Alas ! what would they have done ? Must not many of them have pined away in their wants, and starved under hedges, for lack of suitable provisions ? This would have been dreadful indeed !

Or suppose they had lugged their goods out of London from the fire, and the whole city had been burnt down with all the suburbs, and no habitations left standing hereabouts ; what would they have done with their goods ? where would they have disposed of them ? How could they any ways have continued their trades ? Where could they have disposed of their persons ? How could they have lived this cold winter season ? Could they have struck up booths presently, fit for themselves to abide in, which would have sheltered them from the injury of the weather ? Where would they have had materials, when all was burnt ?

Alas ! what would they have done ? must not their goods have been spoiled, by lying abroad ? would not they themselves, who had been used to so much tenderness, have quickly grown sick, and died in the fields ? would not thousands have starved for cold ? and what provisions could they have had for food and other necessities ?

Besides, would they not have been a prey to thieves and cut-throats? Would not many of their enemies, who laughed at the fall of the city, have rejoiced much more, and taken advantage to come upon them in their nakedness, and butchered them without mercy.

But, suppose the fire that begun at one corner, had been kindled in every gate at the same time, when all the inhabitants had been asleep in their houses, and they had been inclosed with flames, and no possibility of escape, how dreadful would the fire have been then? If, when they awakened in the morning, they had seen the smoke ascending round about them, and the fire drawing near to them; if both ends of a street had been on fire together, and they in the midst, and had heard, with the roaring of the fire, a greater roaring of the people that were burning with the houses: O the rueful looks! Oh the horrible shrieks by women and children! Oh the dreadful amazement and perplexity which would have been in such a place and case! To be burnt alive, is dreadful; but think what tortures would have been in the spirits of guilty sinners, who had not made their peace with God, that had slept out the harvest and day of grace, that had made no provision for death and eternity! The noise and roaring without, would have been nothing to the lashes and tearings within them; the fire in their houses would have been but small, in comparison of the fire in their consciences; and the flames of hell-fire, which, if awakened, they would have seen just before them.

This judgment of the fire might have been

more dreadful than it was; persons are escaped; goods and wealth much saved; houses standing to receive them; trade going on: God might have punished London more sorely in the same kind.

2. God might have punished London more severely in other kinds of judgments.

(1.) He might have brought upon them, and upon the whole land, the sword of a foreign enemy, as he did upon Jerusalem, and the land of Judea, for their sins; which being so pathetically set forth by the prophet, Jer. iv. 16 to the end, I shall represent to the eye.

“A voice declareth from Dan, and publisheth afflictions from Mount Ephraim. Make ye mention to the nations; behold, publish against Jerusalem, that watchers come from a far country, and give out their voice against the cities of Judah: as keepers of the field they are against her round about, because she hath been rebellious against me, saith the Lord. Thy way and thy doings have procured these things unto thee: this is thy wickedness, because it is bitter, because it reacheth unto thine heart. My bowels, my bowels! I am pained at my very heart, my heart maketh a noise within me; I cannot hold my peace, because thou hast heard, O my soul, the sound of the trumpet, the alarm of war. Destruction upon destruction is cried, for the whole land is spoiled, and my curtains in a moment. How long shall I see the standard, and hear the sound of the trumpet. I beheld, and all the cities were broken down at the presence of the Lord, and by his fierce anger; for thus hath

the Lord said, The whole land shall be desolate, for this shall the land mourn, and the heavens above be black. The whole city shall flee, for the noise of the horsemen, and the bowmen; they shall go into the thickets, and climb up upon the rocks; every city shall be forsaken, and not a man dwell therein; and when thou art spoiled, what wilt thou do? Though thou clothest thyself with crimson, though thou deckest thyself with ornaments of gold, though thou rentest thy face with painting: in vain shalt thou make thyself fair; thy lovers shall despise thee, they will seek thy life; for I have heard a voice, as of a woman in travail, and the anguish as of her that bringeth forth her first child: the voice of the daughter of Zion, that bewaileth herself, that spreadeth forth her hands, saying, Woe is me now, for my soul is wearied because of murderers." This might have been the judgment, and these the complaints of London and England, which would have been worse than plague or fire. The plague reached many, but the sword might have reached all; the fire devoured houses, but the sword might have devoured the inhabitants. The Lord might have brought a foreign sword, and open invasion; or he might have given up London to a more private, sudden butchery and *massacre* by the hands of cruel Papists, as was feared; which would have been more dreadful than the massacre of the Protestants by the Papists in Paris; because our numbers do so far exceed those which were in that city.

If bloody Papists had come into our houses in

the dead of the night, with such kinds of knives in their hands as were found after the fire in barrels; and having set watch at every street's end, had suffered none to escape, but cruelly slaughtered the husband with the wife, the parents and the children together, ripping up women with child, and not sparing either silver hairs, or the sucking babe; if there had been a cry at midnight, "They are come!" but no possibility of flying from them, or making resistance against them; if, instead of heaps of stones and bricks in the top of every street, there had been heaps of dead bodies, and the kennels had been made to run down with gore-blood; sure this judgment would have been more dreadful than the plague or fire, which have been among us.

(2.) God might have punished London with *famine*, which is a greater judgment than the plague or sword; if the Lord had broken the whole staff of bread, and cut off all provisions of food from the many thousand souls that lived in and about the city; how dreadful would this have been! If a famine had been so sore in London, that people should have been forced to eat one another, and their own flesh, as it was in Samaria and Jerusalem; if, instead of houses in London, God should have made the people as fuel of the fire in this judgment, as is threatened, Isa. ix. 19, 20. "Through the wrath of the Lord of Hosts is the land darkened; and the people shall be as the fuel of the fire; no man shall spare his brother; and he shall snatch on his right hand, and be hungry; and he shall

name, and God's hand, that hath been stretched forth upon London. They know that both plague and fire have had their commission from the God of heaven, otherwise they could not have wrought with such force and power.

They see God's "name," that is, the glorious attributes of his name displayed. God proclaimed his name, before Moses, when he caused his goodness to pass before him, and discovered himself to be "the Lord, the Lord God; gracious and merciful, slow to anger, abundant in loving kindness, goodness, and truth," *Exod. xxxiv. 6*. And God hath proclaimed his name before London, in causing his judgments to come upon the city, and hath declared himself to be "the Lord, the Lord God, holy and jealous, a God that can be angry when much provoked, and yet righteous in the severest judgments which he doth inflict." A man of wisdom may see God's name in London's judgments; and as he may see power and righteousness in God's name, so he may see grace and goodness in the name of God, which hath passed before the city; he may see and know that God hath a gracious meaning and design of good to London in these judgments; he may see God's name, and hear God's voice, and what it is that he speaketh by the rod.

Oh that London were thus wise! that they would open their eyes and see God's name! God's hand so just and righteous; as also open their ears, and hear God's voice, and understand God's design, so gracious and so much for their good! O that God would open the ears of London, and bend them to the discipline of his judgments!

that with the loss of friends and relations by the plague, and of houses and goods by the fire, they may not lose the good of these judgments too, though of another mind, yet of far greater value, which God intends them.

The enquiry then is—what meaneth the Lord by the plague and by the fire in the city? what doth he call for by this terrible voice, and look for in London, that these judgments may turn to their advantage?

SECT. XI.

The duties which God expects from London after such desolations by the Plague and Fire, are these.

1. God expects that London should awake. London hath been asleep; both the foolish and the wise virgins have been asleep; and when such a voice hath come down in these judgments, which have been revealed from heaven, crying in the midnight of their carnal security, "Behold, the great God is come forth from his place, and is entered into London in fury:" surely all should awake and arise, and prepare to meet him, seeing none can flee from him. God hath seemed to be asleep, while he exercised so much patience towards London; his arm slept in his bosom; but now the Lord hath been awakened with the loud cry of England and London's sins; his arm hath awaked, and put on strength and vengeance.

Awake! then, O London, awake! open thine eyes; draw thy curtains; come forth of thy bed; look out of thy windows. Apparitions! apparitions! strange sights to be seen! Behold! heaven is opened, and God is come down upon earth, clothed with garments of lightning; God is come down in his majesty, and looks upon London with a terrible countenance: Behold the amazing terror of God in the late strange and prodigious judgments. What! dost thou not see him? Surely thou art fast asleep still; thine eyes are closed; the veil is before them.

Awake! London, awake! open thine ears. Hark! O the trumpet that hath been sounding from heaven over the city exceeding loud! O the thunderings of the terrible voice of the angry God! the voice of the Lord hath been powerful and very dreadful. What! canst thou sleep under such a noise? surely thou art dead asleep, dead in sin and security. What will awaken thee if the judgments do not awaken thee? If a shrill and loud trumpet do not pierce thine ears, will soft music enter? if the sound of cannons be not heard, can any expect that pistols should? If, when the lion roareth in thine ears thou canst sleep still, will soft whispers awaken thee? What will awaken thee if the loud voice of these judgments do not awaken thee? The Lord called upon thee before by his ministers; by his mercies: now he hath shouted in thine ears by his judgments.

Awake! London, awake! Thou hast been roused out of thine habitation; methinks thou shouldst be roused out of thy security. What!

sleep when dying! dying by the plague, and tumbling into the grave! What! sleep when burning! burning by the fire, and tumbling into desolation! What! sleep in a storm! when winds are blowing, and waves rearing, sea entering, and ship sinking! "What meanest thou, O sleeper?" Could the heathen ship-master say, in such a case, unto Jonah, chap. i. 5, 6, when he lay fast asleep in the sides of the ship: "Arise, call upon thy God; if God will think upon us, that we perish not:" and may not I say, What meanest thou, O sleepy London; hast thou not perceived the storm that hath beaten so fiercely on thy head? dost thou not perceive that thy ship is shattered and broken, and the sea is coming in again, and thou art in danger of sinking, and that quickly, unless some speedy course be taken for prevention? And yet canst thou sleep still? Awake! arise! call upon thy God; if so be he will think upon us, that we perish not.

God calls upon *sleepy* sinners to awake. Suppose you were under the power of cruel enemies, that had killed your husbands, or wives, or dear children and friends, and you knew not how soon they might fall upon you, and cut your throats; could you sleep securely in the same house with such persons?

You are under the power of tyrannical lusts, which are far worse enemies: you are under the reigning power of sin, which hath brought the plague into the city, and whereby some of you have been deprived of these relations, and you know not how soon sin may bring death upon yourselves, not only the first, but the second

death; not only temporal, but eternal death; and deprive you not only of life, but happiness, and all hopes of the least share in it for ever. And yet can you sleep securely with sin in your hearts; with such an enemy, with such a viper, in your bosoms?

When the fire was in London, I believe few of you could take much sleep for divers nights together: when the fire was burning in your streets, and burning down your houses, you could not sleep in your houses, lest the fire should have burned your persons too: and when the fire of lust is within you, and burning within you; when the fire of God's anger is kindled above you, and burning over you; and the fire of hell, so dreadful and unextinguishable, is burning beneath you; and you are hanging over the burning lake by a twine-thread, which, ere long, will untwine of itself, and may, ere you are aware, and suddenly, be cut or snap asunder, and then you must drop into the midst of flames; can you sleep under the guilt and power of sin, when you are in such danger?

Awake! sinners, awake! God doth not burn you presently, but warns you first; he burns your houses, that you might awake, and escape a more dreadful fire. Awake! sinners, when will you awake! how often, how long, how loud shall God call upon you before you will arise? Eph. v. 14, "Awake thou that sleepest, and arise from the dead, and Jesus Christ shall give thee life."

"A little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to rest." What! can you sleep any longer now? Was not this your tone long

ago, when you were under the calls of the word? and is it the same under the rod too? What will awaken you? or when do you think you shall be awakened, if still you lie down in the bed of security, and love to slumber upon the lap of pleasure, and after a little startle, sleep faster than before?

Ministers have preached, and you have slept under their sermons; but when God hath preached, methinks you should awake. When Paul preached to Felix a sermon of judgment, Felix trembled. God hath preached one, nay, two sermons of judgment, and that more feelingly than Paul could; methinks you should awake, and not drop asleep so soon, because God gives you a little respite to learn his sermon, before he preach the third sermon, which may be your last and ruining sermon. If you do not awake by the sound of his judgments before you, you shall awake by the sense of his judgments upon you. If the plague and fire of London do not awaken you, you shall be awakened by the plagues and fire of hell, which you shall see and feel, but not be able to flee from, as here you might do, if presently awakened.

God calls upon sleepy sinners to awake, and God calls upon drowsy saints to awake; and was there not great need? were not the Jonahs gone down into the sides of the ship, and lying on pillows? Were not the wise virgins turning foolish, sleeping with the rest, untrimmed and undressed? Had there not of late a strange torpor and benumbedness seized upon the spirits of God's own people? Was not the ancier-

vigour and activity, which once they had in the ways of worship of God, much abated and decayed before these judgments came upon London.

Awake, then, ye drowsy saints, awake! put on your garments which you have laid aside, to the discovery of your nakedness; shake yourselves from the dust which hath covered and sullied your faces, and loosen the bands of sleep. God hath been thundering, your Father hath been angry, and displeased with you as well as with others. Your God hath spoken in his jealousy, and he hath spoken in his fury; he hath spoken with a loud voice in righteousness and in judgment.

Awake! ye children, your Father is stirring, and knocking, and calling; yea, he hath entered your chamber, and smitten you on this side and that; and yet will you not arise! He hath been crying in your ears, now he is looking and hearkening whether you will cry in his, and what you will say and do for the prevention of the ruin of England, which he seems to be threatening. It is high time to awake out of sleep, for now is the utter destruction of the city and nation nearer, it may be, than you believe or imagine. Awake, then, put off your clothes of night and darkness, in which you have been sleeping, and put on your garments of light; clothe yourselves with humility, and begirt you with all your graces, and get you to God's knees; hang about his arm, put yourselves in the breach; "It may be the Lord may think upon us, that we perish not."

2. *The Lord doth now, after his speaking by terrible things, expect that London should stand*

in ~~the~~ of him. God's judgments made this impression upon David, Psal. 119, 120, "My flesh trembleth for fear of thee, and I am afraid of thy judgments. And see how the prophet Habakkuk behaved himself, when God spake with a terrible voice, chap. iii. 2, &c. "O Lord, I have heard thy speech, and was afraid: when God came down from Teman, the Holy One from Mount Paran, Selah; when the pestilence went before him, and burning coals went forth at his feet; when the nations were drove asunder, the everlasting mountains were scattered, and the perpetual hills did bow; when the tents of Cushan were in affliction, and the curtains of the land of Midian did tremble: when God did ride upon horses, and his bow was made quite naked; when the sun and moon did stand still in their habitations, at the light of his arrows that went forth, at the shining of his glittering spear; when God did march through the land in indignation, and walk through the sea with his horses, and did wound the head out of the house of the wicked, and did strike through habitations with his staves: at this, the prophet is afraid, his belly trembled, his lips quivered at the voice, rottenness entered into his bones," &c. And when God hath come down from heaven, the Holy One from Mount Sion, Selah. When the pestilence hath gone before him, and burning coals at his feet; when the Lord drove London asunder, scattered the inhabitants, and made the stately buildings to bow and fall, whose rearing up none can remember; when the tents of London have been in affliction, and the curtains of

city have trembled : when death had been riding upon horses, and his bow hath been made quite naked ; when the heavens have been astonished at God's judgments, and the sun and moon have hid their heads in their habitations, at the shining of his glittering spear : when the Lord hath marched through the city in his indignation, hath wounded the heads of so many wicked with his arrows, and struck through so many habitations with his staves. Oh ! how London should tremble and quiver, and stand in awe of this glorious Majesty, at the voice of these terrible judgments !

Read, and apply what the Lord speaketh by the prophet Isaiah, chap. xxxiii. 18, 14. " Hear ye that are afar off, what I have done, and ye that are near, acknowledge my might. The sinners of Sion are afraid, fearfulness hath surprised the hypocrites ; who among us shall dwell with devouring fire ? who among us shall inhabit everlasting burnings ?" ver. 18. " Thine heart shall meditate terror : where is the scribe ? where is the receiver ? where is he that counted the towers ?"

Methinks the sinners now in London should be afraid, and fearfulness should surprise the hypocrites ; when God hath sent so many of their number into the everlasting burnings of hell by the plague, and by such a devouring fire hath consumed so many habitations.

Tremble, ye sinners, at this, and be ye horribly afraid, all ye workers of iniquity ! God hath come down with a shout, the Lord with the sound of a trumpet. He hath taken his weapons in his hand, and hath appeared in London as a

furious enemy; should not this make the sinners in the city to quake, and strike a dread upon the spirits of the rebellious? When the Lord hath spoken thus, and done thus, because of our sins, should not London, yea, all England, "hear and fear, and do no more so wickedly."

Because God was patient formerly, you presumed, Eccles. viii. 11. Because sentence against your evil works was not speedily executed; therefore your hearts were hardened and resolved in your evil ways. Because the Lord kept silence, you thought he was altogether such an one as yourselves, Psal. l. You thought, it may be, that he took no more notice of you than you did of him, or that you had no more reason to fear him than he had to fear you. You thought, it may be, that God had forsaken the earth, or had hidden his face, and would never see your wickedness. And oh, how bold have you been; how audacious and fearless in sin! You were afraid to offend man, though a worm, and yet you have not been afraid to offend God, the King of the whole world. Men's laws have kept you from sins, but the laws of God have not put upon you the least restraint. You have lived and sinned as if there were no God; or as if he had been so gentle, and mild; and merciful, that you might do any thing to him, and he not be displeased with you; or, as if though he were displeased, yet his displeasure were not to be regarded, and that he had no power to execute vengeance upon you.

But now God's patience hath, in a great measure, been turned into fury. : Now, sinners, you may perceive a little that God can be angry ;

and when his anger is kindled but a little, if it doth express itself so dreadfully, what dreadful expressions will there be of it, when it breaks forth into an open flame? If his anger be such in the day of some lighter, temporal judgments, what will it be in the day of the revelation of the treasures of it, upon all the wicked, at the appearance of Jesus Christ?

But God's vengeance now in these judgments should work your hearts to a fear and awe of this righteous Judge, who hath done such executions in the city; it should bridle and stay you in that fearless course of sin, in which you were rushing on, as the horse rusheth into the battle.

When Balaam's ass saw the angel stand in the way with a drawn sword, he was afraid, and would not go forward, though spurred on, and beaten by his master. And when God stands in the way with his sword of judgment, which hath made such slaughter already, and is lifted up again to strike you, methinks you should be afraid and turn back. It is the way to hell that God stands in by his judgments; and will you break through all into those flames? Oh stand in awe, and sin not, commune with your own hearts. Consider what hath been doing in London, and who hath done these things. You have nearly escaped, it may be, with your lives; oh learn to fear the glorious and fearful name of the Lord God in these dreadful judgments.

And as God doth expect that the world and his enemies should stand in awe of him; so also much more, that the righteous and his people should. Some, it may be, when God gave them

free access to him, and admitted unto familiarity with him, and encouraged them to boldness and confidence, and strewed their path with nothing but mercies; such might abuse his goodness, and forget to mingle faith and love with due reverence and respect; and begin to be too saucy with God, and peremptory; and did not consider their original distance, but forgot the severity which they deserved for sin. Therefore God appears in the way of these judgments with such terrible rebukes, that his own people might be brought unto a due awe and fear of his name; that, if they love him, they may fear him too; if they pray with boldness, they may pray also with reverence; if they rejoice in his goodness, they may tremble also at his judgments.

3. *God doth expect that London should now search and try their ways.* When God had punished Jerusalem with dreadful judgments, in the lamentation of which the prophet Jeremiah doth spend a book, see what use and improvement he calls upon the people to make hereof, Lam. iii. 40. "Let us search and try our ways, and turn again unto the Lord." This was the practice of David in the day of his trouble, Psal. lxxvii. 6. "I communed with mine own heart, and my spirit made diligent search." It hath been a "day of God's wrath in London, a day of trouble and distress, a day of wasting and desolation, a day of darkness and gloominess, a day of clouds and thick darkness," as it was in Jerusalem," Zeph. i. 15. There have been dark and thick clouds over London, which in part have broken into dreadful storms; and amazing tempests of God's anger,

expressed in the late judgments: and all have been the product of London's sins, which may yet produce far worse effects. London is then called upon with a loud voice to search and find out those sins, which have been the troublers of the city. I suppose that true citizens would be forward to search after those persons that had a hand in the first kindling and carrying on the fire, which burned their habitations to the ground. Give me leave, and I shall make a discovery of London's incendiaries, how you may find the persons, how you may trace their footsteps, what marks they bear, what their names are, and where their abode: and need I lead you far in the search? The sinners, the sinners of London did kindle the fire of London; it was sin which fired the first house, and sin was like oil poured upon the flames, which put such fury into them, that none could withstand until the greatest part of the city was fallen and turned into ashes: the swearers, the Sabbath-breakers, the adulterers, the drunkards, the unrighteous, the profane, and the like sinners have been London's incendiaries, and had a hand in pulling down this and other judgments upon the place where they lived: and is it hard to find out these persons? are they gone far from the place of their former abode? The skirts of London are remaining, and if you turn up the skirts, or turn your eye under them, and look into the houses standing about the city, may you not find many of these persons, these vile sinners inhabiting, who are still blowing hard at the fire of God's anger, and pulling hard with cords of vanity and sin, for further judg-

ments? Search, London, search, and find out thine enemies, thy destroyers; hast not thou destroyed thyself? Search, and find out thy sins, which have brought such mischiefs and ruins upon thee.

Sinners, enter into your closets, retire into yourselves, take the candle of the Lord, and look into your inner rooms; make a strict search into your hearts, find out those filthy lusts which lodge in dark corners, and bring them forth to be slain; read over the old records of your lives, consult the register of your consciences, revolve in your minds your former sins: take the glass of the word, and look upon your faces in it, and see how many spots it will discover which you never before did perceive; not beauty-spots, but spots of deformity, plague-spots, death-marks, hell-tokens, such as will bring upon you inevitable misery, unless they be wiped off; take the rule of the Word, and measure your actions by it, and you may quickly perceive how much they have fallen short, how crooked they have been, *Rectum est index sui et obliqui*: compare your actions with the straight rule of God's law, and you may find out many irregularities; if you do not find out your sins, your sins will find you out, and God's judgments will find you out; and if you be found out in your sins, woe be to you. O the horror which will be upon your consciences when ruining judgments are inflicted upon you particularly, and you cannot escape; when death looks you in the face, and comes with the sting of sin in its mouth to devour you. But, O the horror you will be

under hereafter, if you be taken away in your sins; when your souls shall be summoned, immediately after their separation, unto the bar of God, where you will be searched, and tried, and condemned to everlasting torment, by an inevitable and irreversible sentence of the Judge himself: O therefore hearken to the voice of God in these temporal judgments on the city, (after which you still remain alive, through infinite patience) which calls upon you to search and try your ways, that you may escape more fearful judgments which may be preparing for you: labour to find out your sins, which are the cause of all judgments, temporal and eternal; and to help you in your search after sin, read the catalogue I have given you of London's sins, and examine yourselves thereby: be very serious, and thorough, and impartial, in this search; sequester yourselves often from all company; ease your mind of the load of worldly business; leave the carriages at the bottom of the hill; strive against temptations and indispositions to the work; set yourselves in the presence of the heart-searching God; beg the help of his Spirit to discover to you what hath displeased and provoked him; search after sin as offensive to God, and as destructive to yourselves, as your worst enemy, as the cause of plague and fire in London, and as that which will bring the plagues and fire of hell upon you, if it be not found out and subdued.

4. *God doth expect that London should acknowledge their sins unto him.* When the Prophet had directed the people to search and try their

ways, after the execution of such judgments upon them, Lam. iii. 40, see the following direction, verses 41, 42. "Let us lift up our hearts with our hands unto God in the heavens: we have transgressed, and have rebelled," &c. Thus the prophet doth confess the sins of Jerusalem, chap. i. 8, 9. "Jerusalem hath greatly sinned, therefore she is removed. Her filthiness is in her skirts, she remembered not her last end, therefore she came down wonderfully." And thus the daughter of Zion, as she bewaileth her affliction, so she acknowledgeth her transgression, verse 17, 18, 20. "Zion spreadeth forth her hands, and there is none to comfort her. The Lord is righteous, for I have rebelled against his commandment. Behold, O Lord, for I am in distress, my bowels are troubled, mine heart is turned within me, for I have grievously rebelled." Thus Daniel, after dreadful judgments, maketh a confession of the sins of the people of Israel, chap. ix. 4, 5, 6. "I prayed unto the Lord, and made my confession, and said O Lord, the great and dreadful God, we have sinned and committed iniquity, and have done wickedly, and have rebelled, even by departing from thy precepts and thy judgments: neither have we hearkened unto thy servants the Prophets, which spake in thy name to our kings, our princes, and our fathers, and to all the people of the land," and ver. 11, 12. "Yea, all Israel have transgressed thy law, by departing, that they might not obey thy voice; therefore the curse is poured upon us, and the oath that is written in the law of Moses, the servant of God, because

we have sinned against him : and he hath confirmed his word which he spake against us, and against our judges that judged us, by bringing upon us a great evil : for under the whole heaven hath it not been done, as it hath been done upon Jerusalem."

God doth expect that London should find out their sins, and having found them, that they should make confession of them. O that the profane and ungodly generation in London, whose sins have been enumerated in the catalogue, would be persuaded to get alone by themselves, and consider their evil ways, and what the consequence of their sins have been in bringing down temporal judgments ; what the consequence of their sins is like to be, even the bringing upon them eternal judgments, and that they would fall down and prostrate themselves at God's foot, and covering their cheeks with shame and blushing, because of their filthiness and foul sins under the view of so holy an eye ; that they would acknowledge their transgressions unto him, not only in general, but also particularly, with their heinous aggravations ! O that with an inward deep sense, with a bleeding, broken heart, they would fill their mouths with confession ; that they would take to themselves words, and say, " We have rebelled against thee, O Lord, and done wickedly, and grievously offended thee ; so foolish have we been, and ignorant of thee, we have been worse than beasts before thee : the ox acknowledgeth his owner, and the ass his master ; but, though we are thy creatures, and live upon thy bounty, and are daily at thy

finding, yet we have not acknowledged thee, and have had less consideration than those creatures, who have had no reason; we have been sinful people, laden with iniquity, a seed of evil doers, children that have been corrupters, who have forsaken thee, and by our wickedness provoked thee to anger. We have been stubborn and disobedient, serving thine enemies, the devil and our own lusts; but have neglected, yea, refused to serve and worship thee in our families and closets, living as if there had been no God in the world. We have seldom, if ever, taken thy name into our mouths, unless it hath been in vain, unless in our oaths and curses. We have profaned thy Sabbaths, and defiled thine ordinances, and have often been more wicked on the Lord's-day, than any day of the week besides. When we were children, we disobeyed our parents, but disobeyed thee much more, who didst command us to honour them: when we were children in years, we were grown men and women in sin; when we were weak in body, we were strong in spirit to commit iniquity; we learned the trade of sin before any other, and were apt scholars in the school of the devil, when dull and blockish to learn any thing which was good: we were wise to do evil, when to do good we had no understanding; our iniquities have increased over our heads, faster than our years have done; since we have been governors of others, we have had no government upon our own spirits, and have endeavoured to lead those under our charge with us in the way to hell, instead of labouring to draw them into the way

of heaven, by our example, command and persuasions; and we have filled up all our relations with sin, instead of filling them up with duty. If we have not murdered any with our hand, we have murdered many with our tongue; swords have been in our lips, and bitter reviling speeches in our mouths; heart-murder we have been guilty of. O the inordinate anger that hath boiled in our hearts! O the envy and malice which have gnawed our spirits, and been working daily within us! and especially those persons have been most hated by us, who have had thine image upon them, and have been best beloved by thee; we have scorned them, and looked upon them as mean-spirited people; we have separated them from our company, as those who damp and spoil our mirth by their words and looks of reproof; yea, we have persecuted them, as seditious and factious persons; when in truth, it was their holiness and conversation that did contradict and condemn our wicked practices, which did stir up our anger against them; we have scoffed at them, who have prayed for us, and we have looked upon them, and dealt with them as our enemies, because, as to our lusts, who were the best friends to our souls, and above all things desired our salvation. Thou hast given us corn, and wine, and oil, and plentiful provisions for our body, but we have abused thy mercies by our intemperance and luxury: we have been guilty of drunkenness and gluttony; we have indulged our flesh and sensual appetite; we have lived in pleasure and been wanton; we wallowed like so many swine,

in the mire and dung of some filthy sins, which it is a shame to speak of; we have had eyes and hearts full of lusts and adultery, and have broken forth into such vile actual sins of uncleanness, as would raise blushes in modest cheeks to hear but the mention of: we have been unjust and unrighteous in our dealing, have wronged and defrauded our neighbour, though thou hast threatened to be avenged on all such persons. O the lies we have spoken, the slanderous backbiting speeches that we have uttered! O the discontentment, murmuring, envying, evil concupiscence, inordinate affection, and wicked distempers which have been in our spirits! And though we have broken all thy laws, and are guilty of such notorious sins, yet, O the impenitency and hardness of our hearts! though no salvation is attainable but by Christ, who is freely tendered unto us, yet O the unbelief of our hearts, and neglect of our own salvation! We have sinned, we have sinned against thee; and what shall we do unto thee, O thou preserver of men!

God expects that London should make confession of their sin, and it could be wished that London would join together like one man in this work; but if this cannot be, and they want common mouths to open their hearts and sins before the Lord in particular confession, let every one of them be a mouth to himself, and get into his closet, and there acknowledge London's sins: and if those who are most guilty, do neglect this work, let God's people do it in their room, and confess not only their own sins, but

also the sins of the profane and wicked, where they live, and that not only because God is dishonoured, but also because they are in danger of being ruined by the unbewailed sins of others.

5. God doth expect that London should be humbled under these judgments. God inflicted judgments on the children of Israel in the wilderness, "to humble them," Deut. xiii. 16, and he promiseth, after the sorest distresses, which he brings his people into for their sins, to remember his covenant, "if their uncircumcised heart, be humbled," Levit. xxvi. 40-42. Yea, he promiseth to exalt such in due time, "who humble themselves under his mighty hand," 1 Pet. v. 6. God's mighty hand hath been stretched forth upon London; God expects that London should be humble; he hath humbled them by his judgments, he expects that they should humble themselves under his judgments. God hath stained the pride of London, he expects that they should let down their plumes; he hath brought them down, and he expects that they should lie low; he hath brought poverty upon many of them in regard of their estates, and he expects that all of them should be poor in regard of their spirits: he hath made many of them mean in regard of their condition, and he expects that their disposition and affection should be accordingly. God hath laid many persons in the dust by the plague, and he hath laid many houses in the dust by the fire, and he expects that those which survive and remain after such judgments, should lay themselves in the dust for

their sins. Humble thyself then, O London, humble thyself before the Lord; lick the dust of his feet, put off thy ornaments, and gird thee with sackcloth, clothe thyself with humility, God hath spit in thy face; wilt thou be proud of thy beauty again? he hath burnt the city with fire, wilt thou be proud of thy buildings and stately edifices any more? he hath consumed much of the fuel of thy pride, and he expects that thy pride should be abated, and that thou shouldst abase thyself, and humble thyself before him.

8. *God doth expect that London should accept of the punishment of their iniquity.* Levit. xxvi. 40—42. "If my people shall confess their iniquity, and the iniquity of their fathers, and be humbled, and accept the punishment of their iniquity, then will I remember my covenant, and remember the land." God expects that London should justify him in the severest judgments which he hath inflicted upon them; as they should acknowledge their sins, so they should acknowledge their demerit, and that the Lord hath punished them no more, yes, that he hath punished them less than their iniquities have deserved: as they should bring a bill of indictment against themselves, so they should bring a bill of acquittance of God; God expects that they should say, as Neh. ix. 38. "Thou art just in all that is brought upon us; for thou hast done right, but we have done wickedly." Or as Dan. ix. 7, 8. "O Lord, righteousness belongeth unto thee, but unto us confusion of faces, because we have sinned against thee."

Let not London murmur or repine, let not London find fault and complain of God, because of his judgments, Lam. iii. 39. "Why doth the living man complain, a man for the punishment of his sin?" God hath opened his mouth, and spoken terribly; but let London shut her mouth, because God hath spoken righteously; God hath spoken with a loud voice, let London be in deep silence; "I was dumb, I opened not my mouth, saith David, because thou didst it," Psal. xxxix. 9. When Nadab and Abihu, the two sons of Aaron, were consumed with fire from heaven, for offering strange fire before the Lord, it is said, that Aaron held his peace, Lev. x. 1—3. So when God hath consumed the city of London with fire, for the sins of the inhabitants, let them hold their peace, because they have deserved it. Let London be still, and know that God is righteous; let London lay her hand upon her mouth, and her mouth in the dust; let London close up her lips, and seal them up with silence; or if she open them, let her mouth be filled with confessions, not with complaints; or, if she complain, let her complain to God, but let her not complain of him; if she complain, let her complain against herself, but let her not complain against God; let her complain of her own sin and wickedness, but not of God's judgments so righteous. Let London wonder it is no worse with her, when both her sin and her danger was so great; let her wonder, when God was so angry, that he should put any restraint upon it; that when wrath was come forth, that proceeded no farther; let her wonder that the

plague did not quite depopulate her, let her wonder it is so well with her, that she is not made a desolation, and say, "It is of the Lord's mercies that we are not consumed," Lam. iii. 22.

7. *God doth expect that London should mourn for her sins.* We read, Jer. iii. 21, "A voice was heard upon the high places, weeping and supplications of the house of Israel." When the terrible voice of God's judgments hath been heard in London, God doth hearken for the voice of weeping and supplications; this God's voice doth call for: when breaches were made in the city of David, Isa. xxii. 9. "Then did the Lord of Hosts call to weeping, and to mourning, to baldness, and to girding with sackcloth," ver. 11. And when instead hereof there was "joy and gladness, eating flesh, and drinking wine," the Lord is so angry, that he threateneth, "surely this iniquity shall not be purged from you till you die," ver. 13, 14. See also what the Lord calls for to the daughter of Zion under her judgments, Lam. ii. 18, 19, "Let tears run down like a river day and night; give thyself no rest, let not the apple of thine eye cease: arise, cry in the night; in the beginning of the watches pour out thine heart like water before the face of the Lord." God doth not only expect that "his ministers and priests should weep between the porch and the altar," when sore judgments are upon this land, as Joel ii. 17; but also that the people should weep too, "that the bridegroom should go forth of his chamber, and the bride out of her closet," as ver. 16; that people should be "afflicted, mourn and weep, that their laughter should be

turned into mourning, and their joy into heaviness; James iv. 9. He expects that those which escape his judgments "should be like doves upon the mountains, every one mourning for his iniquities," as Ezek. vi. 16. London may mourn for her judgments which have been so dreadful, but God expects they should mourn more for his displeasure, which hath been the cause of these judgments; and most of all for their sins, which have been the cause of his displeasure.

Weep London, weep for thy sins, which have been so many and provoking; let thine eye afflict thine heart; when thou lookest into thy burying-places, and thinkest how many of thy people have lately there taken up their habitation; it should draw tears from thine eyes to think of thy sins, which opened the doors of those lodgings unto them: methinks, when thou passest through thy rainous habitations, and seest the heaps of stones at the top of thy streets, when thou viewest thy half-churches, and bare steeples, and ragged walls, and open vaults; and the dismal solitude in those places, which not long ago were full of people, it should fill thine heart with sorrow for thy sins, which have kindled such anger in the breast of God, as to send the late dreadful fire, which hath made such desolations:

Mourn, London, mourn, put on sackcloth; thou seest in part what an evil and bitter thing it is to offend a holy and jealous God: the effects of sin here are fearful sometimes, what evil is there in sin, then, which is the cause of thy ruins. God looks now that the sinners of London should become mourners; we read of a mark which was

set upon the foreheads of them at Jerusalem, which did mourn and cry out for the abominations that were done in the midst thereof, and they were separated from temporal destruction, which was brought upon the rest, Ezek. ix. 4, 6. God doth set a mark upon them that mourn in London for the sins of London; and, however, he may deal with them, in regard of temporal calamities, be sure he will separate them, and preserve them from eternal destruction.

It thinks the fall of London calls for a mourning like the mourning of Hadadrimmen in the valley of Megiddo, where Joseph fell in battle, Zech. xix. 11. And there should not only be public mourning, but also private mourning, and secret mourning; families apart, and persons apart; 'tis becomes Christians now, after such strokes of God's wrath, to keep secret fasts, to bewail London's ruins, especially to bewail London's sins; their eyes should weep in secret places, for the abominations committed in the city, and bedew God's feet with their tears, that, if possible, they might turn away his displeasure.

God hath expected that London should labour to pacify his anger. When God threatened to send the sword, and to cut off from "Israel the head and the tail, the branch and the rush in one day," and to send the famine sore, that they should "eat every man the flesh of his own brother;" yet it is said, "For all this his anger is not turned away, but his hand is stretched out still;" Isa. ix. 14, 17, 20, 31. And now God hath executed his judgments of plague and fire in London, have not we reason to fear that his

anger is not yet turned away, but his hand is stretched out still? When the houses of London were consumed, which were the fuel to the late fire, then the fire quickly went out; and if the sins of London had been consumed with the houses, if the inhabitants of the city had not brought forth their sins, when they were forced to leave their goods behind unto the flames, then we should have reason to think that the fire of God's anger was gone out, and his wrath turned away from the escaped remnant of London; in-
 somuch as the sins of London have been the fuel, as it were, to this dreadful fire; but when so much sin, after such judgments, is saved alive, untouched, and unmortified: when the plague of sin doth rage so much after the plague of pestilence is removed; and the fire of lust doth burn so much, when the other fire is extinguished: when Londoners, who have taken new houses, have brought into them their old hearts, and live in the practice of their old sins; when the swearers and profane, the drunkards and unclean, the covetous, unrighteous, and loose livers, still persevere in their wicked courses, and no judgment will put a stop to them, but they grow more hardened and incorrigible; when, as it is said, Jer. v, 3, the Lord hath "stricken them for sin," but they are not grieved, chastised them, but they refuse to receive correction, making their faces harder than a rock, and refuse to return: what can we conclude, but that God's anger doth still remain, yea, is more enraged by this aggravation of their wickedness, and that he is stretching forth his hand to give them another blow.

God doth expect that London should use some means to pacify his anger, and he gives them time for it by the pauses which he makes between his judgments, being still slow to anger, and unwilling, if he be not even forced unto it, utterly to destroy this place, where his name hath been called upon. O that London would be persuaded upon this duty, which doth so much concern their safety and happiness! When the fire was in London, and it burned so furiously and dreadfully on the Monday and Tuesday, Londoners' hearts were sunk within them, having little hopes of getting victory over this conqueror, which marched through their streets; and therefore little resistance was made, but all were busily employed in flying from him, with their goods; but when the fury of the fire was something abated on the Wednesday, and they began to conceive any hopes that it might be extinguished, then they pluck up their spirits, and join their forces, and many thousand hands are at work in drawing waters, and pouring them upon the flames, and their pains, through God's blessing, was not unsuccessful. The fire of God's wrath, which shall devour the wicked, and burn them everlastingly, will be so furious and dreadful, that the hearts of the damned will sink under it without the least hopes of ever extinguishing this flame, or flying from it, when it hath once got hold of them; and therefore they will not attempt, but let alone all endeavours for ever to turn away God's displeasure, and to put out the unquenchable fire of hell: but the fire of God's wrath and anger here may be put out, and the flames of his

anger may be turned into flames of love; God's anger, which hath been so hot against London, may be cooled, his wrath alleviated, and his displeasure removed: there is hope in Israel concerning this thing. God is not yet grown so furious that he will not be spoken unto; he is easy to be entreated, and therefore London may be encouraged in their endeavours to pacify his anger. Let them not say, as Israel of old, Jer. ii. 25, "There is no hope; no, for I have loved strangers, and after them will I go." Though God's anger be not yet turned away, yet it may be turned away; and though one hand be stretched out to destroy you, yet the other hand is stretched forth to save you; "for he stretcheth forth his hand all the day long, to a disobedient and gainsaying people," Rom. x. 21. O labour then to pacify God's anger, to quench this fire; arise and gird yourselves with humility; pluck up your spirits, and stir up yourselves to lay hold on God, and stop him in the march of his judgments; bring forth your buckets, draw water, and pour it forth before the Lord; let your eyes be like fountains of tears; the voice of weeping, and mourning for sin doth turn God's bowels within him, Jer. xxxi. 18-20. "I have surely heard Ephraim bemoaning himself, 'Thou hast chastised me, and I was chastised,' &c. and when he repented after such chastisements, and was ashamed of his sin, God doth relent, and his bowels are moved for him; 'Is Ephraim my dear son? is he a pleasant child? for since I spake against him, I earnestly remember him till, therefore my bowels are troubled for him;

and I will surely have mercy upon him, saith the Lord." If London would be chastised, and receive the impressions of grief and shame for their sins by these judgments, God's bowels would be moved, and his fierce anger would be changed into tender compassion; and though he hath spoken terribly against London, yet he would now speak comfortably unto her; he would earnestly remember her, and make her glad according to the days wherein he hath afflicted her, and the years wherein she hath seen evil. There is an excellent virtue in the tears of true repentance, accompanied with the blood of Christ, applied by faith to quench the fire of God's anger.

Sinner, God is angry with you, Psalm vii. 11, "God is angry with the wicked every day," and it is worse to have God angry with you than all the terrors in the world; his favour is better than life, his displeasure is worse than death; to have God angry with you, who is so just and jealous, who is so potent and furious, is very dreadful. If the wrath of an earthly king be like the roaring of a lion, what is the wrath of the King of heaven? And when his anger is stirred up by your sins, and blown into a flame, and breaks forth upon you, what will you do? You cannot hide yourselves in any place where his all-seeing eye will not find you; you cannot fly into any place where his stretched-forth arm will not reach you; you cannot gather such strength as to make head against him, and defend yourselves from the strokes of his vengeance; "who can stand in his sight when once he is angry?" Psalm lxxvi. 7;

O then labour to pacify his anger; you cannot fly from him, O then fly unto him: you cannot stand in his sight when he is angry; O then fall down at his feet, make peace with his adversary, whilst you are upon the way, before he deliver you to the officer, death, and cast you into the prison of hell.

“Sinners, God’s patience doth us, yet hold his arm; and his mercy calls upon you to repent, and he invites you to make your peace with him, Isa. xxvii. 4, 5; “Who would set the briars and thorns against me in battle? I would go through them, I would burn them together; or let him take hold on my strength, and make peace with me, and he shall make peace with me.” You will be like briars and thorns, which will easily take fire, and quickly be consumed in the time of God’s anger; and if briars and thorns do offer to contend with devouring fire, what will be the issue, but the burning them up without remedy? You will find it sharp and painful for your feet, if you kick against the pricks; you will dash out your brains, if you run your head against a rock, or a brazen wall: none ever hardened themselves against God, and prospered; none ever fought against the God of heaven by their sins, but they were wounded, and in the end destroyed in sin, when it is finished, bringeth forth death, and wrath, and misery for ever. O then, lay hold on God’s strength, and make peace with him, run to him, take hold of the sceptre of grace and reconciliation, which is held forth unto you; take hold of his arm, and plead with him for mercy; take hold of his Son, who is offered to you, who

is set forth to be a propitiation for the remission of sins which are past, through the forbearance of God; Rom. iii. 25; as yet God hath forbore you; as yet you are on this side of the grave, and hell; and there is a possibility of turning away God's anger, which is kindled against you, of flying from that wrath which is pursuing of you, of escaping those miseries which are preparing for you; and therefore lay hold on Christ who is freely tendered unto you, who is able and willing to save you, and make your peace with the Father, and to procure a pardon for you. And further to move you; you are not only offered peace and reconciliation, but you are entreated to be reconciled; ministers entreat you; yea, God himself, and Jesus Christ by us, doth entreat, and pray, and beseech you, that you would accept of reconciliation, 2 Cor. v. 20. Be astonished, O ye heavens, and wonder, O ye angels! Be astonished much more, ye sinners! and be wrapt up with admiration, O ye rebels! the King of glory, against whom you have rebelled, and who could crush you so easily without any injury to himself, is not only willing to lay aside his anger, but also entreats you to accept of reconciliation: heartily embrace Jesus Christ upon his own terms, and the work will be done; otherwise the fury of the Lord will be so much the more provoked, and the fire of his anger will break forth into such a flame, as none shall be able to quench; otherwise the Lord will be so much the more enraged against you, and meet you like a roaring and devouring lion, or like a bear bereaved of her whelps; and rend the caul of

your heart, yea, tear you in pieces, when there shall be none to deliver." *Hosea. xiii. 7, 8; Isaiah. l. 22.*

9. God doth expect that London should turn from her evil ways, & *Chron. vii. 14.* The Lord maketh a sweet promise under the dreadful judgments of famine or pestilence, which sometimes he sendeth upon his people for their sins; "If my people, which are called by my name, shall humble themselves, and pray, and seek my face, and turn from their wicked ways; then will I hear from heaven, and forgive their sins, and will heal their land." God doth not only expect that Londoners should now acknowledge their sins, and humble themselves, and mourn for their sins; but also that they should turn from them, otherwise pardon, and healing, and his favour, is not to be obtained, neither are further judgments likely to be prevented; they must "confess and forsake their sins, if they would find mercy." *Prov. xxviii. 13*; the wicked must forsake their way of sin, and turn unto the Lord, and then he will have mercy, and abundantly pardon, *Isa. lv. 7*. God threateneth to go on to punish such as go on to transgress; *Psalm lxxii. 21*, "He will wound the head of his enemies, and the hairy scalp of such as go on still in their trespasses."

Break off, then, your sins by repentance, and cast away all your transgressions from you; put away the evil of your doings from before the holy and jealous eyes of God; cease to do evil; cleanse your hands, you sinners, and purify your hearts, ye wickedly-minded; wash yourselves in the fountain of Christ's blood, set open to you,

that you may be cleansed from all filthiness of flesh and spirit, and be partakers of holiness, and the divine nature; deny all ungodliness and worldly lusts; abstain from flesh-pleasing sins, which war against the soul; and be not conformed to the wicked customs of wicked men; neither follow this ungodly generation to do evil; much less run with them to the same excess of riot; but be ye transformed by the renewing of your minds, and live soberly, righteously, and godly in this present evil world; and let the time past of your lives be sufficient wherein you have wrought the will of the flesh, and served divers lusts, and cast a blot upon the profession of Christianity; now be blameless, and harmless, and unrebukable in the midst of a crooked and perverse nation; cast off the works of darkness; lay aside your night-vail of ignorance; put on the robes of light; walk honestly, as in the day, shining as lights where you live; forbear all works of darkness and sin; and as he which hath called you is holy, so be ye holy in all manner of conversation.

Sinners, turn from your evil ways, otherwise iniquity will be your ruin.

10. *Drunkards, turn from your evil ways;* overcharge not yourselves with excess, where God allows you enough for use. "Look not upon the wine when it is red, when it giveth its colour in the cup, when it sparkleth and moveth itself aright: at last it biteth like a serpent, and stingeth like an adder," Prov. xiii. 81, 92; wounds and woe are the issue of excessive drinking, ver. 29. This sin may be sweet and

pleasing to the eye and appetite in the temptation ; but it will wound and sting the conscience, worse than an adder or serpent can do the body, in the reflection ; God hath put bitterness into the cup by his judgments, and will you drink as deep as before ? are you resolved to taste the dregs that lie at the bottom ? The cup hath poison in it, foul poison, and will you drink of it still, though you murder and destroy your souls for ever by this sin ? The cup hath wrath in it, the wrath of an angry God ; and is it good for you to drink of the wine of God's wrath ? Drunkenness hath been your sin, and if you go on, God threateneth that drunkenness shall be your punishment, Jer. xv. 13, " Speak unto them this word, thus saith the Lord, every bottle shall be filled with wine : " drunkards like this very well ; they are very well pleased that their bottles shall be filled with wine, that they may empty them ; but understand the meaning, ver. 13, 14. " Thus saith the Lord, I will fill all the inhabitants of the land with drunkenness ; and I will dash them one against another, even the fathers and the sons together : I will not pity, nor spare, nor have mercy, but destroy them. " Drunkards, you reel and fall sometimes with your sin ; God will make you reel and fall by his judgments, and dash you one upon another ; yea, dash you in pieces, and destroy you without pity or mercy. Will you not forbear your cups and excesses ? God will put a cup of trembling and astonishment into your hand ; he will put gall and wormwood into your cup, and make you taste the bitter effects of this ; if he do not severely scourge you for this

sin here; he will be sure to torment you for this sin forever.

Turn, ye drunkards, from your evil ways; vomit up your sin by repentance; weep and groan for all your sinful mirth and jollity; and take heed of returning with the dog, and licking up the vomit which you have disgorged. Avoid the occasions of this sin; shun the company of such as have been your tempters; take heed of coming into the places where you have been drawn in to commit it; make a covenant with your feet, that they may never lead you out of the way of God, into such places, where you have been so often overtaken; curb and restrain your appetite; take some kind of holy revenge upon yourselves; deny yourselves some things which are lawful in themselves, because occasions of sin unto you; and instead of filling yourselves with wine, or strong drink unto drunkenness and excess, labour to be filled with the Spirit, and by the Spirit to mortify this and all other deeds of the body; and rather let the wicked wonder at you, and speak evil of you for your sobriety, than God hate you, and bring destruction upon you for your intemperance.

Adulterers, turn from your evil ways; come out of the unclean bed; wallow not any longer in this besmearing mire. Are you fallen into the ditch? get up and come forth with speed, and wash your garments from the spots, which they have received: are you taken in the net, and ensnared in adulterous embracements? deliver yourselves like a roe from the net of the hunter, and like a bird from the snare of the fowler. Lust not after the beauty and enjoyment of adu

temperous women; let not the soft and sweet language of their lips entice you, nor the sparkling motions of their eyes inflame you; put not fire into your bosoms, and take heed of walking upon burning coals; why will you consume your body, and time, and substance, which cannot be redeemed? Why will you bring upon yourselves a wound and dishonour which cannot be wiped off. Why will you be like oxen which go to the slaughter, and be such fools as to bring upon yourselves destruction?

Turn from your evil ways; dare not to go forward in that way which leads unto death and hell. "Marriage is honourable in all, and the bed undefiled, but whoremongers and adulterers God will judge," Heb. xiii. 4. God hath shot his arrows into the city, and wounded many adulterers for this sin, that had before defiled and wounded themselves by it; and will you go on till a shot pierce through your liver? The beginning of the sin is sweet, like honey, but will not the end be more bitter than wormwood? and if a little short pleasure of the flesh be so desirable, will not the extreme endless pain it will produce be insupportable? Can you be content to lie so many millions of years, under the horrible tortures of hell, for a little present sensual delight, which, when reaped, cannot yield you satisfaction? Is it sweet to fall into the arms of an adulterous woman? and will it not be bitter, yea, "a fearful thing to fall into the hands of the living God?" Heb. x. 31, especially when he is irreconcilably angry, and his anger burns like fire which is devouring, and unquenchable? You have seen the fire which hath burnt down the city, how dreadful it was;

the fire of lust within you is worse, and the fire of hell beneath you, which is preparing for you, and unto which, by this sin, you are hastening, is a thousand fold more dreadful, (of which more by and by) and yet will you go on? O turn from your adulterous ways; come not near the doors of such houses, where you have had incentives to lust, and opportunities for such lewd practices; make a covenant with your eyes, the spark is caught at the eye; not only from it, but also by it; the spark that, falling upon the tinder of an adulterous heart, puts it into a flame; do not look upon the maid or woman, that you may not think; do not think, that you may not lust; do not touch that you may not desire to taste; do not toy, lest you be caught; do not come too near the brink, lest you fall into the stream before you are aware; take heed of speculative uncleanness, as you would be kept from actual uncleanness; take heed of self-pollutions as you would be kept from adultery with others; avoid occasions of this sin, come not into such company and places where you may have opportunity to commit it; flee youthful lusts which war against the soul; keep your minds pure and chaste; resist the first suggestions to this sin; quench the fire when it begins to kindle; look to the issue and consequences of this sin; remember that the holy eye of God is upon you, in your most secret retirements, and he will, ere long, call you to an account.

8. Swearers turn from your evil ways. Remember the third commandment, unto which a threatening is annexed; of "God's charging guilt"

especially upon the breakers hereof." Exod. xx. 7.
 "Thou shalt not take the name of the Lord thy God in vain, for the Lord will not hold him guiltless that taketh his name in vain." The very use of the name of God irreverently, is a breach of this command: but to swear by the name of God, in ordinary discourse, is a gross breach of it; which, as it affronts God highly, so it will bring condemnation certainly upon the guilty, that do not repent and forbear. When God hath made your mouths, and given you tongues to speak his praise, which then are your glory, will you profane the name of this God, and turn not only the glory of God, but also your own glory, into shame and dishonour, and that when you have not the motive and incentive to flesh-pleasing sins?

Take not his name, who made thy mouth, in vain;
 It gets thee nothing, and hath no excuse:
 Lust and wine plead a pleasure, avarice gain;
 But the cheap swearer, through his open sluice
 Lets his soul run for nought as little fearing;
 Were I an epicure, I could hate swearing.

Herbert.

Look into Deut. xxviii. 58, 59, what threatenings the Lord doth denounce there against such as do not fear his name: and surely it is for want of fear and awe of God's name, that any are so bold as to swear by it, or take it in vain: "If thou wilt not fear this glorious and fearful name, The Lord thy God, then the Lord will make thy plagues wonderful, and the plagues of thy seed: even great plagues, and of long continuance, and sore sicknesses, and of long continuance, &c. Hath not God plagued and burned the city

of London, amongst other sins, for this of swearing, and yet will you swear still, and provoke the Lord to further wrath, when you have seen, in part, how fearful the name of God is; in the judgments which he hath executed; will you go on still to profane his name? Do you not fear future judgments? will not the name of God be displayed more dreadfully before you, when he opens the treasures of his wrath, and sends his Son in flaming fire to take vengeance upon sinners? and yet will not you fear this name of God?

Swearers, with what confidence can you pray to God? what hope can you have, when you use God's name in prayer, that you shall have the least audience or acceptance, when you abuse his name so much, and cast such dishonour upon it; by your oaths? If you do not pray now, as swearers seldom do, will you never be driven to your knees? will you never be brought to such extremities, that no creature shall be able to give you any relief? and with what face can you, then, look up to God? Will not your callings upon the name of God be in vain, as you have taken his name in vain? Will not God laugh at your calamity? and though you cry and shout, will not he shut out your prayer, and bar the door of mercy upon you for ever?

Swearers, turn from your sin; make a covenant with your mouth: set a watch before the door of your lips; use God's name in prayer, and reverently in discourse; do not swear by it; or take it in vain any more; get an awe of this name

upon your hearts, which will be an excellent means to keep you from this sin.

4. *Liars, turn from your evil ways.* We read Acts v. at the beginning, of Ananias and Sapphira, who were smitten with sudden death for the sin of lying; it is said, "they fell down at the apostles' feet, and gave up the ghost." And hath not the sin of lying been one ingredient in the meritorious cause of the fall of so many persons and houses by the plague and fire in the city of London? This sin of lying the apostle doth especially caution the Colossians and Ephesians against, after the wonderful grace of God in the renovation of them according to his image, Col. iii. 9, "Lie not one to another, seeing ye have put off the old man, with his deeds, and have put on the new man," &c. Eph. iv. 24, 25. "Having put on the new man, which, after God is created in righteousness and true holiness. Put away lying, and speak every man truth to his neighbour." And this sin I may caution Londoners against, after the dreadful anger of God expressed in the desolations which he hath made amongst them by his late judgments; lie not one to another any more, but speak every one truth to his neighbour. The Lord is a God of truth, and he cannot lie. The devil is the father of lies and liars, John viii. 44, and which is most eligible, to be children of God, or children of the devil? A lying tongue is one of the seven abominations which the Lord hateth, Prov. vi. 16, 17. And is there any good you can get by your lying, comparable to the evil of rendering yourselves hate-

ful and abominable in the sight of God? Is it needful for you sometimes to speak lies? Is it not a thousandfold more needful for you always to speak truth? Are you likely to gain so much by the former as by the latter? What is a little outward emolument in comparison with inward peace? Are you likely to lose so much by the latter as by the former? What is the loss of external, temporal things, in comparison with the loss of your souls and happiness for ever? Is it needful to lie that you may excuse your faults? this makes them double.

Nothing can need a lie;

A fault which needs it most, grows two thereby.

Herbert.

Parents, warn your children against this sin of lying; do not spare the rod of correction where you find them guilty; pass by twenty other faults rather than this; lying is the first link in the chain of a thousand gross sins; rap off their fingers from the first link, lest the chain after grow too strong for you to break.

Masters, indulge not your servants in this sin; the resolution of David was, Psal. ci. 7, "He that worketh deceit shall not dwell in my house; he that telleth lies, shall not tarry in my sight." Especially take heed of leading servants to this sin by your example; above all, of putting them upon this sin, by your persuasions or commands; for, besides the guilt of their sin, which hereby you incur, your damage is like to be more than your advantage by their lies. If you put them upon lying for you, they will put themselves upon lying to you; and if you deceive others in some

things by the former, they are likely to deceive you, deservedly, in greater things by the latter.

Young ones, take heed of lies; do nothing as may need the cloak and excuse of a lie; and if you be overtaken with a fault, never deny it, when examined; but with sorrow acknowledge it as you would gain favour with God and man. Take heed of this sin betimes; lay aside lying before it grows into a custom, which will be hard to leave. Old ones, break off this sin, before you be dragged by the chain of this sin into the fire of hell, which is the threatened punishment thereof, Rev. xxi. 8. Be not too hasty in speech, lest this sin issue forth at the door of your lips, before you are aware: speak always as in the hearing of God, who knows whether your word and heart do agree; and who will one day call you to an account for this sin; and, except you repent, punish you for it severely in the lake of fire and brimstone.

5. *Slandervers, turn from your evil ways.* The sin of slandering is one of the worst sorts of lying, and the teeth of slanderers are compared to "spears and arrows; and their tongues to a sharp sword;" Psal. lviii. 4; and when they utter their slanders, they "bend their bow; and shoot their arrows, they whet their swords; and wound therewith the reputation of others, which they are bound to bear as careful of as their own;" Psal. lxxiv. 34. Slandervers are "false witnesses, who lay to the charge of others such things as they know not;" Psal. xxxv. 11; they are liars, who tear in pieces the good name of others; they are deceivers, whose words are stings, and full of deadly

poison; they are compared to "mauls, and swords, and sharp arrows," Prov. xxv. 18; yea, they are like "mad men, who cast about fire-brands, and arrows, and death," Prov. xxvi. 18. By this sin, you wound others, and are guilty of tongue-murder, but you wound yourselves more, I mean your consciences, and are guilty of self-murder, of soul-murder; and the poison of such speeches is not so venomous and deadly, in regard of your neighbour's good name, as it is in regard of your own spirits, which are envenomed, and will be destroyed hereby, without the application of the blood of Christ for pardon and healing.

Slanderers, forbear your backbiting, slanderous speeches; forbear devouring words, which swallow up the good name of your neighbours; let not your throats be like open sepulchres, to entomb their reputation; take heed your tongues do not utter slanders and reproaches, devised by yourselves; be careful also that you do not spread such calumnies as others have devised. Receive not any accusation against your neighbours without good proof; drive away backbiting tongues with an angry countenance; and if you must hear of other faults, let love conceal them as much as may be from the knowledge of others; rather speak to themselves what you hear, and reprove them (if the things be scandalous) with prudence, love, and a spirit of meekness. Remember the command, Titus iii. 2, "Speak evil of no man." And take heed of the sinful practice of the woman described, 1 Tim. v. 13, "They learn to be idle, wandering about from house to house, and not only idle but tattlers also, and busy bodies

speaking things which they ought not." Where your tongues have been instrumental to wound others, and yourselves withal, by slanderous speeches, make use of the same instrument, for healing; labour to heal yourselves by confession of your sins to God, and to heal others by acknowledging to them the wrong you have done them; labour to lick whole their fame, and by good words to promote their esteem, which you have unjustly taken away. Labour for so much humility and brotherly love, as to be as tender of their good name and fame as your own; and in honour to prefer them above yourselves, which will make you ready to hide their faults, and keep you from evil surmises and evil slanderous speeches.

6. *Revilers, turn from your evil ways.* Reviling and slandering often go together, as proceeding both from the same root of malice and hatred; yet, sometimes, the malice is kept more close: when war is in the heart, and mischief is inwardly devised, and the name secretly wounded with slanders behind the back, the tongue doth flatter, and like a honey-comb, doth drop nothing but sweet words before the face. The sin of reviling is open, and spits forth rancour and malice into the face, and breaks forth into bitter speeches, for the shame and disgrace of such persons against whom they are spoken, though revilers disgrace themselves more, by the weakness, and ill government of spirit, which hereby they discover.

Revilers, refrain your angry bitter speeches; "Let all bitterness, and wrath, and anger, and clamour, and evil speaking, be put away from

you, with all malice," Eph. iv. 81. Do not quarrel and contend: do not break forth into brawls and clamours, and bitter reviling speeches, against such as give you no occasion, but desire to live at peace with you; and if others are angry, and quarrel with you, labour to pacify their anger; do not stir up the coals by your bitter retorts; "when you are reviled, revile not again," like our Saviour, 1 Pet. ii. 28. "Render not evil for evil, nor railing for railing, but contrariwise, blessing," 1 Pet. iii. 9. The second blow breeds the quarrel, and the second reviling word breeds the strife; give to a hard speech the return of a soft answer, Prov. xv. 1. "A soft answer turneth away wrath, but grievous words stir up anger." And Prov. xxv. 15. "Long forbearance is of great persuasion and "a soft tongue breaketh a bone." There is a marvellous force in a meek reception of bitter speeches to appease anger, and mollify the spirits of those which are most fierce; whereas grievous and bitter returns stir up unto greater contention. Revenge not yourselves with the hand, neither revenge yourselves with the tongue; revile not your enemies, but "love them, and pray for them, and do good to them; feed and clothe them, and heap coals upon their head," Matt. v. 44; Rom. xii. 19, 20. "Be gentle, shewing all meekness to all men," Tit. iii. 2. Especially, revile not your friends, take heed of stirring up strife in the house where you live; be of a peaceable disposition: above all, take heed of reviling Christ's friends, God's children; revile not the saints: remember that no revilers, especially such revilers as persevere in

that sin, "shall inherit the kingdom of God," 1 Cor. vi. 10. And when the Lord Jesus cometh at the last day, "He will execute judgment upon the ungodly, for their hard speeches which they have spoken against him, in speaking against his people," Jude 15.

Revilers, govern your tongues. "If any man among you seem to be religious, and bridleth not his tongue, that man's religion is vain," Jam. i. 26. Would you govern yourselves well, according to scripture rules, bridle and govern your tongues, Jam. iii. 3, 4. "Behold, we put bits into the horses' mouths, that they may obey us, and we turn about their whole body. Behold also the ships, which, though they be so great, and are driven of fierce winds, yet they are turned about with a very small helm, whithersoever the governor listeth." Put a bit upon this little member, and you may the better have all the rest at command, and keep yourselves in, when otherwise vented passions, like wild horses without reins, may carry you into many a precipice; when otherwise the fierce storms of your minds may break forth, and drive you upon rocks and shelves, and shipwreck both soul and body together; "There is a world of iniquity in the tongue; which defileth the whole body; the tongue is a fire, which setteth on fire the whole course of nature; and itself is set on fire of hell," v. 6. Get the former fire quenched, get the heat of your tongues cooled, as you would escape the latter fire, I mean the fire of hell, from whence the former fire doth proceed, and unto which it will certainly bring you. "The tongue is full of deadly poison, it is

an unruly evil, which no man can tame, when by art the wildest beasts may and have been tamed," ver. 7, 8. Others cannot tame your tongues, but you may get them tamed yourselves: put them under the government of Christ, and he will tame them; get your passions tamed within, and you may tame this member, which is the instrument they make use of to vent themselves in your revilings: keep guard and sentinel before the door of your lips, and watch your words, that you offend not with your tongues.

7. *Persecutors, turn from your evil ways.* Forbear persecuting the people of God, who desire your good, and are the best safeguard and defence, by their prayers and faith, of the places where they live, from miseries and destruction. Is it good for you to hew at the bough on which you stand over such a deep, into which, if you should fall, it will be impossible for you to recover yourselves again? Is it good for you to pull at the pillars of the house, which, if you pluck down, will bring the house upon you, and bury you in its ruins? Is it good to put yourselves under the burthensome stone which will grind you to powder? Suppose, whilst you are breathing forth threatenings against any of Christ's disciples, and are in the heat of your rage and furious persecution of them, you should hear such a voice as Paul did from heaven, "Sinners, sinners, why persecute you me?" Would it not cool, and stop you? You may hear this voice, if you will open your ear unto the word; it is Christ you persecute in his disciples; it is Christ you wound through their sides; you would do the same to him as the

Jews did, were he alive amongst you, and you had the same power as sometimes was put into their hands against the Lord of Life. I will not charge London with, and therefore need not warn them generally against, the sin of persecution of God's people, because they have been a shelter to them, when the times have frowned most upon them: but are there none have need of this warning? Are there no Judas's amongst them, none of Paul's spirit before his conversion?

Persecutors, forbear this sin, which makes you as like the devil as any that I know, and locks you fastest in his arms; which is the very next door to the sin against the Holy Ghost, which will bring upon you swift destruction; which will sink you into the lower parts of the bottomless pit; which will lash and sting your consciences with horrible scourges hereafter, if they be not awakened with horror here; turn from this sin before it be too late; imitate Paul, and become friends to them against whom you have expressed so much enmity and spite.

8. *Covetous persons, turn from your evil ways.* God hath smitten you for the iniquity of your covetousness, do not go frowardly on in this sin; he hath subtracted much of the fuel of this sin, and burnt it in the fire; let there be a greater decay in your lust of covetousness than there hath been in any of your estates. Covetousness is one of the sins which the apostles would not have "so much as named amongst the saints," Ephes. v. 3. It is a sin if it reign, which is inconsistent with the truth of grace, and power of godliness, because it is idolatry, Col. iii. 5. And the apos-

He tells us expressly, that "covetous persons shall not inherit the kingdom of God," 1 Cor. ix. 10. Yea, that "the wrath of God shall come upon them," Ephes. v. 6.

Covetous persons, turn from your sin, get this earthly member mortified: get your hearts loosened from those things, which you have hitherto made your God, and in which you have sought for your chiefest felicity.

Have you little in the world? Be contented with the portion which God gives you; you have as much as God seeth fit for you," Heb. xiii. 5. "Let your conversation be without covetousness, and be content with such things as you have." Covetousness will not heal your poverty, any more than riches can heal your covetousness.

Have you much in the world? do your riches increase? set not your heart upon them: make use of what God hath given you without such pinching and self-denial, which the Lord Jesus never commanded in his precepts of that kind. God never gave riches to save, but to use; take heed of exceeding the bounds in spending, and do not spare the moderate use of what you have, for fear of future wanting; use part of your estates for yourselves in what is needful for the body, and suitable to your degree and quality; lay aside part for your posterity; and lay out part in the help of those in necessity, for relief of the poor, whereby "you will lay up for yourselves a good foundation for the time to come; and, at last, lay hold on eternal life," 1 Tim. vi. 18, 19.

9. *Unrighteous persons, turn from your evil ways.* God hath been righteous in his judgments, because you have been unrighteous in your dealings; and as his judgments are a reproof of your sin, so are they a warning to you to leave it. Unrighteous gains will yield you little advantage in the issue: see what the Apostle James speaks of the wealth which men get in such a way, chap. v. 2—4. “Your riches are corrupted, and your garments moth-eaten: your gold and silver is cankered, and the rust of them shall be a witness against you, and shall eat your flesh, as it were fire: ye have heaped treasures together for the last days; behold the hire of your labourers, which have reaped down your fields, which is of you kept back by fraud, crieth, and the cries have entered into the ears of the Lord of Sabaoth.” The curse of God goeth along with unlawful, unrighteous gains; and is like moth and rust to corrupt and canker them; they bring a fire into the flesh and bones, which will eat and torment; they pierce men through with many sorrows, and at the latter end utterly consume them with terrors, if their conscience be awakened; unrighteous persons do not heap up such treasures of wealth, as by sin they heap up treasures of wrath against the last day: the wrongs which they do to others, cry with a loud voice to God, and the Lord will be the avenger of all such as are defrauded. Let them that have been unrighteous then be unrighteous no more: you cannot wrong others so much by this sin, as you wrong yourselves:

shake your hands of dishonest gains; make restitution of what you have defrauded others, as you expect salvation, *non remittitur peccatum, nisi restitatur ablatum*. This is a hard saying to some, who have no other wealth but what they have gained in a dishonest and unrighteous way; but will it not be harder to suffer the vengeance of eternal fire for this sin? Is it not better to impoverish yourselves, that you may be just and honest whilst you live, than to be damned and thrust into a place of torment when you die? You must leave what you have: if God do not take away what you have by some temporal calamity before, be sure death will strip you of all; and is it not better for you to part with it yourselves to the just owners, when this is the way to obtain pardon and peace, and an inheritance, which is of a thousand-fold more value? And do not fear but God will make provision for you whilst you abide in the world, if you resolve to be honest, and put your trust in him, who hath the disposal of the earth and the fulness thereof. Be righteous for the future; do not swerve a hair from the rule of right. "What you would that others should do unto you, do unto them:" this is a principle inscribed upon the heart by nature, and "this is the law and the prophets," Matt. vii. 12.

10. *Hypocrites, turn ye from your evil ways.* Methinks the terrible voice of God should affrighten you, under your hypocritical shows, and outside devotions; methinks you should now bend your hearts to please the Lord, and approve

yourselves chiefly to him, who hath expressed so much displeasure against sinners, and is most highly offended with hypocrites. What good will a form do you, without the power of godliness? what good will shows do you, without sincere and substantial service? what benefit will you get by counterfeit graces, if your graces be not real? If your repentance, and faith, and love, and the like, be feigned, how ineffectual will they be to procure pardon, and peace, and salvation? Are you content to lose all your bodily exercise, and to have all your heartless lifeless duties rise up one day in judgment against you? What advantage will you get by a bare profession of religion, especially in such times when profession, if it be strict, is discountenanced, and professors, if their lamp shine with any brightness, and they carry any great sail, expose themselves to danger? And if you have not sincerity, which alone can yield you the true and sweet fruits of religion, you are like to lose all, and of all others to make yourselves most miserable; you may suffer from men because you have a profession, and you will suffer from God, because you have no more than a profession: what then, should you cast off your profession? No; so you would turn apostates, and may fall into the sin against the Holy Ghost, which will bring upon you inevitable damnation; but lay aside your hypocrisy, and become sincere: be that in truth, which you are in show; labour for sincerity in regard of your state, and labour for sincerity in regard of your duties.

Sinners, God calls upon all of you to turn from ~~your~~ evil ways by His thundering voice.

Turn presently: let the time past be sufficient wherein you have fulfilled the desires of the flesh and the mind; go not a step forward in the way of sin, lest you meet with destruction suddenly, and perish without remedy.

Turn universally; say not of any sin, as Lot did of Zoar, "It is a little one;" cast away all your transgressions, and let no iniquity have dominion over you for the future.

Turn heartily, from an inward principle of hatred to sin, and love to God; and not from outward considerations, and merely upon the account of sin's dreadful consequents.

Turn constantly, and with full purpose of heart ~~never~~ to return unto your evil ways of sin any more.

10. *The Lord doth expect, after such judgments, that London should seek him; that they should not only turn from their evil ways, but also that they should "turn unto him that hath smitten them, and seek the Lord of Hosts," Isa. ix. 13. We read, Amos v. 2. "The virgin of Israel is fallen, she is forsaken, and none to raise her up:" whereupon God calls this duty, ver. 4—8. "Thus saith the Lord to the house of Israel, Seek ye me, and ye shall live; but seek not Bethel, &c. Seek the Lord, and ye shall live, lest he break forth like fire in the house of Joseph, and devour, and there be none to quench; seek him who made the seven stars, and Orion, and turneth the shadow of death into the morning, &c. the Lord is his name:" and it follows,*

ver. 15. "It may be the Lord will be gracious unto the remnant of Joseph." And when this duty is neglected, see the threatening, ver. 16. "Wailing shall be in all streets; and they shall say in all the high ways, Alas, alas! and they shall call the husbandmen to mourning, and such as are skilful of lamentation, to wailing." And now London is fallen, doth not the Lord call upon them, that they would call upon him? and as they would turn away his anger, and prevent their utter ruin, that they would seek him who can turn the shadow of death into the morning, and the blackest night of affliction into a day of prosperity and rejoicing.

London, seek the Lord, that ye may live; that there may be a reviving after the years of such death and ruins; seek the Lord, before the decree bring forth some other judgment, and ye pass away like chaff before the whirlwind, in the day of the Lord's fierce anger; it may be the Lord will be gracious to the remnant of this great city. God expects that London should now pray at another rate than heretofore they have done. It is said, Dan. ix. 13. "All this evil is come upon us, yet made we not our prayer unto the Lord our God:" and when God had consumed Israel, because of their iniquities, the prophet complains, Isa. xlv. 7. "There is none that calleth upon thy name, that stirreth up himself to take hold of thee." Had the prayers of London been such as they should have been, such as they have been, the desolations of London might have been prevented: God expects that London, under such chastisements should "pour

out prayers before him," Isa. xxvi. 16. God hath spoken terribly unto them, he expects that they should cry mightily unto him. God expects that London should meet him in the way of his judgments, not only with weepings for their sins, that they have provoked him unto so great displeasure, but also with supplications for his mercies. When Jacob was devoured, and his dwelling place laid waste, Psal. lxxix. 7, you have their prayer, verses 8, 9, &c. "O remember not against us former iniquities; let thy tender mercies speedily prevent us, for we are brought very low: Help us, O Lord God of our salvation, for the glory of thy name: deliver us, and purge away our sins for thy name's sake." And the church, under desolating judgments, doth in prayer express herself very pathetically, Isa. lxiii. 15, &c. "Look down from heaven, and behold from the habitation of thy holiness, and thy glory: where is thy zeal, and thy strength, the sounding of thy bowels? and thy mercies, are they restrained? Doubtless, thou art our Father, &c. We are thine: return for thy servants' sake, &c. and chap. lxiv. 9. "Be not wroth very sore, O Lord, neither remember iniquity for ever; behold, see, we beseech thee, we are all thy people." God hath been pleading and contending with London by his judgments, and God doth look that London should plead with him in prayer for his mercies.

London, seek the Lord of Hosts, who hath come forth against you in battle, and wounded you with his sharp arrows, and yet hath not laid down his weapons: get to your knees; hang

about God's feet and arms; fill your mouths with arguments to stay him in the course of his judgments; let not the apple of your eye cease from weeping, that you have displeased him; and let not your tongue cease from humble and earnest entreaties, that he would pardon you, and remove his displeasure from you.

Seek the Lord *humbly*; put your mouths in the dust, if so be there may be any hope. God hears the cry of the humble, and will not despise their prayer, Psal. x. 17; Psal. cii. 17.

Seek the Lord *diligently*; he hath promised to be found of all them that diligently seek him, Heb. xi. 6. God looks for earnest, hearty, fervent prayer: there is a sweet promise which God makes to his people's prayers after his sore judgments which he had brought upon them, Jer. xxix. 11—13. "I know the thoughts, that I think towards you, saith the Lord, thoughts of peace, and not of evil, to give you an expected end. Then shall ye call upon me, and ye shall go; and pray unto me, and I will hearken unto you: and ye shall seek me and find me, when ye shall search for me with all your heart."

Seek the Lord *believingly*; mingle your prayers with faith, and make use of the mediation of Christ, that you may prevail.

11. *God calls upon London, by the voice of his judgments, to prepare for greater troubles.* The face of God seems to threaten greater troubles; there is little sign that God's brow is smoothened now, more than it was before the fire; there is little evidence of the appeasement of God's anger; the face of the times seems to threaten

greater troubles: the cloud over London and England is still very black, and seems to be thicker than it was before.

(1.) *God's own people are like to undergo greater troubles*: some of them have endured much, but they are like to endure much more: some of them have suffered deeply, but they are like to suffer greater things more generally: they have been brought low by affliction, but not so low as others be; when others of God's people are stript of all, they enjoy a comparative prosperity; they are not so low as they deserve to be; their Gospel-reproaching sins deserve far greater severities: they are not so low as they may have need to be; they may need greater troubles, to unite them more one to another in their affections, to further their sanctification, to wean and loosen them more from the world; to humble them for, and purify them more from sin; to exercise and brighten more their graces: they are not so low as possibly they must be before they be exalted; the night is the darkest before the day breaks; the storm is the fiercest many times in its last blast; and the afflictions of God's people are the sorest before God gives them deliverance; God lays his people most low, when he intends their highest exaltation: surely, the expected shock is not yet over, and God's people's most dreadful sufferings seem most immediately to be threatened, they seem to be near, very near, even at the doors. The intent of the late judgments by plague and fire, seems plainly to be for the fitting and preparing of them for more smart and heavy strokes. If God

had permitted those expected sufferings to have come upon them more suddenly, they might have found them more unready; God hath given them time to prepare, and awakening warnings to prepare; and when will they be ready to suffer like Christians, like Protestants, if now they be not ready?

(2.) *The profane and wicked generation in the land, are like to endure greater troubles, as hath been shown, page 96—98, and when the storm of God's anger doth break down upon them, are there no drops likely to fall upon London? Is not the whole land likely to be in danger of ruin, when God doth deal with the ungodly and wicked crew, whom he spares for some time, whilst he punisheth so severely the more righteous? The troubles of London have been great, but methinks it is evident, that London is in danger of greater troubles; therefore they have need to make preparation, which they have had such awakening calls unto. Some possibly may think the bitterness of London's troubles is over, because their troubles have been so bitter; that the sharp winter cold is gone, when it was so sharp in the midst of winter, and the sun had got to some height; but March can bring in as cold nipping frost as December and January did; and when the spring of prosperity is expected by some, they may find the sharpest part of the winter of troubles to be behind. Prepare, therefore, London, for greater troubles.*

12. *God doth expect that London should trust no more in arms of flesh, but in himself alone. By these judgments God hath shewn to London*

the weakness and insufficiency of arms of flesh, what broken reeds they are. Some put their trust in men, and their great expectation of relief and comfort hath been from their friends; by the plague God hath shewn, how frail and weak man is; how like grass, or a flower, that quickly withereth, or is cut down; how like glass, or a bubble, which is easily broken and vanisheth: many have lost, by the plague, their chief friends upon whom they have had all their dependance; and the Lord hath shewn how insufficient a foundation man is for any one's trust and confidence; therefore he calleth aloud to London, to "cease from man, whose breath is in his nostrils, for wherein is he to be accounted of?" Isa. ii. 22, not to trust in "any of the sons of men, in whom there is no help;" and the reason is, because "their breath goeth forth, and they return to their dust; in that very day all their thoughts perish," Psal. cxlvi. 3, 4. Some put their trust in their wealth and riches, Prov. xviii. 11. "The rich man's wealth is his city, and a high wall is his own conceit." God hath by the fire, which hath consumed so much of the wealth of the city, shewn how insufficient a foundation wealth is for any man's confidence; he hath made it evident that riches are uncertain, and that they fly away with eagles' wings, sometimes whilst the owners are looking on: may not that which is threatened, Psal. lii. 5, 7, be spoken of many in London, that God hath rooted some of them by the plague out of the land of the living, plucked and forced others out of their habitations by the fire, and taken away their stay and prop from them; of

whom it may be said, "Lo, these are they that made not God their strength, but trusted in the abundance of their riches, and strengthened themselves in their wickedness."

London, trust no more in arms of flesh, but trust in God alone: "It is better to trust in the Lord, than to put confidence in men; it is better to trust in the Lord, than to put confidence in princes," Psal. cxviii. 8, 9. God is knocking off your fingers from all things here below; his will is that you should put your trust in him; which is one promised effect of great desolations and afflictions, that you should labour after; Zeph. iii. 12. "I will also leave in the midst of thee an afflicted and poor people, and they shall trust in the name of the Lord." You were not so forward to trust in the Lord when you had greater abundance; endeavour to trust in him, now you are brought into greater poverty and affliction: his infinite power, wisdom, loving kindness, his promise, truth, and faithfulness are a strong bottom for your trust and confidence in God. Trust in him at all times, in the worst of times; when your danger is greatest, he will be your "help and shield," Psal. cxv. 1; he will be your refuge under oppression, and "present help in time of trouble," Psal. xli. 1; he will be your rock and fortress, your high tower to defend you, or your deliverer to redeem you out of all your troubles. Trust in God alone for all things: if you make use of creatures, do not lean and stay upon them, for they will slip from under you; but stay yourselves on God. O the peace and quiet which this will yield in shaking, troublesome

days. When others' hearts tremble within them, and are moved like leaves upon the approach of danger, "You shall not be afraid of evil tidings, but have your hearts fixed, trusting in the Lord," Psal. cxii. 7.

18. *God doth expect that London should have death in continual remembrance.* This God expects from the judgments of the plague, the death of so many thousands a week in London, gave such a spectacle of mortality, and preached such a sermon in the city, as should bring the remembrance of death into their minds every day of their lives; the death, if it were but of one or two, should put you in mind of your latter end; but when you have seen so many go down into the pit before you, it should inscribe the remembrance of death more deeply upon your minds, the record of which you should look daily into. The gates of the city, in the year of the plague, seemed to have this inscription upon them, "All flesh is grass;" let that word sound every day in your ears, and remember your bodies are exposed to the stroke of death every day: and though you have out-lived the plague, that yet death hath you in the chase, and will ere long, (you know not how soon), overtake you: remember your glass is running, and will quickly be run out; and therefore "all the days of your appointed time," as you should remember, so you should "prepare for your great change," Job, xiv. 14.

God expects that the remaining inhabitants of London should be prepared well for death now, when they have had death so much in their view;

some of you have been sick of the plague, and brought to the very brink of the grave; all of you have been in danger of the plague, when the disease was so sore and raging; I fear most of you were unprepared for death at that time, and had you died then, that it would have been with horror; and I believe that there are few of you but did, in the time of your fears and danger, make vows and promises, if the Lord would shelter you from the arrows which flew about you, and spare your lives then, that you would lead new lives, and be more careful to prepare for your change, so that death should not take you so unprovided any more: God expects the fulfilling of your promises; and that you should live up to the vows, which you made in the time of your distress; and so provide yourselves whilst you are well, that the messenger of death may have a welcome reception, whenever he summoneth you to leave this world.

14. *God expects that London should retain great impressions of eternity.* You have had the door of eternity set wide open in your view, when so many were thronging in at the door, and I believe you had deeper apprehensions of eternity in those days, than ever you had in your lives; take heed that those impressions do not wear off, and that you lose not those apprehensions, especially when you are drawing every day nearer and nearer thereunto. Think often of the vast ocean of eternity, without bottom or bank on the other side, into which the whole stream of time will empty itself; and how quickly the small rivulet of your appointed days may fall

into it: think often of the unalterable state of joy or misery, which you must enter into at the end of your course: think how thin and short the pleasures of sin are in this life, in comparison of the horrible and endless torments of hell; and how "light and momentary the afflictions of God's people are here, in comparison with the exceeding and eternal weight of glory prepared for them in heaven," 2 Cor. xli. 7.

15. *God doth call upon London by the fire which burnt down the city, to secure themselves against the fire of hell.* London's fire was dreadful, but the fire of hell will be a thousand-fold more dreadful. The fire of London was kindled by man; be sure some second cause was made use of herein; but the fire of hell will be kindled by God himself, Isa. xxx. 33. "Tophet is ordained of old, for the king it is prepared, he hath made it deep and large; the pile thereof is fire and much wood, and the breath of the Lord, like a stream of brimstone, doth kindle it." The fire of London burnt the houses of the city, and consumed much of the goods; but the fire of hell will burn the persons of the wicked, Matt. xv. 41, "Depart, ye cursed, into everlasting fire." The fire of London did burn most, but not all, the houses in the city; some are yet remaining, but the fire of hell will burn all the persons of the wicked, not one of them shall escape and remain. The fire of London was extinguished, and did last but four days; but the fire of hell will be unextinguishable, it will burn for ever; it is called everlasting fire, in which the damned

must lie and burn eternally, without any possibility of ever getting forth. If you had known before of London's fire, where it would begin, and how it would spread, and seize upon your houses, surely you would have taken some course for the prevention of it. You know before of the fire of hell; the word of God hath revealed it: O take some course for preventing of it, at least for securing of yourselves against it. When the fire was burning in London you did fly from it, lest it should have consumed your persons as well as houses: O fly from the fire of hell, into which your persons will be thrown if you go on in sin; fly from the wrath which is to come; fly unto Jesus Christ, who alone can deliver you.

16. *God doth call upon Londoners by the fire, to be like strangers and pilgrims in the world.* God hath burned you out of your habitations, that he might loosen your affections from houses, and riches, and all things here below; that he might unsettle you, unhinge, unfix you, that you might never think of rest and settlement in the creatures, as long as you live. God calls upon you by this judgment, to take off your hearts from this world, which is so very uncertain, and to be like strangers and pilgrims upon the earth, who are to take up your lodging here but a few days and nights in your passage to the other world. God expects you should live as those who have here no certain dwelling-place; and therefore that you should not lavish away too much of your thoughts, and affections, and time, about these uncertain things, which are of so

short a continuance, and with which you cannot have a long abode. God hath by his judgments crucified the world very much before you, and he expects that the world should be crucified in you. God hath poured contempt upon the world, and set a mark of disgrace thereon: he hath cast dirt upon the face, where you fancied before so much beauty to lie; and he expects that you should fall in esteem, and grow out of love with the world, and never go a whoring from him to the creatures any more.

17. *God calls upon London to make him their habitation*; Psalm xc. 1, "Lord, thou hast been our dwelling-place in all generations." God is the *hiding-place*, and he is the *dwelling-place* of his people; you have lost your dwelling by the fire, make God your habitation, and dwell in him, to whom you may have constant resort, and in whom you may have a sure abode. Get possession of this house by your union to God through his Son; and when you are in, keep possession, abide in this house, do not wander from him, and turn yourselves out of doors, by breaking of his household laws: make God your home, and labour to be much acquainted at home; spend your time with God, and give your hearts to him: rest and repose yourselves in God daily; look for all your provisions in him, and from him; walk in him, and with him. Make God your habitation.

18. *God calleth upon London to seek after an abiding city*, Heb. xiii. 14, "We have no continuing city, but we seek one to come." London

hath reason to say the former, therefore let London do the latter. You have seen the city fall by the fire, seek after a city which hath more lasting foundations, and is of such strong building, that neither time can wear and weaken, nor flames of fire reach and consume. I mean the New Jerusalem, which is above, the heavenly city, whose builder and maker is God; there are mansions, abiding places for the saints, John xiv: 2. There the wicked will cease from troubling, and the weary will be at rest: seek after this city, labour for a title to it, lay up your treasure in it, get your affections set upon it; above all trades, chase a trade with heaven, which, in the issue, will yield you the best returns.

19. *God doth expect that London should labour to build his house.* The neglect of God's house, I believe, hath been a great cause of the fall of so many houses in the city by fire. God expects that now you should endeavour the building of his house; otherwise, I do not think that God will build again your houses. You may interest Act of Parliament for building the city, and bid workmen about it; but unless God do direct it, the building will never go forward; unless God build the city, the workmen will labour in vain. Read and consider the prophecy of Haggai. Set about the work of reformation more vigorously; especially in the house and worship of God.

20. *God doth expect that Londoners should dedicate themselves and families unto him.* You have broken your baptismal and other vows, and God hath made great breaches upon you for your

infidelity; now renew your vows, give up yourselves to God, avouch him to be your God, and avouch yourselves to be his people, and live accordingly. Take up Joshua's resolution, that whatever others in the land do, that you and your families will serve the Lord. Make it your only business in the world to serve God; let religion have an influence upon all your actions; do nothing without the warrant of God's precept; let your conversation be such as becometh the Gospel; govern your families in the fear of God; fill all your relations with duty; learn more righteousness by God's judgments, and be quickened by them unto a more holy and strict walking.

And if you yield such fruits as these, which God expects after his ploughing and harrowing of you; if you open your ear to the "Terrible voice of the Lord," which hath uttered itself "in the city," and with full purpose of heart set about the practice of the duties he expects and calls for; then you may hope that he will yet build you up, and plant you, that he will close your breaches, and raise up your ruinous habitations; that he will make you glad according to the years wherein he hath afflicted you, and give you to see good days, instead of those evil which you have seen and felt: then the Lord will rejoice over you to do you good; and make London like Mount Zion, where he will pitch his tent, and take up his habitation: then he will compass you about with the bulwark of salvation, and prevent those further utterly de-

solating judgments which you are in danger of ; yea, the Lord will be as a " wall of fire " round about you, and the glory in the midst of London, from whence his praise and your fame shall sound throughout the whole world.

FINIS.

Soli Deo Gloria.

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